

OUR STORY

Changes are afoot in mid-19th century Derbyshire, England. The envy of this part of the county is Alderley Hall, where Margaret, Dowager Countess Fairchild, and her sister-in-law, Ethel, reside with a joint income well in excess of £20,000 pa. Only their loneliness living on such a sprawling estate dampens the generous hearts of the two widowed and childless ladies.

Then, to their delight, they welcome new occupants: dashing nephew Charles and lovely niece Elizabeth, sadly not far removed from tragedy. Their parents, returning from holiday in the south of France, perished crossing the Channel in sudden ill weather. The deaths of Margaret's brother-in-law and his lady have brought Charles and Elizabeth permanently to the Fairchild residence, far from their childhood estate in Yorkshire.

Of course, the irrepressible Fairchild ladies—now a year removed from the terrible accident—know precisely what the best medicine for a sad heart is: romance! Fortunately, the surrounding hills are awash in prime matchmaking material. Having endured the hard times of the late 18th century, the respectable families of Derbyshire are intent on restoring their country estates and reputations, not to mention finding matches for their marriageable children. A sense of optimism is abroad, and the Fairchild ladies have designs!

Obsession

Universal Rules Compendium

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INTRODUCTION & CONTENTS

This compendium compiles all rules from the *Obsession* base game, its two major expansions *Upstairs, Downstairs* and *Characters*, and all optional gameplay modules and official variants included with the base game and expansions.

Additional content is covered in the **Appendices** section on pages 76–115, which provides clarifications for *Obsession* gentry cards with unusual favours, improvement tiles, objectives, solo opponents, and other content published to date.

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COMPONENTS

OBSESSION BASE GAME



Alderley Hall Board (1)



Main Board (1)



First Player Marker (1)



Round Marker (1)



Family Boards (4)



Reputation Markers (4)



Servant Meeples (39)
- Underbutlers (2)
- Butlers (4)
- Housekeepers (4)
- Valets (8)
- Lady's Maids (8)
- Footmen (13)



Reminder Tokens (4)



Tableau Organisers (4)



Reputation Level Counters (20)



Gentry Cards (95)
- Fairchilds (2)
- Family Members (17)
- Starter Guests (15)
- Casual Guests (35)
- Prestige Guests (26)



Improvement Tiles (80)
- Starter Tiles (20)
- Base Game Tiles (54)
- Monuments (6)



(£100) (£500)

Coins (46)



Tile Draw Bag (1)



Theme Cards (10)



VP Cards (30)



Player Aids (24)



Objective Cards (30)

SOLO COMPONENTS



d20 Solo Dice (1)



Solo AI Card (1)



Solo Opponent Cards (12)



Component Storage Boxes (8)



Scorepad (1)

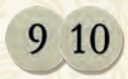
(U) *UPSTAIRS, DOWNSTAIRS* EXPANSION



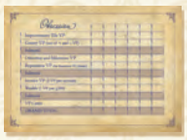
Tableau Mode
Alderley Hall Board (1)



Howard Family Board (1)



Reputation
Level 9/10
Counters (2)



Scorepad (1)



Supplemental Servant Meeples (21)
- Hall Boys (5)
- Cooks (6)
- Head Housemaids (5)
- Useful Men (5)



Servant Storage
Bag (1)



Improvement Tiles (32)
- Starter Tiles (10)
- Extra Set of PR5 Tiles (6)
- Expansion Tiles (8)
- Low VP Monuments (4)
- Promotional Tiles (4)



Rules Mat (1)



Milestone Cards (10)



Objective Cards (33)



Milestone/Solo Estate
Counters (14)



Alternate Size
Theme & VP
Cards (40)



Gentry Cards (56)
- Howard Family Members (4)
- Starter Guests (7)
- Casual Guests (10)
- Prestige Guests (16)
- Promotional Guests (19)



Player Aids (12)

OTHER 5–6 PLAYER COMPONENTS

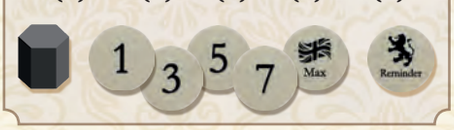
These are duplicates of components in the base game, see page 3:

- Tableau Organiser (1)
- Servant Meeples (14)
- Reputation Markers (2)
- Reputation Level Counters (10)
- Reminder Tokens (2)





(2) (2) (3) (3) (4)



SOLO COMPONENTS



Dynamic AI and Rule Cards (2)



Solo Opponent Cards (6)

(B) BACKER-DEVELOPED PROMO TILES PACK

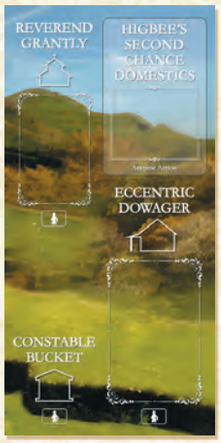


Promotional Improvement Tiles (18)



Rules Mat (1)

(C) *CHARACTERS* EXPANSION



Characters Sideboard (1)



Second Chance (SC) Servant Meeples (15)
- SC Valets (5)
- SC Lady's Maids (5)
- SC Footmen (5)



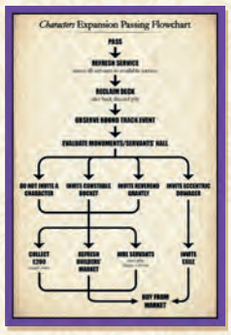
Character Meeples (3)



Improvement Tiles (6)
- Revised Base Game Tiles (2)
- Promotional Tiles (4)



Expansion Player Aids (7)



Passing Flowchart (1)



Component Storage Box (1)



Objective Cards (52)



Gentry Cards (50)
- Alternate Fairchild (1)
- Distinguished Family (21)
- Casual Guests (10)
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SOLO COMPONENTS



Solo Opponent Cards (14)

COOPERATIVE COMPONENTS



Sneyd Family Board (1)



Sneyd Family Cards (5)



Fiery Sermon Cards (2)



d6 Impropriety Dice (1)



Scandal Markers (3)

(W) *WESSEX* EXPANSION



Gentry Cards (20)
- Wessex Family Members (4)
- Casual Guests (6)
- Starter Guests (5)
- Prestige Guests (5)



Wessex Family Board (1)



Improvement Tiles (6)
- Wessex PR2 Starter Tiles (2)
- Expansion Tiles (4)

SOLO COMPONENTS



Extended Play Solo Opponent Cards (6)

CHAPTER 1. INTEGRATED SETUP

This section lists the steps to set up the game **with or without** expansions. Follow the **basic Player Setup** to set up a standard-length game for 2-4 players without any expansions. Follow the appropriately labelled **extra steps** to include expansions and/or common variants.

TEAMS, CO-OP, AND OTHER VARIANTS

To set up other official variants, see Chapter 4, Optional Rules & Content (pg. 46).

To set up other game modes such as Tableau *Obsession*, Team *Obsession* or Cooperative *Obsession*, see Chapter 6, Alternate Game Modes (pg. 62).

Designer's Note: *In early 2024, I went to one of my many Kallaxes and gathered up four boxes for one of my favourite games—the base and three expansions. Friends were an hour away, and, as the resident rules guru, I needed to brush up. After 10 minutes of flipping through 4 rulebooks, I packed everything up and grabbed a different game; I just didn't have time to go through it all. Later that evening, I realised that I had skipped playing a beloved game because getting it to the table had become unwieldy.*

The Obsession *family has 9 rules references scattered over 5 titles! This compendium is designed to put answers to every rule question at your fingertips, to rescue* Obsession *from the very un-Victorian fate of being…cumbersome.*



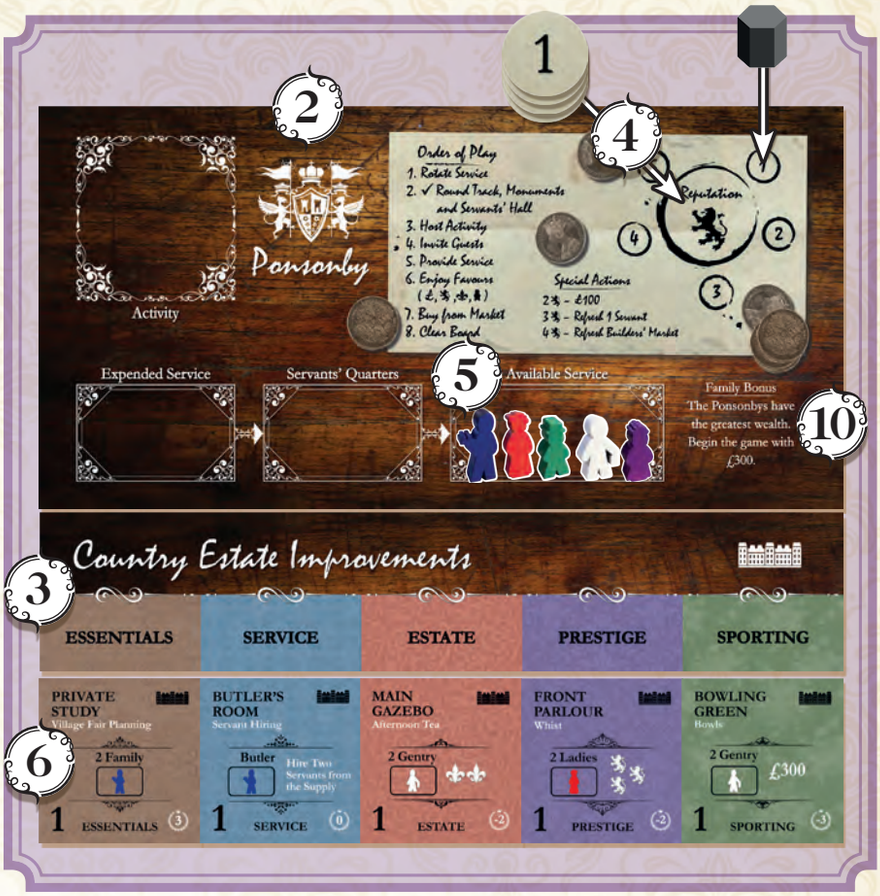
SETUP – EXTRA STEPS REFERENCE

(U) ***Upstairs, Downstairs*** **(C)** ***Characters*** **(W)** ***Wessex*** **(B) Promo Tiles Pack**	**What is it?** Expansions add a variety of gameplay features, including new core mechanics, playable families, servant types, gentry, and improvement tiles. Except where otherwise noted, all expansions and optional modules are compatible with each other. Feel free to mix and match to create your perfect experience! **What do I need?** The indicated expansion(s).
(X) Extended	**What is it?** An extended game lasts 20 rounds instead of the standard 16. **What do I need?** Just the base game. Compatible with all expansions.
(1P) Solo	**What is it?** In solo mode, a single player faces automated opponents of various difficulties. **What do I need?** Just the base game for a standard-length game. An extended game requires extended solo opponents from *Wessex; Upstairs, Downstairs;* or *Characters*.
(5P+) 5–6 Players	**What is it?** Adds up to 2 additional players to the game. **What do I need?** **(U) 5 Players:** Requires 5–6 player components from *Upstairs, Downstairs* and at least **1** expansion family from *Upstairs, Downstairs* **or** *Wessex*. **(U) (W) 6 Players:** Requires 5–6 player components from *Upstairs, Downstairs* and **both** expansion families from *Upstairs, Downstairs* **and** *Wessex*. Team variant is recommended (see 6.2 Team Mode, pg. 64).



1.1 PLAYER SETUP

Follow these **steps** to set up each player's family board, improvement tile tableau, and starting components.



1 **First Player:** Give the first player marker to a random player.



a. **(1P)** In solo mode, you are always first player.

2 **Family Draft:** Beginning to the **left** of the first player and going clockwise, each player chooses an available **family board**. Each family has a unique **starting bonus** listed at the bottom right of their board (see step 10).

a. **Expanded Family Draft:** Players may use the rules on pg. 14 to draft additional starting options, such as extra servants or starter guests. An expanded draft is required when using *Upstairs, Downstairs* **(U)** or the Distinguished Family Members module from *Characters* **(C)**.

b. **(5P+)** With 5–6 players, if you are **not** using an expanded draft, give the 5th & 6th players in turn order £200 and £300, respectively.

c. **(1P)** In a solo game, choose any family board and any set of expanded draft options for expansions or optional modules you are using (pg. 14). Then choose a **solo opponent card** of the desired difficulty that is compatible with expansions you are using, if any (see Appendix G: Solo Opponents, pg. 113). Place the selected card face up near your family board, along with the **d20 solo dice** and **solo AI card**. If you have *Upstairs, Downstairs*, you can instead use the **dynamic solo AI card** for a more challenging and varied experience.

3 **Tableau Organiser:** Depending on available space, each player may **either** use the side of their family board with the 5 tableau categories printed at the bottom, **or** they may take a separate organiser from the box and place it somewhere near their family board. Players should leave space to build a tableau of improvement tiles under their board or organiser. (It's not unusual to have 5+ tiles in a single column at game end.)

4 **Reputation Wheel:** Each player takes a set of **4 reputation level counters** (1/2, 3/4, 5/6, and Max) and stacks them highest to lowest, with 'Max' at the bottom and '1' face up on top. Each player places their counter stack in the center of the **reputation wheel** on their family board, then places a **reputation marker** in **position 1** on their wheel.



a. **(X)** In an extended game, each player also adds a **7/8** counter to their stack, in between Max and 5/6. (Otherwise, leave these in the box.)

5 Starting Servants:

Each player places the following **5 servants** in the Available Service area on their family board: 1 butler (dark blue), 1 housekeeper (red), 1 valet (green), 1 footman (white), and 1 lady's maid (purple).



6 Starter Tiles:

Each player takes the **5 starter tiles** shown (marked with a icon top right). Players place their tiles below their board or organiser as shown. Each tile must be placed with its starter icon face up. Return all unused starter tiles to the box.

7 Family Members:

Each player starts with their **4 family member cards** (marked with their family crest and the first letter of their family name in the top left) in their **hand**.

Return all family members from unused families to the box. (**Note:** The Asquith player starts with 5 family members; see step 10.)



8 Starter Guests:

Sort through the **casual guest** deck ( ) and find all **starter guests** (marked with a top left). Shuffle the starter guests and deal **2** to each player to add to their hand. Shuffle all leftover starter guests back into the casual guest deck.



a. If players opt to **draft** starter guests using the Expanded Family Draft rules on pg. 14, skip this step.

9 Objectives:

Shuffle the objectives deck and deal **5 objective cards** to each player. Players may look at their objectives but should keep them secret.



a. **(U)(C) Replacement Objective Decks** (pg. 43)

- **i.** **(C)** If you have *Characters,* **replace** the entire base game objective deck with the deck from *Characters* (even if you are not using the *Characters* expansion). Remove the 2 Fiery Sermon cards and all objectives for expansions you are not using (marked with a U for *Upstairs, Downstair*s or a W for *Wessex* in the top right). **(1P)**: Remove all Majority Bonuses and the Largest Estate, Country Living Estate, and Traditional Estate Tableau Bonuses.
- **ii.** **(U)** If you are using *Upstairs, Downstairs* but you do **not** have *Characters*, **replace** the entire base game objective deck with the deck from *Upstairs, Downstairs*. (If you have *Characters*, use the *Characters* deck regardless of which expansions you are using.)

b. **(X) (5P+)** In an extended **or** 5–6 player game, deal each player **4** objectives instead of 5. (In an extended game, there are more Draw Objective round track events; with 5–6 players, starting with 4 ensures there are enough objectives for everyone.)

10 Family Bonuses:

Each player receives the starting bonus listed on their family board:

Asquith	Add the **Dowager Countess of Asquith** card to your hand.
Cavendish	Advance your reputation marker to **level 1, position 4**.
Ponsonby	Gain **£300**.
York	Add an extra **footman** to your Available Service.
(W) Wessex	Choose 1 of your 2 special **starter tiles** (Tennis Court or Breakfast Room) and add it to your tableau, with the building ( ) side up. Return the other to the box.
(U) Howard	Add a **cook** ( ) to your Available Service.

1.2 CENTRAL PLAY AREA SETUP

1 **Servants for Hire:** Use the table below to fill the Servants for Hire area on the board with the correct number of **servant meeples** for your player count. When finished, return any unused servant meeples to the box (they will not be available this game).

Do **not** include any butlers (dark blue) or housekeepers (red) in Servants for Hire. If you are **not** using ***Upstairs, Downstairs***, ignore the 4 servant types with a **(U)**.


Valets
(1 per player)


Lady's Maids
(1 per player)


Footmen
(2 per player)


Underbutlers
(2 total)


(U) Hall Boys
(1 per player)


(U) Cooks
(1 per player)


(U) Head Housemaids
(1 per player)


(U) Useful Men
(1 per player)

a. **(U)** If players **drafted** an extra servant during Player Setup, then Servants for Hire should already be filled (pg. 14). Continue to step 2.

b. **(1P)** In solo mode, fill Servants for Hire with 2 valets, 2 lady's maids, 4 footmen, 1 underbutler, and 1 of each *Upstairs, Downstairs* servant (if using them).

c. **(5P+)** With **6** players, fill Servants for Hire as if there are **5** players (there will not be enough to add more).

2 **Objective Deck:** Place the objective deck on the board.

a. **(U)** If using the milestones module from *Upstairs, Downstairs* (pg. 49), shuffle the milestone cards and deal **2** face up where everyone can see them. Return the rest to the box. Each player takes the **2** milestone counters with their family's crest and keeps them in their play area. **(1P)** Do not use milestones in solo mode.

3 **Money:** Create supply piles of £100 and £500 coins where everyone can reach. (**Note:** Players do not start with any money, except for the Ponsonby family and the 5th & 6th players in a 5–6 player game, pg. 47).

4 **Guests:** Separately shuffle the **casual guest deck** (⚜) and **prestige guest deck** (⚜ ⚜) and place them on their marked board spaces.

(U) With newer players, remove all **promotional guests** from both decks (marked with a 'P'; see Gentry Card Anatomy, pg. 35). *For details on unusual favours from Promotional Guests, see Appendix B: Gentry Cards, pg. 80.*

5 **Monument Tiles:** Find the **6** monument tiles listed below (for setup, a Monument must be the same on both sides). Choose (or randomly draw) 1 monument per player **plus 1** to use this game and return the rest to the box. Make sure to select at most 1 of the 2 Estate monuments (or neither).











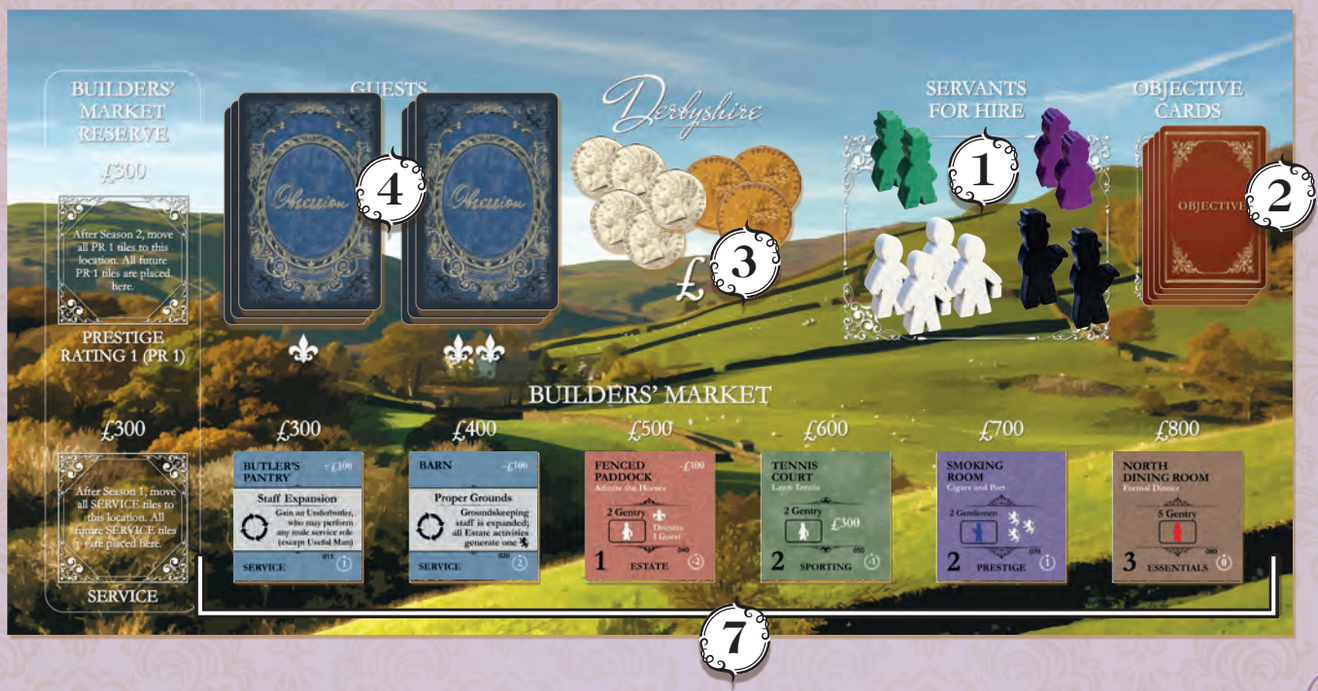


- Imported Marble Floor (Essentials)
- Largest Wine Cellar (Service)
- Manor Gargoyles (Prestige)
- Sculpture Garden (Estate)
- Garden Maze (Estate)
- Big Game Trophy Room (Sporting)

a. **(1P)** **(5P+)** In solo mode, select **3** monuments. With 5–6 players, select **5** monuments.

b. **(U)** If using the **Low VP Monuments** module from *Upstairs, Downstairs* (pg. 48), return **all 6** base game monuments to the box and instead use **all 4** low VP monument tiles, regardless of your player count. **(1P)** Do not use low VP monuments in solo mode.
Note: There is no service monument or Garden Maze monument in the low VP set.

SETUP SHOWN IS FOR A 2-PLAYER, STANDARD-LENGTH GAME



6 **Improvement Tiles:** Gather the selected monuments and all other improvement tiles, mix them up, and place them into the draw bag. (Do not include unused starter tiles.)

(C) **(B)** If you wish to add **promotional tiles** from *Upstairs, Downstairs*; *Characters*; or the Promo Tiles pack (marked with a 'P' or 'B'), limit the number added to the bag as unusual favours may disrupt engine building.

For details on unusual tiles, see Appendix C: Improvement Tiles, pg. 86.



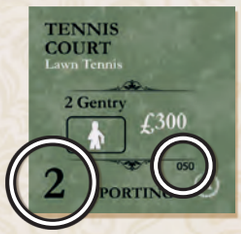
7 **Builders' Market:** Draw tiles from the bag until you have **6 different** improvement tiles that meet **all 3** of these requirements:

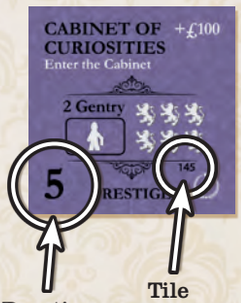
- Tile has a prestige rating (PR) of **3 or lower** (includes tiles with **no** prestige rating)
- Tile is **not** a Servants' Hall
- Tile is **not** a monument (does not show a Monument on both sides)

Set aside all tiles drawn that do **not** qualify and return them to the bag at the end of this step. If you draw a pair of duplicate tiles that **do** qualify, **stack** them together.

When you have drawn the required 6 tiles, **flip over** any tiles with a rose ( ) icon so the icon is no longer visible (leave all other tiles as they were drawn). If a hybrid tile is drawn, the icon with a line under it ( ) shows which side of the tile starts face up. Arrange the tiles on the Builders' Market track from lowest to highest **tile sorting number** (the small 3-digit number in the bottom right) starting at the £300 space. Keep any **duplicates** stacked together in the same space.







ALDERLEY HALL BOARD

8 **Alderley Hall:** Place the Alderley Hall board with the **standard** side up (16 spaces) next to the main board. Place the round marker on '1.'

a. **(X)** In an extended game, flip the Alderley Hall board to the **extended** side (20 spaces).

Designer's Note: *In previous rulebooks, this board was referred to as the 'Round Track board.' I have changed the name here to match the label on the board itself.*

9 **Reminder Tokens:** Place 1 Reminder Token per player above the track (pg. 39).



10 **Theme & VP Cards:** Separately shuffle the theme deck and VP card deck and place them on the marked spaces above Alderley Hall. Reveal **1 theme card** and place it face up above the round track, on the left side. Revealing a theme card at the start of a season is called **open courtship**.

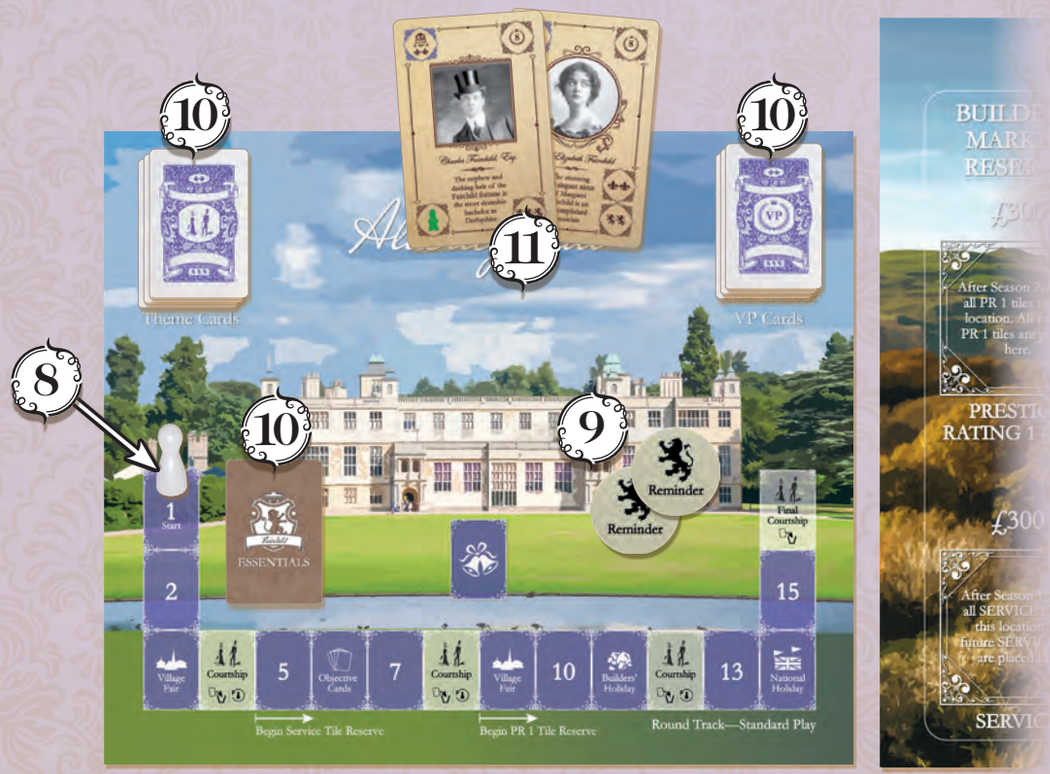
a. **(1P)** In solo mode, do **not** reveal any theme cards. Solo mode uses closed courtship (see 4.11 Jane Austen Closed Courtship Variant, pg. 52.)

b. **(U)** The larger theme & VP card deck in the *Upstairs, Downstairs* expansion can be used in place of the petite cards in the base game.

11 **Fairchilds:** Find the Charles and Elizabeth Fairchild cards (marked with the Fairchild crest top left) and place them face up on Alderley Hall.



a. **(C)** You may use either the base game version of Charles Fairchild or the alternate version from *Characters* (pg. 50).



(C) SIDEBOARD SETUP

If you are **not** using ***Characters***, skip this section.

1. **Sideboard:** Place the sideboard next to the main board on the side with **1** footman under each character's space.
   - **a.** If using the Reserving Characters Variant, pg. 43, instead use the side with **2** footmen under each space.
2. **Characters:** Place the 3 character meeples (Reverend Grantly, Constable Bucket, and the Eccentric Dowager's carriage) on their respective board spaces.
3. **Objectives:** Deal **4** objective cards in a face up pile under Reverend Grantly.
4. **Second Chance Servants:** Fill Higbee's Second Chance Domestics with 1 of **each type** of second chance (SC) servant **per player** (including footmen). Return unused second chance servants to the box.
   - **a.** **(5P+)** With **6** players, fill Higbee's with **5** SC servants of each type.
5. **Dowager's Exiles:** Find the 4 guest cards marked as **Exiles** (Agata, Baroness Svensdotter; Count Vladimir Antonoff; Major Friedrich Stoll; and Lady Sophie Mayer).
   Pile them face up under the Eccentric Dowager, in any order.
   - **a.** **(U)** If you have *Upstairs, Downstairs* (even if not using it), add the following promotional guests to the Eccentric Dowager's pile:
     - **i.** Sir Charles Fitzwilliam, Bt.
     - **ii.** Sir Alastair Leese, Bt.
     - **iii.** (Optional) Aston Webb
     - **iv.** (Optional) Freifrau von Ludwigstorff

Designer's Note: *Aston Webb and Freifrau von Ludwigstorff are overpowered promotional guests, but both add compelling powers for aiding a player in desperate need. Using them always spices up a game.*

SETUP SHOWN IS FOR A 2-PLAYER, STANDARD-LENGTH GAME



1.3 EXPANDED FAMILY DRAFT

An expanded family draft allows each player to further customise their family by selecting additional starting options. Note that an expanded draft is required when using certain expansion content, such as supplemental servants from *Upstairs, Downstairs*.

> **Designer's Note:** *Previous expansions added multiple layers of drafting that became unwieldy when used together. For this rulebook, I have attempted to standardise the draft to accommodate playing with multiple expansions and/or setup variants. Note that the new 'extra servant draft' below replaces the 'short servant draft' from the* Upstairs, Downstairs *rulebook.*

PREPARING THE DRAFT

Before starting the draft, collectively decide which of the following **starting options** players will add to the family board draft. Then follow the steps to prepare the **draft pool** for each selected option.

EXTRA SERVANT DRAFT

Required when using supplemental servants from Upstairs, Downstairs *(pg. 31).*

- **What is it?** Each player drafts 1 extra servant to add to their standard 5 starting servants.
- **Why use it?** Increases family **asymmetry** and expands access to the 4 new servant types.
- **Setup:** Populate Servants for Hire as you normally would in step 1 of Central Play Area setup (pg. 10). Then take **1 servant of each type** from Servants for Hire (except an underbutler) to create the servant draft pool.

Note: *In a 4+ player game* ***without*** Upstairs, Downstairs*, add +1 footman, +1 valet, and +1 lady's maid to the draft pool.*

STARTER GUEST DRAFT

- **What is it?** Each player drafts their 2 starter guests (instead of drawing them at random).
- **Why use it?** Gives more control over the guests players start with, so they can consider the best favours, servant requirements, and distribution of genders.
- **Setup:** Sort through the casual guest deck and take out all starter guests (♔). Shuffle them and draw 2 guests per player plus 2 more. Deal them face up to create the starter guest pool. *Alternatively, see Starter Guests FAQ, pg. 78.*

(C) DISTINGUISHED FAMILY DRAFT

Requires the Distinguished Family Members (DFM) module from Characters *(pg. 50).*

- **What is it?** Each player selects 1 of their family members to become 'distinguished' and gain enhanced favours.
- **Why use it?** Provides each player with a unique set of family members to pursue asymmetric strategies.
- **Setup:** Lay out the Asquith family's **5 Distinguished Family Member cards** (DFMs) face up to create the DFM draft pool (these will act as placeholders during the draft).

Note: *In a 2-player game, players may opt to draft* ***2 DFMs*** *each (see DFM 2–Player Variant, pg. 50).*

DRAFT TURNS

Players perform a 2-round **snake draft**. Starting with the **first player** and going clockwise, each player chooses to draft either their family board **or** their additional starting option(s). Then, starting with the **last player** and going anticlockwise, each player drafts whatever they did **not** draft the first time.

If players draft **extra servants**, each player places their extra servant in Available Service. If players draft **starter guests**, each player adds their starter guests to their hand (as they normally would during step 8).

If players draft **DFMs**, each player (except Asquith) exchanges the Asquith DFM they drafted for the matching card from their own family's set of DFMs. They add their DFM to their starting hand and remove the ordinary version of that family member from the game.

DRAFT CLEANUP

After the draft, return all undrafted servants to **Servants for Hire** and shuffle all undrafted starter guests back into the **casual guest deck** (including those in the pool and those that weren't dealt). Return all undrafted DFMs and all ordinary family members that were replaced to the game box.

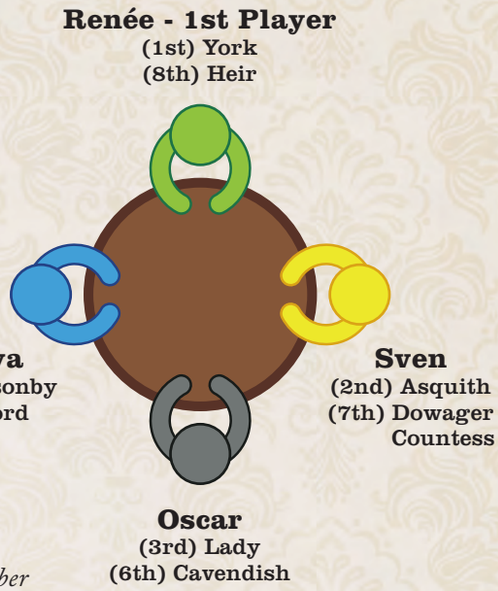


EXAMPLE: DISTINGUISHED FAMILY DRAFT

Renée, Sven, Oscar, and Mariya are choosing Family Boards and Distinguished Family Members. Renée is the 1st player in turn order, so she chooses first. They are playing with only the Characters *expansion, so the Howard and Wessex families aren't available.*

- *1st: Renée takes Family York.*
- *2nd: Sven takes Family Asquith.*
- *3rd: Oscar doesn't have a preference between the remaining 2 families, so he takes the distinguished Lady instead.*
- *4th & 5th: Mariya is last in turn order, so she makes both her selections at once. She takes Family Ponsonby and the distinguished Lord.*
- *6th: Oscar takes the remaining family, Cavendish.*
- *7th: Sven, because he chose Asquith, takes the distinguished Dowager Countess.*
- *8th: Only the distinguished Heir and Daughter are left. Renée takes the Heir.*

Each player now swaps their distinguished Asquith card for the matching member of their own family, then takes their remaining ordinary family cards. All unused distinguished and ordinary family return to the box.



BALANCING MULTIPLE OPTIONS

When drafting **2 or more** starting options, players may elect to split up their 2 draft turns in a more balanced way, using the table to the right.

When using this format, each player must use 1 turn to draft the options in the **Turn A column**, and 1 turn to draft the options in the **Turn B column**, but may do so in either order.

Starting Options			Draft Turns	
Extra Servant	Starter Guests	DFM	Turn A	Turn B
✓	✓	X	Family + 1 Starter Guest	Servant + 1 Starter Guest
✓	X	✓	Family + DFM	Servant
X	✓	✓	Family + 1 Starter Guest	DFM + 1 Starter Guest
✓	✓	✓	Family + DFM	Servant + 2 Starter Guests

ADDITIONAL RULES (1.3 EXPANDED FAMILY DRAFT)

- **(U) Howard Family & Servants:** Each player is limited to 1 supplemental servant of each type (pg. 31). This means that a player who drafts the Howard family may **not** draft a cook as their extra servant (or vice versa).
- **(U) (C) Howard Family & DFMs:** The Howard family has no DFM cards. This is intended to balance their powerful family bonus. If a player drafts the Howard family, they do **not** draft a DFM. Do not use the Howard family with the DFM 2-player variant (pg. 50).
- **(C) DFM Dowager:** In a DFM draft, you may **only** draft the Dowager Countess if you have already drafted the Asquith family. (If the draft allows you to select a family and DFM at the same time, you may draft them together.)
- **(5P+) (U) (W)** In a 6-player game, the Asquith player **must** select the Distinguished Dowager Countess, otherwise there will not be enough unique DFMs. This is also true in a 5-player game where the Wessex family is used but Howard is not.

CHAPTER 2. PLAYING THE GAME



OUR STORY

Six of Derbyshire's respectable families—each possessed of eligible young gentlemen and ladies—find themselves embroiled in romance and intrigue during a time of optimism. Though they have long and storied histories in the county, the difficulties of the late 18th century have left the families Asquith, Cavendish, Howard, Ponsonby, Wessex, and York with neglected country estates and tarnished reputations. Now, in the mid-19th, they have coincidentally come into new sources of income, and are intent on restoring their family names.

The arrival of Charles and Elizabeth Fairchild—both eligible, refined, and substantially wealthy—into a relatively modest corner of Derbyshire engages the minds, hearts, and conversation of every member of the social elite within a day's ride by carriage.

Seeking to fortify their good fortune, the six families aim to impress the eminent Fairchild dowagers in their grand estate at Alderley Hall. A match between one of the families and the newcomers Charles and Elizabeth would be the talk of Derbyshire. But to attract the Fairchilds' attentions, each family must devise a plan to invest their modest new funds, sway the opinions of the local gentry, and win back the esteem of high society.

2.1 OVERVIEW

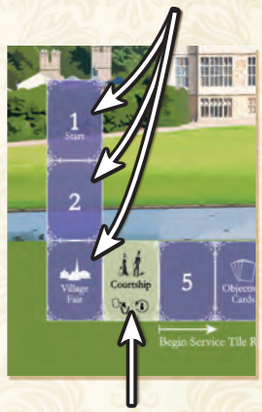
In *Obsession*, each player takes the helm of a 19th-century family striving to improve their diminished social standing. Over the course of the game, you'll use your family members and domestic servants to expand your country estate, host a variety of influential guests, and strive to secure a match with the prestigious Fairchild family. At the end of the game, you score **victory points (VP)** for your progress across a variety of categories. The player who scores the most total VP wins the game.

2.2 SEASONS & ROUNDS

The game is divided into **4 seasons**.
Each season is made up of **3 game rounds**, followed by a **courtship event**.

- During each game round, each player takes **1 turn**, starting with the first player and going clockwise. After the last player's turn, the **round marker** advances 1 space.
- When the marker reaches a **courtship event**, players determine who claims a Fairchild card for the following season. Players **do not** rotate service, take Monument reputation, use the Servants' Hall, or take any turns during a courtship round. **Only the courtship event is resolved**. After the courtship event ends, players move on to the next season.
- After the 4th and final courtship event, the round marker is placed on the space with wedding bells and players add up their VP to determine the winner.

Game Rounds



Courtship Event

(X) EXTENDED GAME SEASONS

When using the 'Extended' side of the Alderley Hall board, each season has **4** game rounds instead of 3. This means each player will take **16 turns** during the game, instead of the 12 they take in a standard-length game.

2.3 PLAYER TURNS

On your turn, you do 1 of the following:

A. Host an Activity (pg. 17)

B. Pass (pg. 21)

You may also take any number of **special actions** at any time on your turn. See Special Actions, pg. 27 for details.

2.4 HOSTING AN ACTIVITY

On most of your turns, you will host an activity, following the steps below. Each step is explained in detail over the following sections.

ORDER OF PLAY (HOSTING AN ACTIVITY)

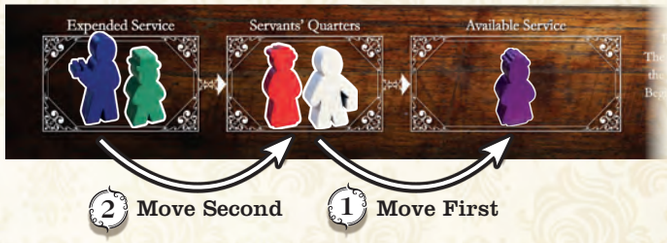
1. **Rotate Service (pg. 17):** Move all servants in Expended Service and Servants' Quarters 1 space to the right.
2. **Check Round Track, Monuments, and Servants' Hall (pg. 17):** If there is an event icon on the current space of the round track, resolve the event now. Also resolve any relevant ongoing effects ( ) on improvement tiles in your tableau.
3. **Choose Activity (pg. 18):** Select an improvement tile from your tableau that lists an activity you want to host and place it in the Activity space on your family board.
4. **Invite Gentry (pg. 18):** Play the number and type of gentry cards required for the activity from your hand.
5. **Provide Service (pg. 18):** Place available servants on the tile and gentry you played to fulfill their service needs.
6. **Enjoy Favours (pg. 19):** Gain reputation, money, and other benefits from the tile and gentry you played.
7. **Buy from Market (pg. 20):** Optionally purchase 1 new improvement tile from the Builders' Market and add it to your tableau.
8. **Clear Board (pg. 20):** Place the servants you used in Expended Service and the gentry you played in your discard pile. Upgrade the tile you used (if possible) and return it to your tableau. If you are the last player in turn order, advance the round marker.

Designer's Note: *For these rules, I have slightly altered the names of steps 3 and 4 from what is printed on the player boards to address some rules ambiguity. However, I have kept the term 'invite' for both playing gentry during an activity and acquiring new guests (pg. 18-19), as changing this would create too much inconsistency with previous rulebooks and components.*

ROTATE SERVICE

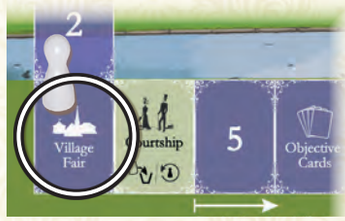
If all your servants are already in **Available Service** at the start of your turn, skip this step.

If any of your servants are in **Servants' Quarters** or **Expended Service**, move each of them 1 space to the right. (**Note:** Move your servants in Servants' Quarters first, so you don't accidentally move an expended servant 2 spaces.)



CHECK ROUND TRACK, MONUMENTS, AND SERVANTS' HALL

First, if there is an **event icon** on the current space of the round track, resolve the corresponding event from the table below.



ROUND TRACK EVENTS

Village Fair: If you have upgraded your Private Study tile, immediately gain £300 and 2 reputation.

Draw Objectives: Draw 2 objective cards, secretly look at them, and keep them face down with your other objectives.

Builders' Holiday: When buying improvement tiles this turn, you may buy any number of tiles. See 3.5 The Builders' Market & Reserve, pg. 40 for details.

National Holiday: When hosting an activity this turn, you may ignore prestige ratings on all your improvement tiles and gentry cards. See Prestige Ratings, pg. 26 for details.

Then, if you have any improvement tiles with **ongoing effects** (↻) that are resolved during this step, such as a Monument, Servants' Hall, or Business Room **(U)(C)**, resolve them now, in any order. See Ongoing Effect Improvements, pg. 39 for details.



CHOOSE ACTIVITY

Choose an **improvement tile** from your tableau with an activity you wish to host and place it on the Activity space of your board. You must choose a tile with an **activity** listed under its name (not an ongoing effect ↻ tile, such as a Monument; pg. 39), and your **reputation level** must be equal to or higher than the **prestige rating (PR)** on the chosen tile (pg. 26).

INVITE GENTRY

Play the **gentry cards** you wish to invite to your activity from your hand. You must play the **exact** number and type of gentry required for your activity as indicated on the improvement tile, and your **reputation level** must be equal to or higher than the **prestige rating** on each gentry card you play (pg. 26).

> **Critical Rule:** You may take actions during the **Choose Activity** and **Invite Gentry** steps (and all later steps) that cause your reputation level to fall below the Prestige Rating (PR) on your activity tile and/or gentry cards (see Special Actions, pg. 27 and the Reputation FAQ example, pg. 77).

GENTRY TYPES

Activities may require the following types of gentry:

- **Gentry:** Any guest or family member
- **Gentlemen:** Any *male* guest or family member
- **Ladies:** Any *female* guest or family member
- **Casual Guests** (⚜): Only casual guests
- **Prestige Guests** (⚜⚜): Only prestige guests
- **Family:** Only family members

(U) (C) MODIFYING REQUIREMENTS

Some effects increase or reduce the number of gentry required to attend an activity, such as the Carriage House from *Upstairs, Downstairs* (pg. 89) or the Eccentric Dowager from *Characters* (pg. 44). When multiple such effects are used during the same activity, they are added together. However, the number of gentry required for an activity can never be 0 (see Tiles FAQ, pg. 79).

PROVIDE SERVICE

Place an available **servant** of the correct type on each **service need icon** on the improvement tile and gentry cards you played.

Each servant must come from **Available Service** and must match the icon they are placed on (or use a substitution ability; pg. 29).

EXAMPLE: INVITING GENTRY & PROVIDING SERVICE



The Ponsonby player decides to host an indoor constitutional at their Gabled Conservatory. Their reputation level is 3, so they can use this tile.

An indoor constitutional at the Gabled Conservatory requires 3 ladies. The Ponsonby player decides to invite 1 family member, 1 casual guest, and 1 prestige guest, all female. Again, they confirm their reputation level is high enough to invite the Viscountess Abernathy, with a prestige rating of 3.



No service needs

The Ponsonby player must provide service on their Conservatory and guests. They place their butler on the tile and a lady's maid on Miss Katherine. Since they have no more lady's maids, they may use their housekeeper's service ability to substitute for a lady's maid (pg. 29) and place her on the Viscountess. Lady Ponsonby herself has no service needs.

SERVICE SUBSTITUTIONS

Certain highly trained servants have **service abilities** that allow them to 'fill in' for other servant types. For example, a housekeeper may fill a lady's maid requirement on a tile or guest, provided you have no lady's maids available (pg. 29-30).

SERVICE HELP

If you are short on servants to host an activity, you may use the Service Help special action to immediately refresh 1 or more of your servants in Servants' Quarters at a cost of **3 reputation** each, even if it lowers your reputation level below the prestige ratings of your tile and guests. See Special Actions, pg. 27.

UNABLE TO HOST AN ACTIVITY

If you are not able to fulfill **all** the requirements of an activity—including having a high enough reputation level, having the required gentry in hand, and having the correct servants available—you may **not** host the activity. You must either choose a different activity to host, or pass. In the event you cannot host any activity in your tableau, you **must** pass.

ENJOY FAVOURS

You are now ready to enjoy the fruits of your labour. Gain all **favours** shown on the improvement tile and on each gentry card you played.

Favours are benefits you earn from hosting an activity, such as reputation, money, or new guest invites. They appear on the bottom right of gentry cards and on the right of most improvement tiles with activities.

You may enjoy favours in any order (with the exception of negative favours, which **must** be enjoyed after positive favours; pg. 36). Most favours are mandatory; only favours that use the term 'may,' such as dismissal favours, are optional.

EXAMPLE: ENJOY FAVOURS



The Ponsonby player earns a total of 3 reputation and £100 from their invited gentry. The Conservatory lets them draw 4 new casual guests, choose 2 to keep, and return the others to the bottom of the deck. The Lady Ponsonby provides 2 options: either draw 2 casual guests and choose 1, or permanently dismiss 1 guest. The player decides to dismiss a guest with a negative VP value from their discard pile.

COMMON FAVOURS

Reputation: Gain 1 reputation per icon.

Money: Gain the amount of money shown.

Invite Casual Guest: Draw 1 guest card from the casual deck, reveal it to all players, and add it to your hand.

Invite Prestige Guest: Draw 1 guest card from the prestige deck, reveal it to all players, and add it to your hand.

Screen Guests: Draw 2 guest cards from the casual guest deck and choose 1 to reveal and add to your hand. Dismiss the other. See Screening Guests, pg. 36. (Favours of this type may allow you to draw more than 2 guests and/or choose more than 1 to keep; these numbers will be given on the card or tile.)

Dismiss Guest: You may choose any 1 guest card from your hand, activity, or discard pile and place it on the bottom of the appropriate deck. See Dismissing Guests, pg. 36.

VP Card: Draw 1 VP card, look at it, and place it face down with your objectives. You may discard it at any time to gain its benefit, or keep it until end game scoring to score its VP. See VP cards, pg. 42.

Return Gentry: You may return any 1 gentry card of your choice from your discard pile to your hand. (If a specific gentry type is listed, e.g., 'family only,' you must return a card of that type.)

For unique favours on guests and tiles, see: Appendix B: Gentry Cards, pg. 80 and Appendix C: Improvement Tiles, pg. 86.





BUY FROM THE MARKET

You may buy **1** new improvement tile from the Builders' Market, paying the **market price** printed on the board above the tile plus the **price modifier** printed on the tile itself, if it has one. Place the tile in the correct column of your tableau, without flipping it.

After buying a tile, refill the Market by sliding tiles left to fill the empty space then drawing a new tile from the bag and placing it in the rightmost space. See Refilling The Builders' Market, pg. 41 for additional rules.

EXAMPLE: BUY FROM THE MARKET

The Ponsonby player wants to purchase the Fenced Paddock improvement tile from the market. The tile costs £400 (£500–£100).

Then, they slide the remaining tiles left to fill the space and draw a replacement from the bag.



Fenced Paddock costs £400 total



DUPLICATE TILES

All tiles in your tableau must always be **unique**; you may never buy a tile you already have (pg. 40). If there is a stack of duplicate tiles in the Builders' Market, each tile in the stack has the same price. If you buy a tile from a duplicate stack, do not refill the Market (since there is no empty space).

BUYING FROM THE RESERVE

If there are tiles in the Builders' Reserve, you may choose to buy any tile from the Reserve instead of the Market. All Reserve tiles have a market price of **£300** plus any price modifier, if applicable. See Buying From The Reserve, pg. 40 for details.

CLEAR BOARD

At the end of your turn, follow these steps to clean up your activity:

1. **Expend Servants:** Place all servants you used this turn in Expended Service.
2. **Discard Gentry:** Place all gentry cards you played in your personal discard pile.
3. **Upgrade & Return Tile:** Return the improvement tile you played to the appropriate column of your tableau.
   - If the tile does not have a visible upgrade icon ( ), flip it over to upgrade it.
   - If playing a hybrid tile (/), flip it to the opposite side (as if upgrading it) and place it in the column matching its new category.
   - **(U)(C)(B)** If playing a tile that flips ( ), flip it to the opposite side.

   See Upgrading Improvements, pg. 39.
4. **Advance Round Marker:** If you are the **last player** in turn order, advance the round marker 1 space. If not, skip this step.

2.5 PASSING

Passing allows you to return all **gentry cards** from your discard pile and fully **refresh** all of your servants. To pass, follow the steps below in order.

ORDER OF PLAY (PASSING)

1. **Refresh Service:** Move all of your servants directly to Available Service.
2. **Return Gentry:** Return all gentry cards from your personal discard pile to your hand.
3. **Check Round Track, Monuments, and Servants' Hall:** Resolve this step as you would when hosting an activity (pg. 17).
4. **Passing Benefit:** Receive 1 of the available passing benefits (see below).
5. **Buy from Market:** Resolve this step as you would when hosting an activity (pg. 20).
6. **Advance Round Marker:** If you are the **last player** in turn order, advance the round marker 1 space. If not, skip this step.

PASSING BENEFITS

When you pass, instead of enjoying favours, you receive 1 of the following passing benefits:

PASSING BENEFITS	
Collect £200	Gain £200.
Refresh Builders' Market	Clear all tiles from the Builders' Market and refill it from the bag. See Refreshing The Builders' Market, pg. 41 for details.
(U) (C) Hire Servants	Expend your butler (or underbutler) to hire servants with your Butler's Room tile, then upgrade your Butler's Room, if you haven't already.

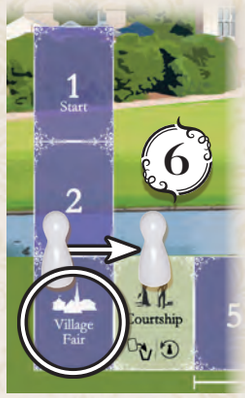
HIRING WHEN PASSING

The **Hire Servants** passing benefit was introduced in *Upstairs, Downstairs* and enhanced in *Characters*. It is required when using either expansion. Players can opt to include it as a variant rule when playing the base game. See the Hiring When Passing, pg. 30 for details.

EXAMPLE: PASS TURN

The Cavendish player passes on their turn.

1. *All of their servants move to Available Service.*
2. *They return all their gentry cards to their hand.*
3. *Resolving the Village Fair space on the Alderley Hall board earns them £300 and 2 since their Private Study is upgraded (side). They place a lady's maid on the Servants' Hall to steal 1 from another player.*
4. *They choose to receive £200 as a passing benefit.*
5. *They purchase an English Garden from the Market.*
6. *As the last player in the turn order, they advance the round marker.*





(C) INVITING CHARACTERS

When using the *Characters* expansion, you may also invite a sideboard character during a pass turn. This is done between steps 3 and 4 in the Order of Play. Inviting a character may affect which passing benefits you can choose. See Inviting A Character, pg. 43.

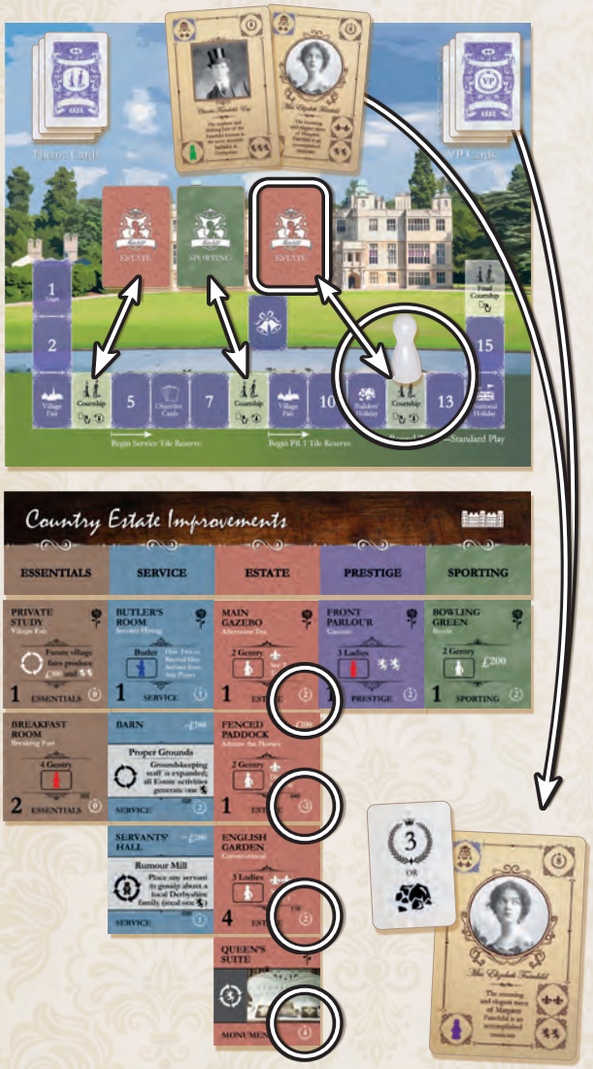
2.6 COURTSHIP & END OF SEASON

The arrival of Charles and Elizabeth Fairchild—both eligible, refined, and substantially wealthy—into a relatively modest corner of Derbyshire engages the minds, hearts, and conversation of every member of the social elite within a day's ride by carriage.

Each season ends with a courtship event, where one Derbyshire family is given the opportunity for their son or daughter to court one of the young Fairchilds. The winning family receives a Fairchild card of their choice for the following season, along with a VP card.

EXAMPLE: SCORE THEME

This is the third season of the game, so 3 theme cards have been revealed so far. For the current season, only the Estate improvements are scored:



The winning player's Estate improvements are worth 2+(-2)+2+4 = 6 points. They draw a VP card and choose a Fairchild card to add to their hand.

COURTSHIP EVENTS

Each time the round marker reaches a courtship space, follow the steps below to resolve a courtship event.

ORDER OF PLAY (COURTSHIP EVENT)

1. **Return Fairchilds:** Place both Fairchild cards on the Alderley Hall board, if they are not already there.
2. **Score Theme:** The theme card revealed at the start of the season determines which category of improvement tiles is used to score this event. Each player adds up the total VP value of their improvement tiles that match the theme to get their theme score. (**Note:** Tiles with negative VP values that match the theme reduce your theme score.)
3. **Winner:** The player with the highest theme score is the winner. They draw 1 VP card and take 1 Fairchild card of their choice from Alderley Hall, adding it to their hand.
4. **Discard Objectives:** Each player chooses 1 of their objective cards and discards it face down (pg. 42). Shuffle the discarded objectives and place them on the bottom of the objective deck.

COURTSHIP TIES

If 2 or more players **tie** for highest theme score during a courtship event, each tied player draws 1 VP card, and **no one** takes a Fairchild card.

COURTSHIP REWARDS

When you draw a **VP card**, you may either immediately reveal and discard it to gain its printed benefit or keep it face down with your objective cards. If you keep it, you may either discard it for its benefit on a later turn or keep it until the end of the game to score its VP value. See VP cards, pg. 42 for more detail.

Charles and Elizabeth Fairchild are **prestige guests** who may be played, discarded, and returned the same as your other guest cards. However, like family members, the Fairchilds have **no prestige rating** and may be played at any reputation level (see Appendix B: Gentry Cards, pg. 80).

At the start of each courtship, the winner of the previous courtship must return to Alderley Hall the Fairchild card they took (whether they are in the player's hand or discard pile). In order to score the **VP** on a Fairchild card, you must win them during the **final courtship event** (pg. 23).

END OF SEASON

After each of the first 3 courtship events, follow the steps below to set up for the next season.

ORDER OF PLAY (END OF SEASON)

1. **Open Reserve:** Check whether to move any improvement tiles from the Builders' Market to the Builders' Reserve (see Opening The Reserve, pg. 40):
   a. **End of Season 1:** Move all Service tiles to the Reserve. (**Note:** Never move the Largest Wine Cellar service monument to the Reserve.)
   b. **End of Season 2:** Move all tiles with prestige rating 1 (PR1) to the Reserve.
2. **Refresh Market:** Clear all remaining tiles from the Builders' Market and refill it from the bag. See Refreshing The Builders' Market, pg. 41.
3. **New Seasonal Theme (Open Courtship):** Reveal a new theme card. Place it face up on the Alderley Hall board, to the right of the previous theme card.
4. **Pass First Player Marker:** Pass the first player marker anticlockwise.
5. **Advance Round Marker:** Advance the round marker 1 space and start the first round of the new season.

Designer's Note: *In previous rulebooks, refreshing the Builders' Market at the end of each season has been included as the optional variant, called the Emily Brontë Seasonal Market variant. Based on continued testing and community feedback, I now feel this should be included as the default option during the game to prevent market stagnation. Of course, players may choose to skip this step if they prefer a stable market.*

FINAL COURTSHIP

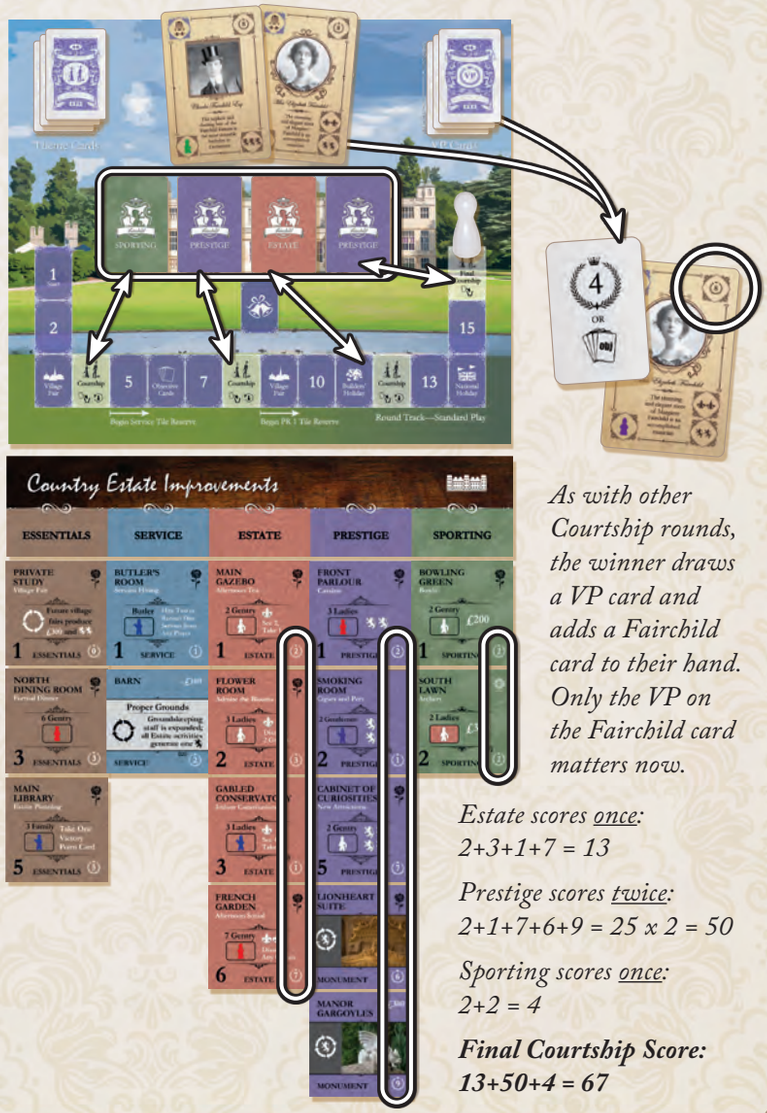
During the 4th and final courtship event of the game, the young Fairchilds look back on the past year and, with the approval of the Dowager Countess Fairchild, declare their intentions!

Instead of scoring the seasonal theme normally, each player adds up the VP values of their improvement tiles in **all** categories on the 4 theme cards revealed during the game. If any 2 face up theme cards show the **same** category, each player counts **double** the VP value of their tiles in that category. The player with the highest total wins the final courtship.

The winner takes a VP card as well as a Fairchild card, adding it to their hand to be scored later. **If there is a tie**, the player with the highest reputation level wins the final courtship (the position of your reputation marker around your wheel does not matter). If still tied, no one takes a Fairchild card.

After the final courtship event, players have a last chance to take **special actions** and/or discard any of their **VP cards** to gain their printed benefits, if possible. See VP cards, pg. 42.

EXAMPLE: FINAL COURTSHIP SCORING



As with other Courtship rounds, the winner draws a VP card and adds a Fairchild card to their hand. Only the VP on the Fairchild card matters now.

Estate scores <u>once</u>:
2+3+1+7 = 13

Prestige scores <u>twice</u>:
2+1+7+6+9 = 25 x 2 = 50

Sporting scores <u>once</u>:
2+2 = 4

Final Courtship Score:
13+50+4 = 67

2.7 GAME END & SCORING

After resolving the final courtship event, move the round marker to the central Wedding Bells space on the round track, and use the scorepad to record each player's total score in each VP category. The player with the highest total VP is the winner.

END GAME SCORING

Players add up their final VP as follows:

VP SOURCES	
Improvement Tile VP	Score the total VP on all **improvement tiles** in your tableau. Tiles with negative VP values reduce your score.
Gentry VP	Score the total VP on all **gentry cards** in your hand and discard pile. If you claimed a Fairchild during final courtship, include their VP value. Guests with negative VP values reduce your score.
Objective VP	Reveal and score your remaining **objective cards**. See Objective cards, pg. 42. **(U)** Score milestones in this category (pg. 49).
Reputation VP	Score VP based on your final **reputation level** using the table, right.
Service VP	Score 2 VP per **servant** in your employ. Count servants of all types (except second chance servants from *Characters*; pg. 34).
Wealth	Score 1 VP per **£200** you have, rounding down.
VP Cards	Reveal and score your unused VP cards, if you have any. See VP cards, pg. 42.

REPUTATION VP

Each player scores the following VP based on their reputation level. The position of your reputation marker around your wheel does not affect your score.

Reputation Level	VP
1	1
2	3
3	6
4	10
5	15
6	21
7 (Max)	28
8	36
9 (Max)	45

(X) EXTENDED GAME REPUTATION

Reputation levels 8 and 9 are only used (and scored) in an extended game.

END GAME TIEBREAKERS

If multiple players tie for victory, the tied player who claimed a **Fairchild card** during final courtship wins the game.

If none of the tied players have a Fairchild, the tied player with the **highest reputation level** wins (the position of your reputation marker around your wheel is ignored). If this still does not break the tie, the tied players share their victory.



EXAMPLE: END GAME SCORING



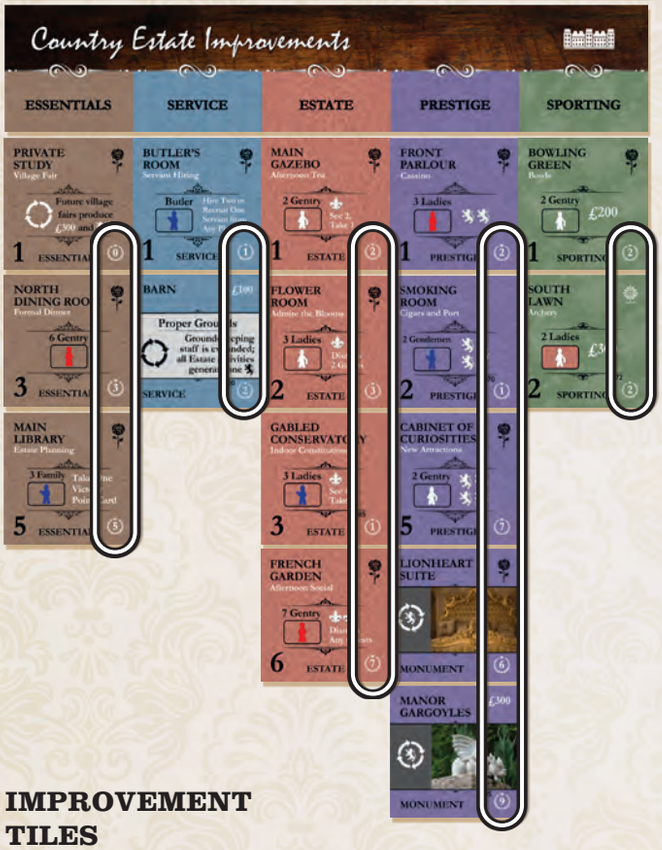
REPUTATION



*1+2+3+4+5 = **15VP** (see Reputation VP, pg. 24)*

SERVICE

*2VP Per Servant = **18VP***



GENTRY CARDS

In Hand or Discard Pile





Casual & Prestige Guests : (-1)+0+1+2+2+4 = 8

Family Members: 3+2+2+1 = 8

Fairchild = 8

Total: 24VP

IMPROVEMENT TILES

Essentials: 0+3+5 = 8

Service: 1+2 = 3

Estate: 2+3+1+7 = 13

Prestige: 2+1+7+6+9 = 25

Sporting: 2+2 = 4

Total: 8+3+13+25+4 = 53VP

OBJECTIVE CARDS



Total: 5+5+0 = 10VP

WEALTH

1VP per £200, Rounded Down



Total: £1300 = 6VP

VP CARDS



Total: 3+4 = 7VP

Obsession	D
Improvement Tile VP	53
Gentry VP (net of + and – VP)	24
Subtotal	77
Objective and Milestone VP	10
Reputation VP (See Reputation VP, Glossary)	15
Subtotal	102
Service VP (2 VP per servant)	18
Wealth (1 VP per £200)	6
Subtotal	126
VP Cards	7
GRAND TOTAL	133

The Ponsonby player has a total score of 133VP!

CHAPTER 3: RULES DETAIL

3.1 REPUTATION & WEALTH

GAINING & SPENDING MONEY



£500



£100

Money is primarily spent to purchase **improvement tiles**. Any money you gain during the game is taken from the supply, and any money you spend is returned to the supply. You can never take any action that costs more **money** than you have. The amount of money you have must be kept **public** at all times. You may exchange money for different denominations from the supply at any time. You cannot give money to or receive money from other players, except in Team Mode (pg. 64) and Cooperative Mode (see Assisting Allies, pg. 74). **The money in the supply is intended to be unlimited; in the rare event you run out, you may use a proxy**.

GAINING & LOSING REPUTATION

The face up counter in the middle of your reputation wheel shows your current **reputation level**. This level determines the improvement tiles and gentry cards you can play (see right) and is worth VP at the end of the game (pg. 24).

The position of your **reputation marker** around your wheel shows how close you are to reaching the next reputation level. Whenever you gain reputation, move your marker 1 position clockwise around the wheel per icon shown. If your marker advances past position 5 and back to 1, immediately increase your **reputation level** by 1 (by flipping over or removing the top counter on the stack).

You can also **lose** reputation during the game. When this happens, move your marker 1 space anticlockwise per – icon shown. If your marker falls below position 1 and back to position 5, immediately decrease your reputation level by 1, if possible.



Gaining 1 while at 5 advances the reputation marker to position 1 and flips over the reputation counter.

PRESTIGE RATINGS

In order to play an improvement tile or guest card, your reputation level must be at least equal to the prestige rating (PR) on the tile or card. Each guest's prestige rating is shown in the top left, and each improvement's prestige rating is shown in the bottom left. (**Note:** Family members and Fairchild cards do not have prestige ratings and may be played at any reputation level; see Appendix B: Gentry Cards, pg. 80.)



An improvement or guest's prestige rating only affects whether you can play them during your turn. You can draw new guests and purchase new improvements of any prestige rating, and you score VP for all guests and improvements you have at the end of the game, regardless of prestige rating (see End Game Scoring, pg. 24).





The Ponsonby player purchases the Hillside Kennels (above), which has a prestige rating of 3. Since their current reputation level is only 2, they cannot play it until their reputation level reaches 3.

NATIONAL HOLIDAY

During a National Holiday round track event (pg. 17), you may **ignore** prestige ratings on all guest cards and improvement tiles. This means you may play any tile in your tableau and any guests in your hand regardless of your reputation level, provided you have the required servants.

MODIFYING PRESTIGE RATINGS

Some effects temporarily reduce the prestige rating on guests or improvement tiles, allowing you to play them at a lower reputation level. For example, the **useful man** from *Upstairs, Downstairs* can be used to play a tile 1 level above your current reputation (pg. 33).



MINIMUM & MAXIMUM REPUTATION

MINIMUM REPUTATION

Your reputation cannot fall below **level 1, position 1**. While at minimum reputation, you ignore any further reputation loss. You may still play guests or activity tiles with negative reputation favours, ignoring those favours (pg. 36). You cannot be targeted by opponent actions that reduce your reputation, such as gossip favours (see Servants' Hall, pg. 101).

(C) *CHARACTERS*
REPUTATION PENALTIES

When using *Characters*, you may use second chance servants (pg. 34) or invite Constable Bucket (pg. 44) even if you do not have enough reputation to pay their reputation penalties.

MAXIMUM REPUTATION

In a standard-length game, the maximum reputation you can attain is **level 7, position 5**. Level 7 is represented by your 'Max' counter. While at maximum reputation, you may immediately spend any additional reputation you gain to take **special actions** (see right). Any excess reputation you do not spend this way is lost.

(X) EXTENDED GAME REPUTATION

In an extended game, each player's **maximum reputation** level is increased to **9** by adding an extra 7/8 reputation counter (see step 4 on pg. 8).

SPECIAL ACTIONS

In moments of need, you can trade your family's hard-won reputation to call in immediate favours from your Derbyshire connections. This is called taking a **special action**.

You may take a special action at any time during your turn, either when hosting an activity or passing. For each special action you take, you **lose** the indicated amount of reputation.

You may take Borrow Money and Service Help actions **any number** of times each turn, provided you have enough reputation, but you may only take the Refresh Market special action **once** per turn, no matter how much reputation you have. While you are at minimum reputation, you may **not** take special actions for any reason.

SPECIAL ACTIONS

Borrow Money	Lose 2 reputation ( ) to gain £100.
Service Help	Lose 3 reputation ( ) to move any 1 of your servants from Servants' Quarters to Available Service.
Refresh Market	Lose 4 reputation ( ) to clear all tiles from the Builders' Market and refill it from the bag. See Refreshing The Builders' Market, pg. 41.



3.2 SERVANTS

The servant meeples on your family board represent the domestic staff who maintain your estate and see to the needs of visiting guests.

Each player starts with a modest number of servants and can hire more during the game using their **Butler's Room** improvement tile (pg. 88).

COMMON & UNIQUE SERVANTS

Common servants are the rank and file domestics who maintain your estate and provide for your guests. They include **footmen**, **valets**, and **lady's maids**. You may have any number of common servants in your employ, though the total number in the game is determined during setup when populating Servants for Hire (step 1 on pg. 10). Common servants are known to seek opportunities elsewhere and can be **recruited** to work for other players who have upgraded their Butler's Room (pg. 88).

Unique servants are senior staff who fulfill essential roles in your household. They include your **butler** and **housekeeper**, as well as your **underbutler**, if you have hired one. You may only have 1 servant of each unique type. Once you have acquired a unique servant, they will not leave your employ for any reason.

COMMON SERVANTS

FOOTMEN



Wait on family and guests at table and out of doors, transport food from the kitchen to the dining rooms, announce visitors, wind clocks, and perform a wide variety of tasks necessary to keep an estate running smoothly.

- Required to use many **improvement tiles**.
- Required on some male guest cards.
- May substitute for a valet if no valets are available (requires Brushing Room tile, pg. 88).

VALETS



Serve any male guests travelling without personal servants (male family members are always attended by their own personal valets and thus do not require activity service).

- Required to play most **male guests**.

LADY'S MAIDS



Serve any female guests travelling without personal servants (female family members are always attended by their own personal lady's maids and thus do not require activity service).

- Required to play most **female guests**.

UNIQUE SERVANTS

BUTLER



Head of the household staff, responsible for checking references of new servants.

- Required to use important tiles like the **Butler's Room** and **Private Study**.
- Required to use some improvement tiles and play some male prestige guests.

HOUSEKEEPER



Responsible for the disposition of the manor and its staff accommodations.

- May substitute for a **lady's maid** if none are available.
- Required to use some improvement tiles and play some female prestige guests.

UNDERBUTLER



A versatile senior servant who assists the butler in his duties.

- May only be hired by acquiring a **Butler's Pantry** tile (pg. 88).
- May substitute for male servants (butler, footman, valet, or **(U)** hall boy), even when servants of that type are available. May not substitute for the **(U)** useful man.
- Not specifically required by any tile or guest.

USING SERVANTS

In order to play an improvement tile or gentry card, you must fulfill its **service needs** by placing the correct number and type of available servants on it. Tiles and gentry have **service icons** showing which servants they require. If you don't have the correct servants in Available Service to fulfill **all** of a tile or gentry's service needs, you may **not** play that tile or gentry.

At the end of your turn, you must place all servants you used in any capacity in **Expended Service**. You may not use them again until they return to **Available Service** (see Rotate Service, pg. 17). Available servants you did **not** use remain in **Available Service**.

SERVICE ABILITIES

Some servant types provide additional benefits when used. For example, your **housekeeper** starts the game with the ability to **substitute** for a lady's maid when no lady's maids are available (see Unique Servants, pg. 29). This means you may use her to fulfill a **service need** for a lady's maid on any tile or card, provided you have no other lady's maids in your Available Service.

Most servants do not start with service abilities, but can gain them from improvement tiles in the **Service** category. Adding a tile with a service ability to your tableau permanently grants that ability to all your servants of the indicated type (or types).



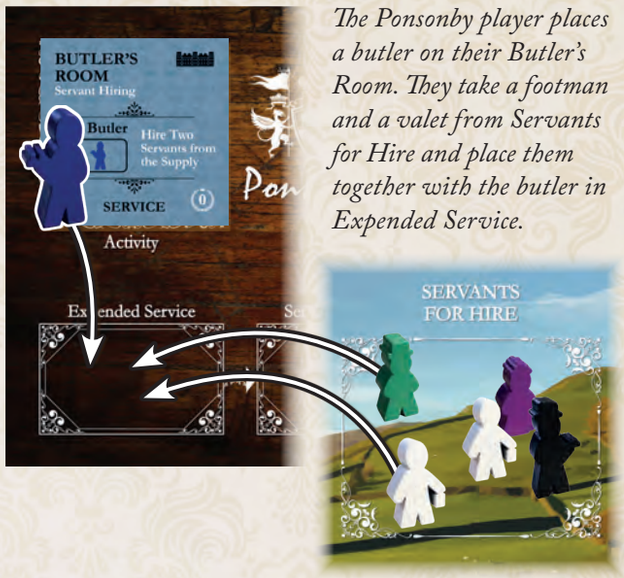
If you have a Brushing Room in your tableau, you may use your footmen as valets when you have no available valets.

HIRING SERVANTS

As you improve your estate and expand your influence, you will need to bolster your service staff. To hire new servants, you must use the **Butler's Room** tile to host a Servant Hiring activity, using your butler (or underbutler). You may not play any gentry during this activity.

Resolve all steps in the normal Order of Play for hosting an activity. During the Enjoy Favours step, use the tile's unique favour to take up to **2** servants of your choice from Servants for Hire and place them in **Expended Service**. You may choose any 2 servants in Servants for Hire, **except** the underbutlers. You can only hire an underbutler by purchasing a Butler's Pantry tile from the Builders' Market (pg. 88).

EXAMPLE: HIRING SERVANTS



The Ponsonby player places a butler on their Butler's Room. They take a footman and a valet from Servants for Hire and place them together with the butler in Expended Service.

RECRUITING OPPONENTS' SERVANTS

If you have upgraded your Butler's Room, you may use it to either hire 2 servants from Servants for Hire as normal **OR** recruit 1 common servant from another family.

The latter option allows you to take a footman, valet, or lady's maid from anywhere on an **opponent's** family board and place them in your Expended Service. This can be especially useful if there are no servants of the type you need left in Servants for Hire. Note that you can't recruit other players' **unique** servants (they are too professional to run off at the first opportunity).

(U)(C) HIRING WHEN PASSING

When using either *Upstairs, Downstairs* or *Characters,* you may Hire Servants as a passing benefit when you pass (pg. 21). When doing this, you use your Butler's Room as you would during a normal activity. You must still expend your butler (or underbutler) and upgrade your Butler's Room if you haven't already. Note that because you refresh servants before taking your passing benefit, your butler will always be available to use.

When playing without either expansion, players may choose to implement this rule as an **optional variant**.

(1P) When playing against solo opponents from the base game or *Wessex* expansion, it is not recommended to use Hiring When Passing, which increases scoring. The target scores of these opponents were generated without this option.

(U) SUPPLEMENTAL SERVANTS

The *Upstairs, Downstairs* expansion introduces 4 new servant types with special **service abilities** you can use on your turn. These supplemental servants can fill a variety of roles and assist your other servants in performing their duties.

SUPPLEMENTAL SERVANTS



Hall Boy | Cook | Head Housemaid | Useful Man

HIRING SUPPLEMENTAL SERVANTS

Supplemental servants are **unique** servants, meaning you may only have 1 of each type in your employ, and they **cannot be recruited** by other players (pg. 30).

However, unlike other unique servants, supplemental servants are placed in **Servants for Hire** at setup and can be hired like common servants, using your **Butler's Room** (pg. 88). Each supplemental servant is counted the same as a common servant for hiring purposes (i.e., you may hire 2 different supplemental servants, or 1 supplemental and 1 common servant, with a single use of the Butler's Room).

USING SUPPLEMENTAL SERVANTS

Each available supplemental servant may use **1** of their service abilities each turn (see next page). Place each supplemental servant you use on a gentry card, improvement tile, or other location according to the rules for the chosen ability. During your Clear Board step (pg. 20), place each supplemental servant you used in any capacity in **Expended Service**, along with your other expended servants.

If an improvement tile has a service need for a specific supplemental servant, you will see a service icon showing that servant on the tile. You may then place that servant on the tile to fulfill this need, following all normal rules for providing service (pg. 18). Unless otherwise stated, the servant may **not** use any of their service abilities.



When the head housemaid stands in for a lady's maid using the effect of the Housekeeper's Room, she does not also get to use her ability to screen guests.



(B) PROMOTIONAL TILES

In *Upstairs, Downstairs*, only the Renovated Kitchen requires a supplemental servant. However, these service needs appear on a number of backer-developed promo tiles, such as the East Lawn and Grand Ballroom.



HALL BOY

A hall boy is a young apprentice responsible for menial tasks such as carrying coal, attending to the front door, cleaning up, and running messages.

If you have a hall boy in Available Service, you may use any **1** of the following abilities during your turn:

- **Favourable Impression:** When hosting an activity, you may place your hall boy on a **money favour** on a gentry card you played to gain an extra **£100**. (You may not do this on an improvement tile.)
- **Butler's Assistant:** When hosting an activity, your hall boy may substitute for your butler on a **gentry card** only (not on an improvement tile), even if the butler is available.
- **Carriage Training:** When you use the Carriage House tile, your hall boy may substitute for a footman, even if a footman is available.

HEAD HOUSEMAID

The head housemaid is responsible for cleanliness: changing bed linen, emptying chamber pots, cleaning upstairs fireplaces, and watching over the lower cleaning staff.

If you have a head housemaid in Available Service, you may use any **1** of the following abilities during your turn:

- **Screen Guests:** When hosting an activity, place your head housemaid on a **guest invite favour** on the improvement tile or gentry card you played to draw 1 additional guest of the indicated type, then dismiss one of the guests you drew.
- **Housekeeper Training:** When hosting an activity, your head housemaid may substitute for your housekeeper on a **gentry card** only (not on an improvement tile).
- **Apprenticeship:** May substitute for any female servant (except the cook) on an improvement tile or gentry card if you have purchased the Housekeeper's Room tile (pg. 94).

You may use the head housemaid's Screen Guests ability on a guest or improvement that already has a **screening** favour. In this case, draw 1 more guest than you would normally and dismiss 1 more guest than you would normally.

EXAMPLE: FAVOURABLE IMPRESSION

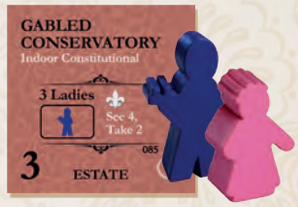


The hall boy is placed on the money favour shown on the Marquess of Tetbury. The player receives £600 during the Enjoy Favours phase instead of £500.

EXAMPLES: SCREEN GUESTS



By placing the head housemaid on Lady Turner, the player will draw 2 prestige guests and keep 1.



By placing the head housemaid on the Gabled Conservatory, the player will draw 5 guests (instead of 4) and keep 2.





COOK

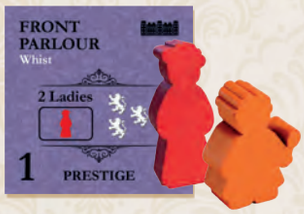
A talented cook can prepare elaborate meals that attract elite guests from across the county.

Whenever you use your cook during an activity, either to fulfill a **service need** on an improvement tile (e.g., the Renovated Kitchen, pg. 100) or use her **service ability** below, gain an extra **1 reputation** during your Enjoy Favours step.

If you have a cook in Available Service, you may use the following ability during your turn:

- **First-Rate Dining:** When hosting an activity, you may place your cook on the improvement tile you play to lower the prestige rating of all **guest cards** in your hand by **2** for this activity. You must still meet all other requirements to play each guest.

EXAMPLE: FIRST CLASS DINING





The cook is placed on the Front Parlour tile, in addition to the housekeeper. This allows the player to invite guests with a prestige rating up to 3 (1,+2 for the cook). All guests still require service as usual, and the player gains +1 ✿.

USEFUL MAN

A useful man is a jack-of-all-trades domestic who performs whatever menial tasks need doing in a great Victorian house.

If you have a useful man in Available Service, you may use any **1** of the following abilities during your turn:

- **Village Fair:** When resolving a Village Fair event, you may place your useful man on your Private Study to gain an extra **£200** (even if your Private Study is not upgraded).
- **Builders' Discount:** When buying from the Builders' Market, you may place your useful man on any improvement in the Market or Reserve to reduce its price by **£100** this turn. (The total price of a tile cannot be reduced below £100.)
- **Refurbish:** When choosing an improvement tile to host an activity, you may place your useful man on any tile in your tableau to reduce its prestige rating by **1** for this activity.
- **Retire:** At any time on your turn, you may permanently remove your useful man from the game to either **refresh the Builders' Market** (pg. 41) or search the draw bag for any **1 specific improvement tile** that is not a Monument to add to the Market. If you choose a specific tile, discard the leftmost tile in the Market, slide all other tiles left, and place the new tile in the rightmost space; return the discarded tile to the bag.

If you **retire** your useful man, return him to the **game box**, not Servants for Hire. You may **not** hire a new useful man after retiring one.

EXAMPLES: USEFUL MAN

VILLAGE FAIR



During a Village Fair event, placing the useful man on the Private Study (pg. 99) earns you an extra £200 from the Village Fair event. If your Private Study is also upgraded (✿ side), earn a total of £500 from the Village Fair.

BUILDERS' DISCOUNT



This player wants to purchase the Breakfast Room, which is in the £300 space of the Builders' Marker. They place their useful man on it to reduce the cost by £100, paying only £200 to gain the tile.

REFURBISH



The Ponsonby family wants to host a pheasant hunt using the Hillside Kennels. Even though they only have a level 2 reputation and the tile requires 3, placing the useful man on the Hillside Kennels reduces its prestige rating by 1 and allows them to host the activity.

(C) SECOND CHANCE SERVANTS (SCS)

Characters introduces second chance servants, who can be hired at any time to fill out your domestic staff, but who come with reputation penalties.

HIRING SECOND CHANCE SERVANTS

SCS are hired from **Higbee's Second Chance Domestics** instead of Servants for Hire. You may visit Higbee's as an extra action outside your normal turn sequence (similar to a special action; pg. 27). You may visit Higbee's at any time on your turn after you have rotated or refreshed service, provided your **butler** (or underbutler) is in Available Service.

To visit Higbee's, expend your butler (or underbutler), placing him directly in Expended Service. Then hire any **1** or **2** SCS from the sideboard **or** recruit **1** SCS from another player's family board. Place your new SCS in your **Servants' Quarters** (instead of Expended Service). They will become available on your next turn. SCS cannot be hired using the Butler's Room (see Servants FAQ, pg. 78).

USING SECOND CHANCE SERVANTS

SCS can be used to staff activities and serve guests just like ordinary servants (but not to invite characters; pg. 43).

However, when you use a SCS during an activity, you immediately suffer a **reputation penalty** based on the **guests** attending, as listed below. If you use multiple SCS during the same activity, you suffer a penalty for each of them. Penalties for **casual** guests depend on whether they are **unsavoury** or **respectable** (pg. 36). You suffer no reputation penalty when using SCS on a tile with only **family members** in attendance.

- You may use SCS even if you don't have enough **reputation** to fully pay their reputation penalty. You must pay as much as you can.
- You can only use the housekeeper as a lady's maid if you have no available lady's maids, which includes SC lady's maids.
- **Brushing Room:** You can use SC footmen as valets if you have the Brushing Room, but only if you have no available valets, which includes SC valets. You still may receive a reputation penalty for using them. **Note:** You also cannot use a regular footman if you have available SC valets.
- **Servants' Hall:** There is no reputation penalty for using a SCS to activate the Servants' Hall in step 2 of your turn, since you've not yet invited any guests.
- **(U) Carriage House:** Using a SCS to activate the Carriage House does incur a reputation penalty if there are prestige or respectable guests in attendance, since this happens during the activity.

SCS REPUTATION PENALTIES

When placed on an activity tile	• If there is at least 1 prestige guest attending the current activity, lose 2 reputation. • If there are no prestige guests, but there is at least 1 respectable guest, lose 1 reputation. • If there are no prestige or respectable guests, suffer no penalty.
When placed on a gentry card	• If it is a prestige guest, lose 2 reputation. • If it is a respectable guest, lose 1 reputation. • If it is an unsavoury guest, suffer no penalty.

SCORING SECOND CHANCE SERVANTS

Unlike ordinary servants, second chance servants can't be used to complete objective cards or milestones and are worth 0 VP at game end.

EXAMPLE: SECOND CHANCE SERVANTS

Before ending their turn, the Ponsonby player expends their butler to hire a SC valet and footman from Higbee's.



Next turn, the second chance servants rotate to Available Service and can be used to provide service for an activity. In this case, the Bowling Green.



Isabella Montgomery is a respectable guest, so the Ponsonby player loses 1 reputation for staffing the Bowling Green with a SCS. However, Walter Tuttle is unsavoury (red frame), so the Ponsonby player suffers no penalty for having a second chance valet look after him during his stay.

3.3 GENTRY

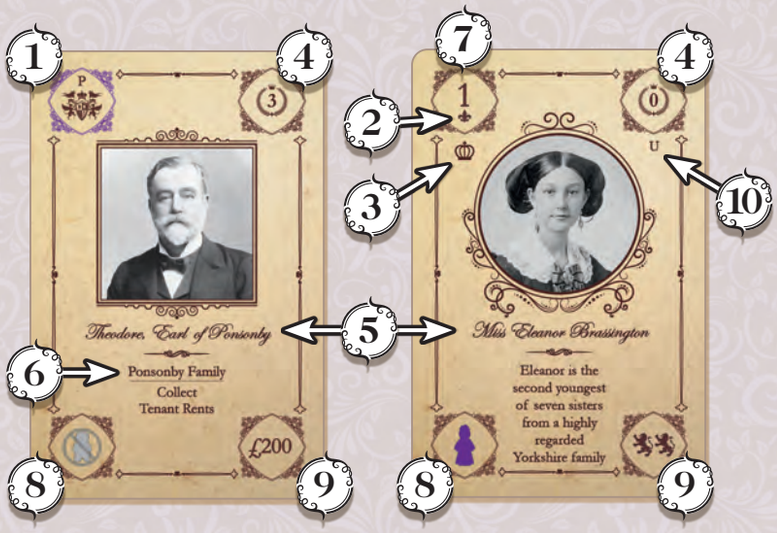
Gentry cards represent the gentlemen and ladies of Derbyshire society. They include your **family members** and the many **guests** who visit your estate over the course of the game.

Whenever you play gentry cards from your hand, you enjoy their printed **favours** (pg. 19). At the end of your turn, any gentry you played are placed in your personal discard pile. There is **no limit** to the number of gentry cards you can have in your hand or discard pile at any time.

Gentry cards in your discard pile still belong to you and may be returned to your hand when you pass (pg. 21). At the end of the game, you score the **VP values** of all gentry in your hand **and** discard pile.

For more details on gentry cards and their effects, see: Appendix B: Gentry Cards, pg. 80.

GENTRY CARD ANATOMY



1. **Family Crest:** Identifies your family members
2. **Guest Type:** Casual (⚜) or Prestige (⚜⚜)
3. **Starter Guest** (♔)
4. **VP Value**
5. **Name**
6. **Title** (underlined)
7. **Prestige Rating (PR):** Reputation level required to play this card
8. **Service Needs:** Servants required to play this card (Theodore has no service needs)
9. **Favours:** Benefits this card provides
10. **Source:** First letter of the expansion the card is from:
    - C for *Characters*
    - P for Promotional
    - U for *Upstairs, Downstairs*
    - W for *Wessex*

FAMILY MEMBERS

Each player starts with a Lord, a Lady, an Heir, and a Young Lady. Each of these 4 family members is the same for each family, except for their name, picture, and title (for example, each family's Lord gives £200 when played). The Asquith family also starts with a 5th unique family member, the Dowager Countess.

Family members have **no** prestige rating (PR) or service needs, meaning they can be played at any reputation level and do not require any servants. Family members can never be **dismissed** for any reason.

For details on each family member, see Family Members, pg. 80.

GUESTS

Guests come in 2 types: **casual** (⚜) and **prestige** (⚜⚜). Casual guests have fewer requirements to play, but have weaker favours and lower (or negative) VP values. Prestige guests have stronger favours and are worth more VP, but have a higher prestige rating and occasionally more service needs.

For details on specific guests with unusual favours, see Unique Guests, pg. 82.

STARTER GUESTS

Starter guests are casual guests (⚜) marked with a ♔ icon and represent a family's closest and most trusted friends. These guests are dealt out to players during setup and may be referenced by some game effects. Otherwise, they have no special properties.

After starter guests are dealt out at setup, they are **always** shuffled back into the casual guest deck. Excluding unused starter guests will unbalance casual deck favours.

INVITING & DISMISSING GUESTS

INVITING GUESTS

Guest invite favours allow you to draw new guests from the appropriate deck and add them to your hand. You must reveal each new guest you invite to all players before adding it to your hand. Guests you've invited remain 'yours' for the rest of the game, and only return to the deck if you **dismiss** them (see below).

Designer's Note: Obsession *also uses the term 'invite' for playing gentry during an activity (pg. 18) and taking characters from the sideboard (pg. 43). While a Victorian family would have well understood the distinction between a formal introduction and inviting a friend to tea, I acknowledge these repeated terms can cause some confusion in gameplay. These rules continue to use 'invite' in multiple ways to preserve compatibility with existing rulebooks and components.*

DISMISSING GUESTS



Dismissal favours allow you to **permanently remove** a guest from your hand, current activity, or discard pile. When you dismiss a guest, place them on the bottom of the appropriate guest deck.

Dismissing guests is always **optional**. You are allowed to play a tile or guest with a dismissal favour but choose not to dismiss any guests from your hand or discard pile.

Once you have dismissed a guest, you no longer return them to your hand when you pass, and you do not score their VP value at the end of the game. (**Note:** Dismissing can be a good way to get rid of casual guests who are worth negative VP.)

SCREENING GUESTS



Some guest invites allow you to **screen** your guests by drawing multiple cards and choosing which of them to add to your hand.

Each screening invite indicates the number of guests you draw and the number you keep. Each guest you choose not to keep is **dismissed** to the bottom of the appropriate guest deck. You must reveal the guest you keep to other players, but not those you dismiss. (**Note:** Screening can be a good way to avoid drawing guests with weak favours or negative VP.)

UNSAVOURY & RESPECTABLE GUESTS

Not all Derbyshire folk are upstanding, and associating with certain unsavoury individuals may come at a cost to your family's reputation or funds. This is represented by favours or VP values with **red frames** around them.

Casual guests who have at least 1 red frame are called **unsavoury** guests*. All casual guests who are **not** unsavoury are considered **respectable**. Only **casual** guests can be unsavoury or respectable; prestige guests and family are considered separate categories (even if they have red frames).



Examples of unsavoury guests

*The one exception are Exiles **(C)**, who are always considered respectable, even if they are casual and have a red frame.

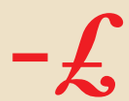
NEGATIVE FAVOURS

Unsavoury guests may have the following negative favours. When enjoying both positive **and** negative favours, you must resolve all positive favours **first**, then resolve all negative favours.

NEGATIVE FAVOURS



Reputation: Lose 1 reputation per icon. If you are at minimum reputation, ignore this favour. You may still play this guest or improvement and enjoy their other favours as normal. Remember that if you both gain and lose reputation from different favours during the same activity, you must first gain positive reputation, then lose it.



Money: Lose the indicated amount of money. If you don't have enough money to pay the full amount, you must immediately spend reputation to take a Borrow Money special action (pg. 27). If you do not have enough reputation to do so, you may **not** play this guest or improvement.

(C) SOCIALITES & ANTISOCIALITES





Certain guests introduced in *Characters* have an **extra requirement** to attend an activity, shown at the bottom left of their card along with their service requirements. This extra requirement may either increase or reduce the number of **other guests** that must attend an activity with them.

When multiple Socialite or Antisocialite guests are played together or with other effects that modify the gentry count of an event, their effects are added together. If playing an Antisocialite would reduce the number of guests required for an activity below 1, they may not be played. Socialites and Antisocialites may not be played with **suite** tiles (pgs. 93, 95, 99), which have a fixed requirement of exactly 1 gentry and can't be modified. (For other affected tiles, see pg. 79.)

EXAMPLE: SOCIALITES & ANTISOCIALITES





The Ponsonby family wants to host the last 3 gentry cards in their hand in the Main Gazebo, which normally requires only 2. They place a footman on the Carriage House, increasing the guest count to 3. However, one of their guests is the socialite Baroness Gatenby, who now increases the count to 4! The Ponsonby plans are surely spoiled. Fortunately, their last gentry card saves the afternoon: Sir August Dankworth, a curmudgeon (Antisocialite), reduces the count by 1, allowing the family to secure all their favours before passing (2+1+1–1 = 3 guests).



Socialites: These guests must be accompanied when attending social events. If a guest has a +1 or +2 in the bottom left, they increase the total number of gentry that must attend their activity by that amount. If the current activity restricts the kinds of gentry that can attend, each additional gentry must follow these restrictions. (For example, if an activity requires 2 Ladies, you can't invite a Gentleman, only another Lady.)

Socialites live for the best of society, and their charisma and ebullience captures the imagination of every acquaintance.



Antisocialites: These guests repulse other gentry who might otherwise attend. If a guest has a -1 in the bottom left, they reduce the total number of gentry that can attend their activity by 1. If the current activity requires a set of gentry of specific kinds, you may choose which of them you do not invite. (For example, if an activity requires 2 Gentlemen and 2 Ladies, you may invite 2 Gentlemen and 1 Lady, or 1 Gentleman and 2 Ladies.)

Antisocialites, of which the Curmudgeon is a superior example, despise gatherings and the mindless frippery of Victorian excess.

All Socialites and Antisocialites have detailed entries in Appendix B: Gentry Cards, pg. 80.



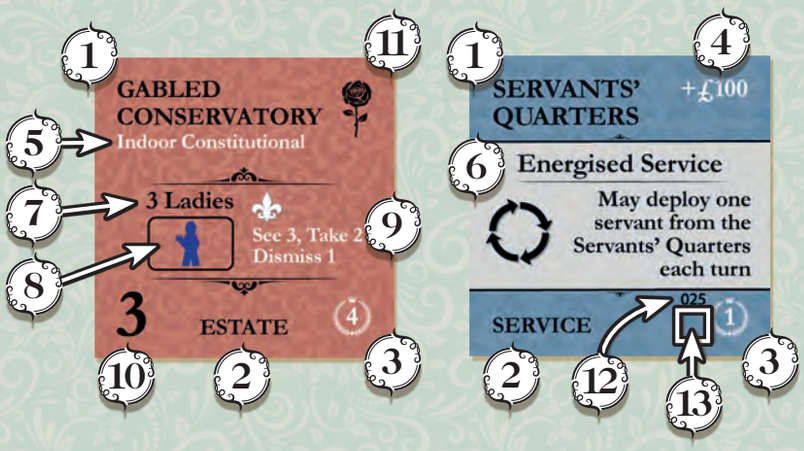
3.4 IMPROVEMENTS

The improvement tiles in your tableau represent the improved rooms and outdoor spaces in and around your country estate. Each player starts with the same 5 improvements, and may gain more during the game by **buying** them from the Builders' Market or the Builders' Reserve (pg. 40).

Most improvement tiles can be used to host **activities** during your turn (pg. 17), while some provide **ongoing effects** that benefit you throughout the game (pg. 39).

For more details on improvement tiles and their effects, see Appendix C: Improvement Tiles, pg. 86.

IMPROVEMENT TILE ANATOMY



1. **Name**
2. **Category**
3. **VP Value**
4. **Price Modifier:** Added to the market price printed on the board
5. **Activity:** The activity this tile can be used to host
6. **Ongoing Effect** ↻**:** Indicates this tile has an ongoing effect each turn
7. **Gentry Requirements:** The number and type of gentry needed to host this activity
8. **Service Needs:** The servants needed to host this activity
9. **Activity Favours:** The benefits this activity provides
10. **Prestige Rating (PR):** The reputation level required to use this tile
11. **Upgrade Icon** 🌹**:** Indicates whether the tile has been upgraded
12. **Tile Sorting Number:** Used when sorting tiles in the Builders' Market *(**Note:** Tile Sorting Numbers are only on the front)*
13. **Source:** First letter of the expansion the tile is from (*base game tiles are shown above, which do not show a letter*):
    - U for *Upstairs, Downstairs*
    - W for *Wessex*
    - B for Backer-Developed Promotional Tiles
    - P for Promotional



IMPROVEMENT CATEGORIES

Improvement tiles are divided into 5 categories: Essentials, Service, Estate, Prestige, Sporting. Tiles in the same category typically have similar gentry requirements, service needs, and favours. Tile categories are also important during **courtship events**, when players compare the VP value of their tiles matching the seasonal theme.

***Note:** As a general rule, the VP on front and back follow a pattern (see labels below tiles). There are exceptions, especially with starting and promo tiles.*



Front: VP=0
Back: VP=PR

Essentials (Brown)
Used for planning tasks and hosting activities with a large number of **gentry**.



VP=1 (Barn 2)

Service (Blue)
Typically provide **ongoing effects**, such as **service abilities** that improve your servants.



Front: VP=PR–2
Back: VP=PR+1

Estate (Red)
Typically help you invite, screen, and dismiss guests; valuable source of prestige guests.



Front: VP=PR–1
Back: VP=PR+2

Prestige (Purple)
Typically provide **reputation** and are often worth significant **VP**.



Front: VP= –1
Back: VP=PR+1

Sporting (Green)
Typically provide **money**.

UPGRADING IMPROVEMENTS

The **first time** you use an improvement tile to host an activity, you must flip it to its **upgraded** side ( ). This usually increases its VP value and modifies the activity, for example by allowing you to invite more gentry or improving its favours.

Upgrading a tile is **not optional**. Even if you prefer the activity on the front of the tile, you **must** flip it after using it. If you use an upgraded tile to host an activity, it stays upgraded and does **not** flip again.

ONGOING EFFECT IMPROVEMENTS

Tiles with ongoing effects (indicated by a icon) **can't** be used to host activities. These include tiles that grant **service abilities** to your servants (pg. 30), as well as **monuments**, which grant reputation or other benefits every turn (below). When acquiring these tiles, take a **reminder token** from the Alderley Hall board and place it on your family board.



Some ongoing effect tiles, such as the **Servants' Hall**, require an available **servant** to use their effect. To use this effect, place the servant on the tile during the indicated step of your turn. At the end of your turn, place the servant in Expended Service along with all other servants you used.

Most ongoing effect tiles can't be upgraded. These tiles do not have an upgrade icon and are the same on both sides (meaning it does not matter which side of the tile starts face up). However, if a tile has an activity on the **front** and an ongoing effect on the **back**, it must start with the **activity** side face up. After it is used and upgraded, it gains an ongoing effect, but can no longer be used to host activities. This effectively means the tile's activity can only be hosted **once per game**.

EXAMPLES: ONGOING EFFECT IMPROVEMENTS



To use the 'Gossip' effect of the Servants' Hall, place 1 servant of any type on it during step 2 of your turn. Since it has no activity, it can't be upgraded.





You may only host the Slumber activity on the front of the Queen's Suite once per game. After you do, you must upgrade it to a monument.

MONUMENTS

Monument tiles are identified by the word 'Monument' and a dark grey background bar (as opposed to a white bar for other ongoing effect tiles). Each monument in your tableau provides a passive benefit every turn (during step 2 if you are hosting an activity or step 3 if you are passing; pg. 21). In the base game, all monuments provide 1 per turn. In expansions, some monuments can provide money.



The upgraded side of the Lionheart Suite is a Monument



Monument (same on both sides)



(U) The Parsonage provides money or reputation

(U) LOW VP MONUMENTS

The *Upstairs, Downstairs* expansion provides an alternate set of 4 Monument tiles that optionally replace the 6 double-sided Monuments in the base game (base game tiles that upgrade into Monuments are not affected). These alternate Monuments have lower price modifiers and VP values, making them easier to attain, but less impactful during courtship events and end-game scoring. To use them, follow step 5b of Central Play Area Setup (pg. 10) or see 4.4 **(U)** Low VP Monuments Module, pg. 48.

HYBRID IMPROVEMENTS

Hybrid improvements are rooms or outdoor spaces that have multiple purposes. They have a different category on each side, and are **always** flipped after being used.

Hybrid tiles do not have an upgrade icon like normal tiles, and instead have **hybrid icons** ( ) in the top right on both sides. The icon with a line under it ( ) shows which side of the tile starts face up.

After you host an activity with a hybrid tile, flip it to the opposite side (as if upgrading it) and place it in the column matching its **new** category. If you use it again later, you must flip it again. **Note:** For both courtship events (counting up category VP) and objectives (scoring categories at the end of the game), **only** the improvement category of the face up side counts.



Starting Side



Back



Starting Side



Back

Tip: The colour of the opposite side is previewed as a pattern behind the servant

3.5 THE BUILDERS' MARKET & RESERVE

The Builders' Market reflects competition for scarce skilled labour and high-end building materials in rural mid-19th century England. When planning the expansion of your estate, you must work within the funds you have and the opportunities that are available.

You may purchase **1 improvement tile** from the Builders' Market each turn, either when hosting an activity or passing. The Builders' Holiday and certain VP cards allow you to purchase multiple tiles in the same turn. After you purchase tiles, you must **refill the Market** from the draw bag, respecting all rules in the following sections.

At the end of each season, the Builders' Market is fully **refreshed**, and some tiles may be moved to the **Builders' Reserve**, ensuring the Market does not stagnate.

TILE PRICES & BUYING RESTRICTIONS

PRICES & MODIFIERS

The total price to purchase a tile is the **market price** printed above it in the Market or Reserve plus the **price modifier** printed on the tile itself, if it has one.

If a tile does **not** have a price modifier, its current price is equal to its market price. If a tile has a **negative** modifier, its price is reduced by the indicated amount. A tile's price may **never** be reduced below £100.

DUPLICATE RESTRICTION

All tiles in your tableau must always be **unique**. You may **never** acquire a tile you already have by any means. Otherwise, you may buy any tile in the Builders' Market or Reserve, provided you can afford it.

BUILDERS' HOLIDAY



During a Builders' Holiday round track event (pg. 17) or when using a Market Purchase VP card (pg. 105), you may purchase **any number** of tiles from the Builders' Market and/or Reserve, not just 1 tile. You must finish buying **all** tiles before you refill the Market. Follow the rules for refilling multiple Market spaces at the same time (pg. 41).

Once you have purchased a tile on the Builders' Holiday, **you cannot refresh** the market with a special action, useful man, or VP card. You must complete your purchases from a single market without sliding the tiles after each purchase.

THE BUILDERS' RESERVE

As the game progresses, local builders increase their efforts to meet the rising demand for construction, and simpler improvement projects become more affordable. This is represented by the Builders' Reserve, where players can purchase discounted improvement tiles from season 2 onward.

Designer's Note: *On the game board, this area is labelled 'Builders' Market Reserve.' Here I have chosen to shorten it to 'Builders' Reserve' to reduce confusion between what is considered 'the Market' and 'the Reserve.'*

OPENING THE RESERVE

At the end of season 1, all **Service tiles** in the Builders' Market are moved to the Builders' Reserve (**Note:** The Largest Wine Cellar is a **service** monument, but it is never placed in the Reserve). At the end of season 2, all tiles with a **prestige rating** of 1 (PR1) are likewise moved to the Reserve. Tiles placed in the Reserve may be stacked in any order (or spread out face up, if space allows).

Once the Reserve has 'opened,' any **new** tiles drawn from the bag that qualify for the Reserve are placed directly in the Reserve instead of on the Market track (see next section). This means that, from season 2 onward, all new Service tiles drawn are placed directly in the Reserve, and from season 3 onward, all new PR1 tiles drawn are placed directly in the Reserve.

EXAMPLE: OPENING THE RESERVE



At the end of Season 1, the two Service tiles are moved to the reserve.

BUYING FROM THE RESERVE

Whenever you would buy a new tile from the Builders' Market, you may buy a tile from the Reserve instead. Each tile in the Reserve can be purchased at a price of **£300** plus or minus normal price modifiers (pg. 20). All tiles in the Reserve are public and available to be purchased. You may look through them at any time.

REFILLING & REFRESHING THE MARKET

REFILLING THE BUILDERS' MARKET

Whenever new tiles are drawn and placed in the Builders' Market, follow these rules:

- Before drawing new tiles, **slide** any tiles remaining in the Market to the left so that all empty spaces are at the right end.
- When you draw a tile with an **upgrade icon** ( ), place the icon face down.
- When you draw a tile with a **hybrid icon** ( ), place the icon with a line under it face up ( ).
- When you draw a **duplicate** of a tile that is already present in the Market, **stack** it on top of the matching tile and draw again.
- When you draw a **Service** or **PR1** tile, check if it must be moved to the **Reserve** (previous section). If so, place it in the Reserve and draw again.
- If you are filling more than 1 empty space in the Market, place the new tiles in order of lowest to highest **tile sorting number**.
- If you draw **2 duplicate tiles** while refilling the Market, place both of them in the same space, following the order described above.

  (**Note:** There are at most 2 copies of each tile in the bag.)

EXAMPLE: REFILLING THE MARKET

A player has purchased the tile from the £500 space. All tiles to the right of that space slide left.



Then, new tiles are drawn from the bag. The first draw is a Barn, which is stacked with the Barn already in the Market. The second tile drawn is the Hillside Kennels, which is added to the rightmost space.



REFRESHING THE BUILDERS' MARKET

When the Builders' Market is refreshed, all tiles are cleared and the Market is fully refilled from the bag. This happens at the end of the first **3 seasons** (pg. 23), as well as when a player chooses to refresh the Market as a **passing benefit** (pg. 21), with a **VP card** (pg. 105), by retiring a **useful man** (pg. 33), or as a **special action** (pg. 27).

To refresh the Market, follow these steps:

1. Remove **all** tiles from the Builders' Market and set them aside (do not remove any tiles from the Reserve).
2. Refill all 6 spaces in the Market from the bag, following the normal rules for refilling the Market (previous section). Remember to sort all new tiles from lowest to highest **tile sorting number**.
3. Return all tiles removed from the Market to the **draw bag** and thoroughly mix them in (if you are concerned about wear on tiles, see the Tiles FAQ, pg. 79).

EXAMPLE: REFRESHING THE MARKET

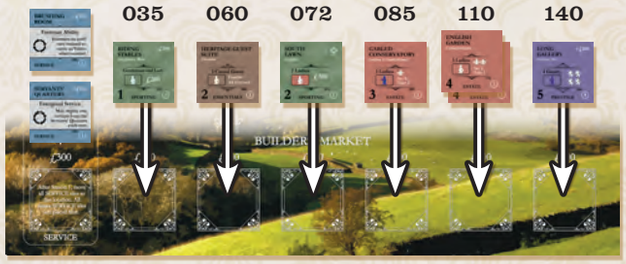
All tiles from the Builders' Market are set aside.





New tiles are drawn from the bag. Service tiles are added to the Reserve, the South Lawn is placed side up, the duplicate English Garden tiles are stacked, and all stacks are sorted by their ***tile sorting number.***

Service



Finally, all of the set-aside tiles are mixed into the draw bag.



3.6 OBJECTIVES & VP CARDS

Objective cards represent the private passions of the family, distinct from any public competition for the Fairchilds' attention. VP cards are special rewards you earn by impressing the Fairchilds and other prestigious guests, as well as from some improvement tiles.

OBJECTIVE CARDS

Each card shows an objective you can fulfill to score additional VP. Keep your objectives hidden from opponents until end game scoring.

In a standard-length game, each player draws a total of **7** objectives (5 at setup and 2 during the Draw Objectives event) and discards **1** objective during each courtship event. This leaves each player with a total of **3** objectives to score at the end of the game (pg. 24).

All discarded objectives are placed on the bottom of the objective deck without being revealed. If multiple objectives are discarded at the same time, shuffle them before placing them on the bottom of the deck.

For a detailed list of objective cards, see Appendix E: Objective Cards, pg. 106.



(X) EXTENDED GAME OBJECTIVES

In an extended game, each player draws a total of **8** objectives (4 at setup and 4 more during 2 Draw Objectives events), and discards **1** objective during each courtship event, leaving them with **4** objectives to score at game end.

DRAWING NEW OBJECTIVE CARDS

Certain rare effects in the game, such as the **Main Library** tile (pg. 96), allow players to draw additional objective cards. Each time you use one of these effects, you not only draw a new objective, you increase the total number of objectives you can **score** at the end of the game by 1.



GROUP OBJECTIVES

To complete any objective that requires a tile, you only need to have that tile (or tiles) in your tableau at the end of the game. **It is not necessary that the tile be upgraded**, even though some tile graphics show a rose, such as with the Croquet Lawn shown here (see Objectives FAQ, pg. 77).



(C) REVEREND GRANTLY'S OBJECTIVES

When using the *Characters* expansion, instead of placing discarded objectives on the bottom of the deck, place them face up on Reverend Grantly's sideboard space. Players may look at the cards in this pile at any time, and may exchange their own objectives with those in the Reverend's pile by inviting him to their estates (pg. 44).

VP CARDS

VP Card



VP cards can be earned during courtship events or from certain prestige guests and tiles.

Each VP card can either be **discarded** for an immediate benefit or **kept** until the end of the game to score VP.

For a detailed list of VP card benefits, see Appendix D: VP cards, pg. 105.

DISCARDING VP CARDS

Whenever you draw a VP card, you may immediately reveal it, gain its benefit, and **discard** it to the bottom of the VP deck. If you choose not to discard the VP card immediately, keep it face down with your objective cards. At any time on any of your turns, you may reveal and discard it to gain its benefit. You may discard multiple VP cards in the same turn.

At the end of the game, you have **1 final chance** to discard VP cards for their benefits (*for example, you might want to discard a VP card that gives reputation to reach a reputation level that's worth more VP than the card itself*). You then score the VP values of all VP cards you did **not** discard.
See End Game Scoring, pg. 24.



(U) (C) REPLACEMENT OBJECTIVE DECKS

The *Upstairs, Downstairs* and *Characters* expansions each provide an alternate deck of objective cards that **replaces** the base game objective deck.

Upstairs, Downstairs **Objective Deck**



Marked with a U in the top right corner

Characters **Objective Deck**



Different card back

USING THE *UPSTAIRS, DOWNSTAIRS* DECK

The objective deck provided in *Upstairs, Downstairs* should only be used if you are playing *Upstairs, Downstairs* but do **not** have the *Characters* expansion. This deck adds unique objectives for *Upstairs, Downstairs* and has enough cards for 5–6 players.

USING THE *CHARACTERS* DECK

The objective deck provided in *Characters* replaces **all** previous objective decks, and should be used when playing the base game or any combination of expansions (even when playing without *Characters* itself). Objectives that are only used with specific expansions are marked with a **small letter** in the top right:

- **U** for *Upstairs, Downstairs*
- **W** for *Wessex*
- There are no objectives specific to *Characters*

If you are playing without an expansion, simply remove the marked cards from the deck.

The *Characters* deck contains 2 **Fiery Sermons** that have the same purple back as other objectives, but are used exclusively in the **Cooperative Mode**. Do not use these in competitive play.

Note: The 2 objectives with a raven (🐦‍⬛) are required for Cooperative Mode, but are still used in normal play.

3.7 (C) SIDEBOARD CHARACTERS

The *Characters* expansion introduces 3 influential and eccentric individuals whose special talents may prove useful to your family.



Whenever you **pass**, you can send a footman to the **sideboard** to invite one of these characters to your estate. On your **next** turn, the character will provide you with **special favours**, then return home until another family invites them.

INVITING A CHARACTER

When you pass, immediately before choosing a **passing benefit** in Step 4 (pg. 21), you may place an available **footman** (or **underbutler**) on any 1 character's sideboard space. If you do, take their character meeple and place it on the Activity space on your board.

If you invite either **Reverend Grantly** or **Constable Bucket** (or you do not invite a character), you may then choose a passing benefit as normal. However, if you invite the **Eccentric Dowager**, you do **not** receive a normal passing benefit. Instead, look through her pile of **Exile** guests, choose 1 to add to your hand and return the rest to her space.

You may only invite **1** character each time you pass. If a character is currently visiting another player's estate, you can't invite them until they return to the sideboard. You can't use second chance footmen (pg. 34) to invite characters, only ordinary footmen. Note that you refresh service **before** inviting characters.

RESERVING CHARACTERS VARIANT

Players who prefer less direct competition can use the **reverse side** of the *Characters* sideboard, with 2 footman boxes under each character's space. When using this side of the board, you may **reserve** an absent character during a pass turn by placing an available footman in the **2nd box** under the character's space, behind the footman of the player who has them.

When another player returns a character you have reserved and retrieves their footman, slide your footman forward and **immediately** take the character's meeple, following all normal rules. On your next turn, enjoy their favours normally (pg. 44). Note that if you reserve the **Eccentric Dowager**, you don't gain an Exile until her carriage arrives at your estate.

ENJOYING CHARACTER FAVOURS

If you have a character on your Activity space at the start of your turn, you **must** resolve each of their favours during the Enjoy Favours step of your turn. When you choose an activity tile, place the character on top of the tile as a reminder (even if it is an activity that would not typically allow servants or gentry).

During the Clear Board step of your turn, you must **return** the character to their sideboard space. When you do, take back your **footman** from the sideboard and place him in Expended Service.

If you have a character at the start of your turn, you may **not** pass (since you **must** enjoy their favours). If you invite a character during your **final turn** of the game, you won't be able to use them, since you won't have a next turn (with the exception of the Eccentric Dowager, who still allows you to take 1 of her guests and score their VP).

CHARACTER FAVOURS



REVEREND GRANTLY

- Exchange **1** or **2** of your objective cards for the same number of objectives of your choice from the Reverend's pile.
- Spend **£100** per objective you exchange.

Exchanging at least 1 objective is mandatory. If you do not have at least £100 when you invite the Reverend, you must generate money to pay before enjoying his favours (by choosing Collect £200 as your passing benefit, playing a guest or activity that generates money, or using a Borrow Money special action).



CONSTABLE BUCKET

- Ignore all negative favours on any **unsavoury** guests attending your current activity (pg. 36), except for American Heiresses. You may still enjoy all gentry's positive favours.
- **Dismiss** any number of unsavoury guests from your hand, current activity, or discard pile. You **must** dismiss at least 1. You may not dismiss American Heiresses.
- Lose 2 reputation.

If you have no unsavoury guests in your hand, current activity, or discard pile, you may not invite the Constable. If you are at minimum reputation when you enjoy the Constable's favours, ignore his reputation loss. The Constable's favours do not affect American Heiresses (alas, he cannot show influential tourists the door!), but they are still considered unsavoury for other effects.



ECCENTRIC DOWAGER

- You may invite **1 additional gentry** to the activity you host this turn.

The extra gentry you invite must follow any restrictions the activity has (e.g., if an activity requires 2 Ladies, the extra gentry must also be a Lady). You cannot use this effect if you play a suite tile.

THE DOWAGER'S EXILES

The exiles staying at the dowager's manor have lived a lifetime in the excesses of royal courts, and a visit from them requires the family to live up to their extravagant standards. However, those willing to accommodate them can expect fortunate tidings.





The Eccentric Dowager can be used to invite special guests called **Exiles** who are not available from the guest decks. Each Exile's favours require you to pay £100-200, but grant a significant reward, most often allowing you to **screen** prestige guests. Exiles are never considered **unsavoury** (pg. 36), even if they are casual and have a red frame. Otherwise, Exiles are yours to keep for the rest of the game and act the same as other guests. **You must have enough money to pay an Exile in order to play them** (see Negative Favours, pg. 36).

(U) ADDITIONAL EXILES

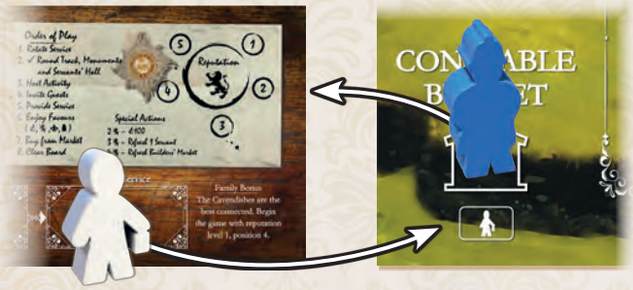
When using *Upstairs, Downstairs* with *Characters,* additional guests are added to the Eccentric Dowager's pile during setup (pg. 13). Each of these guests is considered an Exile and follows all rules that other Exiles do.



If you acquire Charles Fitzwilliam from the Eccentric Dowager, you must immediately dismiss 2 casual guests (this is an exception to the rule that dismissals are optional).

EXAMPLE: CONSTABLE BUCKET

This player uses their turn to pass. After refreshing service, reclaiming gentry, and observing round track events, they decide to invite Constable Bucket to their estate by placing a footman on the corresponding space of the Characters *Sideboard.*



On their next turn, they invite 3 unsavoury guests and a family member in the Breakfast Room. Adding Constable Bucket to this activity allows them to enjoy the positive favours of all these gentry while ignoring their downsides.



As a result, this player collects £500, 1 prestige guest, and 1 casual guest. They then use the Constable to dismiss an unsavoury guest from their hand, as well as Sir Bentley Churchill and James Hereford, but choose to keep Miss Elizabeth Jones to enjoy her favours again later.

Finally, this player loses 2 reputation for using Constable Bucket, as his services are awkward to explain in polite company. The Constable Bucket meeple is returned to the corresponding space on the sideboard, and the footman there is retrieved and placed in Expended Service.

EXAMPLE: ECCENTRIC DOWAGER

This player uses their turn to pass. After refreshing service, reclaiming gentry, and observing round track events, they decide to invite the Eccentric Dowager to their estate and request she bring Count Vladimir Antonoff with her from her manor. There is no passing benefit, but they can still buy from the Builders' Market.



On the following turn, they play Count Antonoff as an extra guest when they host an activity and return the Eccentric Dowager's carriage back to the corresponding space on the sideboard. The footman there is retrieved and placed in Expended Service.



CHAPTER 4.
OPTIONAL RULES & CONTENT

Chapter 4 contains critical, routinely-used variations that are fundamentally part of high-level *Obsession* contests.

Here you will find milestones, a balanced Charles Fairchild card, monument options, and the asymmetric Distinguished Family Members module as well as the most popular game length: extended play. These are **not** whimsical variants, but an essential toolbox for arriving at your preferred style of play. **Note:** See pg. 43 for the Reserving Characters variant.

The **Variant Catalogue** in the *Characters* expansion contains additional fan-based variants.

4.1 (X) EXTENDED GAME

- **What is it?** Adds 1 more round to each season.
- **Why use it?** Allows for more developed country estates, more elaborate activities, dramatically higher reputation scores, and a better chance to complete difficult objectives.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires: Reputation Level 7/8 Counters

SETUP

(X) The following setup steps are also listed in Integrated Setup (pg. 6).

During Player Setup, make the following changes:

- **Reputation** (Step 4): Each player adds a level **7/8** counter to their stack of counters.
- **Objectives** (Step 9): Deal each player **4** objective cards instead of the normal 5.

During Central Play Area Setup, make the following change:

- **Alderley Hall** (Step 8): Flip over the Alderley Hall board to show the **extended round track** (with 20 spaces instead of 16 and 'Extended Play' printed immediately beneath the round track).



GAMEPLAY

Each season has **4** game rounds (instead of the standard 3), meaning each player will take **16 turns** during the game (instead of 12). The **maximum reputation level** is increased to **9**, allowing players to score additional Reputation VP at game end (see End Game Scoring, pg. 24).

Extended Play has 3 Village Fairs instead of 2 and locates the National Holiday early in Season 3.

OBJECTIVES

Over the course of the game, each player draws a total of **8 objective cards** (4 at setup and 4 more during 2 Draw Objectives round track events). As normal, players must discard 1 objective at the end of each courtship event, leaving each player with **4** objectives at game end. Players may score all 4 of their remaining objectives, if able.



4.2 (5P+) 5–6 PLAYER MODE

- **What is it?** Adds up to 2 extra players.
- **Why use it?** You have too many friends.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:

(U) 5–6 Player Components
- Tableau Organiser (1)
- Servant Meeples (14)
- Reputation Markers (2)
- Reputation Level Counters (10)
- Reminder Counters (2)
- Starter Tiles (10)

(U) (W) Either the Howard or Wessex family (6 players requires both)

(U) (C) *Upstairs, Downstairs* or *Characters* Replacement Objective Deck

Recommended:

(U) Team Mode (with 6 players)

(U) *Upstairs, Downstairs* expansion (required if Howard is used)

Incompatible with:

(1P) Solo Mode

(U) Tableau Mode

(C) Cooperative Mode



SETUP

(5P+) The following setup steps are also listed in Integrated Setup (pg. 6).

During Player Setup, make the following changes:

- **Family Draft** (Step 2): If you do **not** perform an Expanded Family Draft (pg. 14), give the players who are 5th and 6th in turn order **£200** and **£300**, respectively. (Note that if you are using the Howard family, you must use an Expanded Family Draft.)
- **Objectives** (Step 9): Deal each player **4** objectives instead of the normal 5.

During Central Play Area Setup, make the following changes:

- **Servants for Hire** (Step 1): With 5 players, fill Servants for Hire as normal, using the extra servants provided in *Upstairs, Downstairs*. With 6 players, fill Servants for Hire as if there are 5 players (there will not be enough to add more).
- **Monument Tiles** (Step 5): Select a total of 5 monuments, using only 1 Estate monument (unless using the low VP monuments module, in which case use all 4 monuments as normal; pg. 48).

(C) If using *Characters* with 6 players, fill Higbee's Second Chance Domestics as if there are 5 players (as above, this will be all servants in the game).

GAMEPLAY

Over the course of a standard length game, each player draws a total of **6 objective cards** (4 at setup and 2 more during the Draw Objectives round track event). As normal, players must discard 1 objective at the end of each courtship event, leaving each player with **2** objectives to score at game end.

(X) Over the course of an extended play game, each player draws a total of 8 objective cards (4 at setup and 4 more during the Draw Objectives round track events). As normal, players must discard 1 objective at the end of each courtship event, leaving each player with 4 objectives to score at game end.

6 PLAYERS

With 6 players, it is strongly recommended to play in **Team Mode** (pg. 64) with 3 teams of 2 players each, to keep game length manageable.

4.3 FRIENDLY MODE

- **What is it?** A minor variant that removes all 'take that' elements from the game.
- **Why use it?** Many players dislike direct conflict and nasty surprises, and newer players may not be expecting them.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	No additional components required
Incompatible with:	**(1P)** Solo Mode **(5P+)** 5–6 Player Mode **(C)** Cooperative Mode

Designer's Note: *This mode incorporates the Polite Society variant, developed by many community members.*

SETUP

During Central Play Area Setup, make the following changes:

- **Servants for Hire** (Step 1): Add 1 extra valet and 1 extra lady's maid to Servants for Hire (there will be the **number of players + 1** of each servant type).
- **Guests** (Step 4): Remove the 2 casual guests with Gossip attack favours from the game (Miss Elizabeth Perkins and Miss Florence Oliver, see Appendix B pgs. 84-85).
- **Improvement Tiles** (Step 6): Remove both Servants' Hall tiles from the game.

GAMEPLAY

Players may not recruit servants from other players.

4.4 (U) LOW VP MONUMENTS MODULE

Grand monuments—though certainly, ahem, noticeable—can be a garish and unsightly testament to one's vanity. More modest improvements are much easier on the coin purse.

- **What is it?** An alternate set of monuments with lower cost modifiers and VP.
- **Why use it?** Some players feel that the base game monuments, with values of 5-10VP, disproportionately impact courtship. These alternate monuments are worth only 1-4VP and have lower costs to make them more accessible early in the game.



COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	**(U)** Low VP Monument Tiles (4)
Incompatible with:	**(1P)** Solo Mode **(U)** Solo Estate Challenge **(C)** Cooperative Mode

SETUP

During Central Play Area Setup, when selecting monuments, return all 6 base game monuments to the box and instead use all 4 low VP monument tiles, regardless of player count.

4.5 (U) MILESTONES MODULE

In the quest for social preeminence, the elegant aristocrats of 1860s Derbyshire could be more frightening than a nest of adders, stylishly sporting the latest fashions, of course. milestones represent peak social climbing, the relentless effort to outdo your neighbours in all possible things.

- **What is it?** A set of competitive public objectives that players race to complete.
- **Why use it?** Increases player interaction and adds an alternative to focusing on private objectives.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	**(U)** Milestone Cards (10) **(U)** Milestone Counters (12)
Incompatible with:	**(1P)** Solo Mode **(U)** Solo Estate Challenge **(C)** Cooperative Mode

SETUP



Objective Deck (Step 2): During Central Play Area Setup, after placing the objective deck, shuffle the milestone cards and deal **2** face up where everyone can see them. Return the rest to the box. Each player takes **both** milestone counters with their family's crest.

Setup Variant: If players prefer to know which milestones will be in play before drafting families, they may decide to reveal the 2 milestones at the start of **Player Setup** instead. (**Note:** Objective cards are still dealt during step 9 of Player Setup, as normal.)

GAMEPLAY

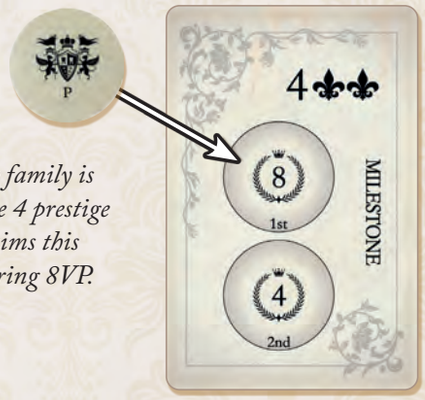
Each milestone card shows a public objective for players to complete. The first and second players to claim each milestone score the indicated VP at the end of the game (8 VP and 4 VP, respectively).

You may claim a milestone you qualify for **once per turn**, at any time on your turn, by placing 1 of your milestone counters in the topmost unoccupied space on the card. At the end of the game, add the VP you score from claimed milestones to your **Objective VP** (pg. 24).

If 2 players have already claimed a milestone, no one else may claim it. Once you've claimed a milestone, you can't lose it, even if you no longer meet the objective. You can't claim the same milestone more than once.

For a detailed list of milestones, see Appendix F: Milestones, pg. 112.

EXAMPLE: MILESTONE CARDS



The Ponsonby family is first to acquire 4 prestige guests and claims this milestone, scoring 8VP.



4.6 (C) DISTINGUISHED FAMILY MEMBERS (DFM) MODULE

- **What is it?** Each player replaces 1 of their ordinary family members with a Distinguished Family Member (DFM) who provides enhanced favours.
- **Why use it?** Allows players to further customise their families and pursue asymmetric strategies. **Note:** To balance the most powerful family advantage, the Howards do not have DFM.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	**(C)** Distinguished Family Member Cards (21)
Incompatible with:	**(U)** Solo Estate Challenge

SETUP

During Player Setup, use an Expanded Family Draft (pg. 14) to select DFMs along with family boards. Each player must select a DFM with a different title (i.e., only 1 player may choose the Lord of their manor, only 1 player may choose the Lady of their manor, etc).

A player may only draft the Dowager Countess if they have already drafted the Asquith family; the Dowager may never be drafted first. (If the draft allows you to select a family and DFM at the same time, you may draft them together.)

Since the Howard family has a very strong family bonus, the player that drafts them does not draft a DFM (if they choose the Howard board, they leave all distinguished cards in the center).

Once drafting is complete, each player replaces the ordinary version of the family member they selected with the distinguished version they drafted, returning the ordinary version to the box.

GAMEPLAY

Distinguished Family Members follow the same rules as ordinary family members but provide the more powerful favours shown on their cards.

For a detailed list of DFM favours, see Distinguished Family Members, pg. 81.

DFM 2–PLAYER VARIANT

With 2 players only, you may elect to draft 2 DFMs each. During the draft, each player must use 1 turn to draft their family and 1 turn to draft **both** their DFMs, in either order. When combined with an extra servant draft, each player instead uses 1 turn to draft their family plus 1 DFM, and 1 turn to draft their extra servant plus 1 DFM.

4.7 (C) ALTERNATE CHARLES FAIRCHILD

- **What is it?** Charles Fairchild now provides £300 as well as 3 reputation.
- **Why use it?** Improves Charles' favours to better balance him with his sister Elizabeth, making each of them a good choice for courtship.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	**(C)** Alternate Charles Fairchild Card (or proxy)

SETUP

When setting up the Alderley Hall board during Central Play Area Setup (pg. 10), replace the original Charles with the alternate version from *Characters*.

If you do not have *Characters*, you can instead use the original Charles card as a proxy. Place £300 on his card to simulate his new favour. Whenever a player claims him during courtship, they gain his £300. When he returns to Alderley Hall at the start of the following courtship, place another £300 on him.



4.8 (B) COSTUME BALL

When Margaret Fairchild of Alderley Hall announced that there would be a Costume Ball of special magnificence to celebrate the installation of Charles and Elizabeth Fairchild, there was much talk and excitement amongst the best people in Derbyshire. Those invited immediately began designing imaginative costumes for the occasion, which was to be held in early summer. Locally, the families Asquith, Cavendish, Howard, Ponsonby, Wessex, and York will at last satisfy an all-consuming curiosity about Alderley Hall and its new, eligible occupants.

- **What is it?** Adds a thematic event where players can potentially acquire a prestige guest.
- **Why use it?** Early prestige guests can be game changers, and ensuring everyone has access to them helps players establish their all-important prestige guest engine.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	**(B)** Alderley Hall Tile from Backer-Developed Promo Tiles (or proxy)
Incompatible with:	**(1P)** Solo Mode **(U)** Solo Estate Challenge **(C)** Cooperative Mode

SETUP



Place the Alderley Hall Tile (or a suitable proxy) on the round track near the first courtship event space.

GAMEPLAY

At the end of the first season, when refreshing the Builders' Market, place the Alderley Hall Tile in the rightmost space in the Market. Refill the rest of the Market as normal.

In the following rounds, the Alderley Hall Tile can't be purchased, but still slides left each time tiles are purchased. If the Builders' Market is refreshed again while the Alderley Hall Tile is present, leave it **exactly where it is** and fill the other spaces around it.

ATTENDING THE BALL

When the Alderley Hall Tile reaches the 3rd space (£500), the Costume Ball happens immediately. Each player with **reputation level 2** or higher may spend **£200** to attend the Ball (this does not require servants or gentry cards). Each player who does immediately draws **2 prestige guests** and chooses 1 to keep.

The player currently taking their turn decides first whether they will attend the Ball, followed by each other player in turn order. After the Ball concludes, remove the tile from the game and refill the Builders' Market normally.

4.9 (U) STARTING HALL BOY VARIANT

- **What is it?** Adds the hall boy to the Starting Servants.
- **Why use it?** Gives the least-used servant a bigger role in the game. Also helps introduce newer players to supplemental service and gives them a little extra money early.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	**(U)** *Upstairs, Downstairs* Expansion

SETUP

During step 5 of Player Setup (pg. 9), each player adds a hall boy to their starting servants. Do not place any hall boys in Servants for Hire.



4.10 INTENSIVE SERVICE SETUP VARIANT

- **What is it?** A minor setup change that ensures the Builders' Market starts with specific Service tiles, giving players early access to certain service abilities.
- **Why use it?** Ensures specialised service is an option and empowers service-based engines.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Incompatible with:
(U) Solo Estate Challenge
(C) Cooperative Mode



SETUP

During Central Play Area Setup, set aside 1 **Brushing Room** tile, 1 **Butler's Pantry** tile, and 1 **Barn** tile. When populating the Builders' Market, include these tiles and only draw 3 other qualifying tiles. Tiles are arranged in Tile Sorting Number order, and any additional Service tiles drawn are placed (or stacked) in the Market, as usual.

ALTERNATE SETUP

Experienced players may choose to substitute the 3 starting Service tiles with others of their choice (such as the Servants' Hall, Renovated Kitchen, or Carriage House). Alternatively, they may randomly select 3 starting Service tiles.

If performing an Expanded Family Draft, choose all tiles before the draft (since you will not be able to select impartially after drafting).

4.11 JANE AUSTEN CLOSED COURTSHIP VARIANT

- **What is it?** An optional variation on courtship rules where each season's theme is kept face down until the start of the courtship event at the end of the season so it's always a surprise.
- **Why use it?** Eliminates intense focus on the current courtship theme and promotes balanced tableau building. More relaxed.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Incompatible with:
(U) Tableau Mode
(U) Solo Estate Challenge
(C) Cooperative Mode
Other Courtship Variants

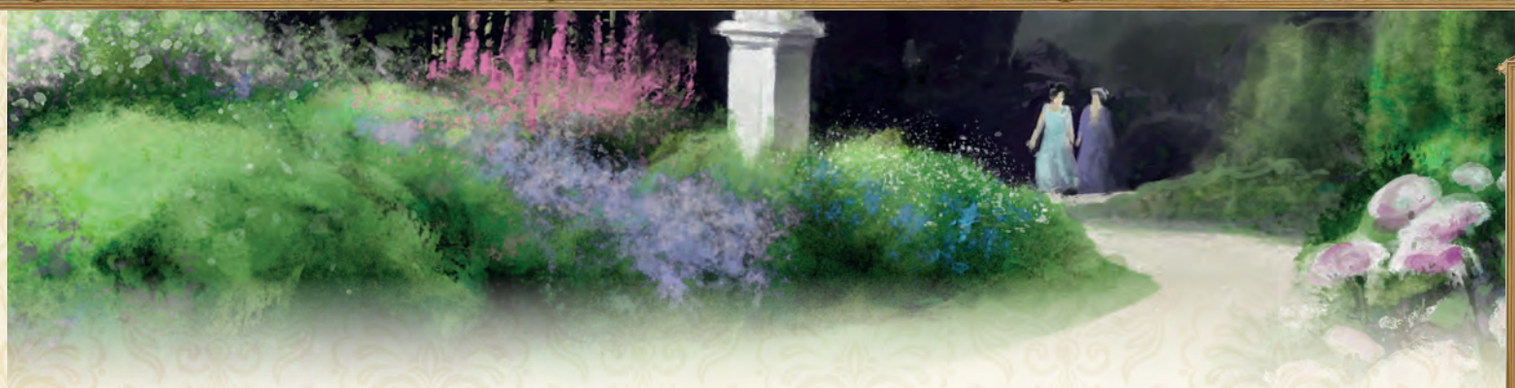
GAMEPLAY

At the start of each season, do **not** reveal a new theme. Instead, reveal a theme at the start of each **courtship event**. The winner is determined as normal.

Note that during the **final season**, you will still know 3 of the 4 themes that will be used in final courtship and can plan accordingly.



Note: The Jane Austen Courtship Variant is required when playing **Solo** (pg. 54).



4.12 QUEEN VICTORIA MARKET VARIANT

- **What is it?** At the end of each round, the leftmost tile in the Builders' Market is removed.
- **Why use it?** Offers more variety, limits market stagnation, and helps with tile objectives.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Incompatible with:	**(U)** Solo Estate Challenge

GAMEPLAY

At the end of each round*, before advancing the round marker, remove the tile(s) from the £300 space of the Builders' Market and refill it as usual. Return the removed tile(s) to the bag.

*On the last round of a season, do not remove the tile from the £300 space, but instead **refresh** the Builder's Market (pg. 41).

4.13 CHARLES DICKENS CLIFFHANGER COURTSHIP VARIANT

- **What is it?** An optional variation on courtship rules where each season's theme is revealed at the start of a randomised round.
- **Why use it?** Creates a unique, unpredictable flow to each game.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	Solo Components (base game) • d20 Solo Dice (1)
Incompatible with:	**(1P)** Solo Mode **(U)** Tableau Mode **(U)** Dynamic AI Variant **(U)** Solo Estate Challenge **(C)** Cooperative Mode Other Courtship Variants

GAMEPLAY



At the start of each season, roll the d20 solo dice to determine when the next theme will be revealed:

- **1-5:** Reveal the theme card immediately.
- **6-10:** Place the dice on the 2nd round of the season on the round track.
- **11-15:** Place the dice on the 3rd round of the season on the round track.
- **16-20:** Place the dice on the next courtship on the round track.

If the dice is placed on the round track, reveal the theme card immediately when the round marker reaches it.

(X) In an extended game, use the following dice results instead:

- **1-4:** Reveal the theme card immediately.
- **5-8:** Place the dice on the 2nd round of the season on the round track.
- **9-12:** Place the dice on the 3rd round of the season on the round track.
- **13-16:** Place the dice on the 4th round of the season on the round track.
- **17-20:** Place the dice on the next courtship on the round track.

CHAPTER 5. SOLO PLAY

The central gameplay mechanic of *Obsession* is the hosting of social activities, which is an action that takes place independent of one's competitors. As a result, *Obsession* naturally lends itself to solo play. Starting with a solo game is the very best way for a new player to learn the game.

Designer's Note: *My advice for every new player is to begin with a solo game. Not only will the thematically coherent rules fall into place, but you see the central puzzle of the game in action: the interaction of reputation, guests, servants, and improvements, which will greatly help you learn the game.*

5.1 SOLO MODE

- **What is it?** A simulated 2-player game against an AI opponent of varying difficulty. The AI takes tiles from the market, competes in courtship events, and scores VP at game end.
- **Why use it?** Experience the theme and strategy of *Obsession* in a solo setting. Test your skills and see how you measure up!

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	Solo Components (base game) • d20 Solo Dice (1) • Solo AI Card (1) • Solo Opponent Cards (12) Jane Austen Closed Courtship Variant (pg. 52)
Recommended:	Expansion Solo Opponent Cards (required for extended games) **(U)** *Upstairs, Downstairs* Opponents (6) **(W)** *Wessex* Opponents (6) **(C)** *Characters* Opponents (14)
Incompatible with:	**(U)** Milestones Module **(U)** Low VP Monuments **(U)** Team Mode **(U)** Tableau Mode **(C)** Cooperative Mode



SETUP

(1P) The following setup steps are also listed in Integrated Setup (pg. 6).

Follow Player Setup, but set up your **own play area only**, with the following changes:

- **First Player** (Step 1): You are always the first player.
- **Family Draft** (Step 2): Choose any family board for yourself. Then choose a **solo opponent card** of your desired difficulty and place it face up near your family board, along with the d20 solo dice.
  - If you are using an **Expanded Family Draft** (pg. 14), set up the draft for 2 players and choose any combination of available starting options. Your opponent does not participate in the draft.
  - **(U) (C) (W)** If using expansions, make sure to choose a **solo opponent** who is compatible with those expansions (see next section).
  - **(U)** If using the **Dynamic AI variant** (pg. 57) included with *Upstairs, Downstairs*, replace the standard solo AI card with the **dynamic AI card**.
- **(C) Objectives** (Step 9): If using the **replacement objective deck** from *Characters,* remove the following objectives (in addition to any objectives for expansions you are not using):
  - **(C)** All Majority Bonuses
  - **(C)** Largest Estate Tableau Bonus, Country Living Estate Tableau Bonus, and Traditional Estate Tableau Bonus

Follow Central Play Area Setup for **2 players**, with the following changes:

- **Alderley Hall** (Step 8): Use the side of the board required by your chosen solo opponent (see Appendix G, pg. 113).
- **Theme & VP Cards** (Step 10): Do not reveal a theme card.

SOLO OPPONENTS

Each solo opponent card lists a **difficulty level** (beginner, intermediate, or expert) and shows how your opponent will score each tile category during **courtship events**. It also shows the **base VP value** they score at the end of the game. See End Game Scoring, pg. 56.

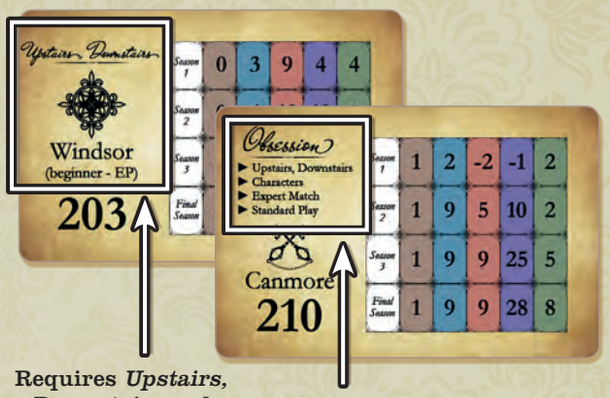
For a detailed list of solo opponents, see Appendix G: Solo Opponents, pg. 113.

SOLO OPPONENT CARD ANATOMY



(X) Expansion solo opponents marked 'EP' or 'Extended Play' are used in **extended games**. All other opponents are used in standard-length games (including all base game opponents).

(U) (C) Expansion solo opponents may indicate one or more **required expansions** in the top left.
If *Upstairs, Downstairs* or *Characters* is **not** listed among an opponent's required expansions, it should **not** be used with that opponent. The *Wessex* expansion can be used with **any** solo opponent (since it does not affect scoring).



Requires *Upstairs, Downstairs* and EP, meaning (X) Extended Play

Requires both *Upstairs, Downstairs* and *Characters* expansions

(W) Opponents included in the *Wessex* box require the base game only (they are incompatible with *Upstairs, Downstairs* and *Characters*).

GAME TURNS

During your turn, follow all normal game rules, **but note the Rule Exceptions, pg. 56**.
During your opponent's turn, follow the steps below.

ORDER OF PLAY (AI TURN)

1. **Check for Monuments:** If there is at least 1 monument in the Builders' Market, your opponent uses the 'Monument Turn' column on the solo AI card this turn. Otherwise, they use the 'Standard Turn' column.
2. **Acquire from Market:** Roll the d20 solo dice and resolve the matching-numbered result on the solo AI card (in the appropriate column).
   - **1-15 (Standard Turn):** Your opponent takes the indicated tile (or tiles) from **one space** in the Builders' Market.
   - **1-15 (Monument Turn):** Your opponent takes the indicated tile (or tiles) from **one space** in the Builders' Market. If there is more than one monument, the AI targets the least expensive one.
   - **16-19:** Your opponent doesn't do anything.
   - **20:** Your opponent refreshes the Builders' Market (pg. 41).
3. **Advance Round Marker:** Advance the round marker 1 space.



Solo AI Card

TAKING TILES

When your opponent rolls a numbered **position**, they take **all** tiles in the corresponding space on the Builders' Market track (including duplicates). Market track spaces are numbered 1-6 from left to right (£300 to £800). They **never** take tiles from the Builders' Reserve.

All tiles your opponent takes from the Market are permanently removed from the game; do not return them to the draw bag. After your opponent takes tiles, **refill** the Market normally (pg. 41).

EXAMPLE: NUMBERED POSITIONS



ROLL MODIFIER

If your opponent does **not** take a tile on their turn (on a roll of 16-20), their roll result is reduced by **5** on their following turn (you may want to use a reminder token or place the solo dice on the solo AI card as a reminder). If the modifer would reduce the result to **less than 1**, the value is 1.

COURTSHIP

At the start of each courtship event, reveal the top **theme card** and place it face up above the round track (to the right of the previous theme, if there is one). Resolve the courtship event using the newly drawn theme. (**Note:** This courtship variant is known as the Jane Austen Closed Courtship, pg. 52.)

Add up your theme score normally. Find your opponent's theme score using the **courtship table** on their card. If you win or tie courtship, you receive the normal rewards. If your opponent wins or ties, place a VP card face down next to their opponent card, without revealing it. They do not claim a Fairchild card (except during final courtship; see below).

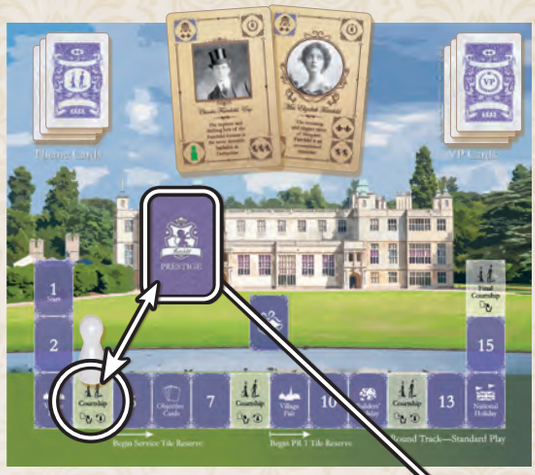
After courtship, follow the normal end of season steps, but do **not** pass the first player marker anticlockwise. You keep the first player marker throughout the game.

FINAL COURTSHIP

Instead of scoring a single seasonal theme, you add up the VP values of improvement tiles in **all categories on the 4 theme cards** revealed during the game. You then compare that total to the total of the same 4 categories in the bottom row of the AI courtship table. If any 2 face up theme cards show the **same category**, both you and the AI count double the VP value of tiles in that category.

The winner draws a VP card and claims a Fairchild card to score their VP.

EXAMPLE: SOLO COURTSHIP SCORING



At the end of season 1, a Prestige theme is revealed. Eden's theme score is 3. You need at least 4 VP from Prestige tiles to win the courtship!



END GAME SCORING

Add up your score normally. Then reveal your opponent's VP cards and add up the following to get their score:

- The **base VP value** on their solo opponent card
- The total VP from **VP cards** they drew during courtship events
- The VP on their **Fairchild card**, if they won final courtship

If your score is equal to or higher than your opponent's, you win.

Monument Challenge Variant: If you wish to increase the difficulty of an opponent beyond expert level, add the total VP from monuments they took during the game to their final score.

RULE EXCEPTIONS

- **Recruiting Servants:** Your opponent has no servants, so you can't recruit servants from their estate with an upgraded Butler's Room (pg. 30). You can hire servants normally.
- **Servants' Hall & Gossip:** Your opponent has no reputation and can't lose any. You still gain 1 reputation when using a Servants' Hall. Gossip favours that reduce reputation have no effect.

5.2 (U) DYNAMIC AI (DAI) VARIANT

- **What is it?** An alternate solo AI that more aggressively takes tiles and responds to courtship themes.
- **Why use it?** More dramatic and challenging gameplay that better simulates a human opponent.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	Solo Components (base game) • d20 Solo Dice (1) • Solo Opponent Cards (12) **(U)** Dynamic AI Card Jane Austen Closed Courtship Variant
Recommended:	Expansion Solo Opponent Cards (required for extended games) **(U)** *Upstairs, Downstairs* Opponents (6) **(W)** *Wessex* Opponents (6) **(C)** *Characters* Opponents (14)
Incompatible with:	**(U)** Milestones Module **(U)** Low VP Monuments **(U)** Team Mode **(U)** Tableau Mode **(C)** Cooperative Mode

SETUP

Set up Solo Mode (see 5.1, pg. 54), with the following changes:

- During Player Setup, replace the Solitaire Builder's Market AI with the **dynamic AI card**.
- As in the base game Solo Mode, closed courtship is used. The Courtship Monument and Courtship Tile options in the Value Tile Hierarchy refer to any previously revealed courtship theme. In season 1 (when no theme card is revealed), ignore these steps.



Dynamic AI Card

GAME TURNS

During your opponent's turn, follow the steps below (instead of the Solo Mode steps on pg. 55).

ORDER OF PLAY (DYNAMIC AI TURN)

1. **Acquire from Market:** Roll the d20 solo dice and resolve the matching-numbered result on the DAI card.
   - **1-8:** Your opponent takes the tile (or tiles) from the Builders' Market or Reserve it considers most **valuable**, according to its Value Tile Hierarchy (see below).
   - **9-18:** Your opponent takes the tile or tiles in the indicated position from the Builders' Market.
   - **19:** Your opponent doesn't do anything.
   - **20:** Your opponent refreshes the Builders' Market (pg. 41) then takes a Value Tile.
2. **Advance Round Marker:** Advance the round marker 1 space.

VALUE TILE SELECTION

Whenever your opponent takes a **Value Tile**, they take the tile they consider most valuable according to the Value Tile Hierarchy on the DAI card. Your opponent will consider tiles in **both** the Builders' Market and the Reserve.

For each step in the Value Tile Hierarchy, **your opponent always prioritises the least expensive tile**. They first try to take a monument tile or a regular tile matching any previously revealed courtship theme. If there are no such tiles, they try to take a non-courtship **monument**; then they try to take a **Prestige** tile; then an **Estate** tile; and so on. If there is a tie for least expensive, **you choose** which tied tile they take.

ROLL MODIFIER

If your opponent does **not** take a tile on their turn (on a roll of 19), their roll result is reduced by **2** on their following turn (instead of 5). If the modifer would reduce the result to less than 1, the value is 1.

COURTSHIP

Follow all Solo Mode courtship rules on the previous page.

5.3 (U) SOLO ESTATE CHALLENGE VARIANT

- **What is it?** A solo experience without courtship that emphasizes tableau building.
- **Why use it?** Makes for a much more puzzle-like game with full information to plan your country estate.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:

d20 Solo Dice (base game)
(U) *Upstairs, Downstairs* Expansion
(U) Estate Challenge Components
Tableau Mode Alderley Hall Board (1)
Solo Estate Counters (7)

Incompatible with:

(U) Low VP Monuments Module
(U) Milestones Module
(U) Dynamic AI Variant
(C) *Characters* Expansion
(C) Distinguished Family Members Module (pg. 50)
(B) Backer-Developed Promo Tiles
Intensive Service Setup Variant
Courtship Variants



(X) Extended Game Target VP Value (188)

Standard Game Target VP Value (132)

SETUP

Follow Player Setup for Standard Solo Mode (see 5.1, pg. 54), with the following changes:

- **Family Draft** (Step 2): Use the Expanded Family Draft to select your family and starting servant (pg. 14). Do not select a solo opponent or use the solo AI card.
- **Objectives** (Step 9): Do not deal any objective cards.

Follow Central Play Area Setup for Solo Mode, with the following changes:

- **Objective Deck** (Step 2): Remove all Group Bonus cards from the objective deck (along with all objectives removed in normal Solo Mode). Shuffle and place the deck on the board, as normal.
- **Monuments** (Step 5): Find the 6 base game monuments. Remove the **Garden Maze** from the game, then stack the remaining 5 monuments in order of **tile sorting number**, from lowest (top) to highest (bottom). Place the full stack on the rightmost space on the Builders' Market track.
- **Improvement Tiles** (Step 6): Do not use the tile draw bag. Instead, take out **1 copy** of every improvement tile, excluding **hybrid tiles**. Return all duplicates and hybrid tiles to the box.
- **Builders' Market** (Step 7)**:** Sort the non-monument tiles by **tile category** (Sporting, Prestige, etc). As with the monument tiles, stack all tiles in each category in order of **tile sorting number**, from lowest (top) to highest (bottom). Place each stack on the Builders' Market track as shown in the diagram below. Below each stack, place the **solo estate counters** with the matching market price (e.g., place the £300 counter below stack in the £300 space).
- **Alderley Hall** (Step 8): Use the Tableau Mode Alderley Hall board instead of the standard one, flipped to the side with the continuous round track.
  - **(X)** Use the same side of the board for a standard-length or extended game.
- **Theme & VP Cards** (Step 10)**:** Theme cards are not used.
- **Fairchilds** (Step 11): The Fairchilds are not used.

SETUP EXAMPLE: SOLO ESTATE COUNTERS





OVERVIEW

In this solo challenge, your goal is to **complete your tableau** before the round marker reaches the **target round** on the Alderley Hall board. The target round for a standard-length game is highlighted in **yellow**. For an extended game, it is highlighted in **red**.

To complete your tableau, you must meet **all 3** of the following conditions:

- Fill each column of your tableau with the **max number of tiles** (see below)
- **Upgrade** all tiles in your tableau that can be upgraded
- Reach **max reputation level**

When you complete your tableau, you add up your score and compare it to the **target VP value** printed on the Alderley Hall board (see diagram, left). If you score higher than the target value, you win.

TABLEAU SIZE RESTRICTIONS

In a standard-length game, you can have a maximum of **3 tiles** in each column of your tableau. In an extended game, the maximum is **4 tiles**.

If you ever **exceed** the maximum in any column, you must immediately **discard** a tile of your choice from that column. The discarded tile is removed from the game (do not return it to the market). If you discard a tile that provides an ongoing effect this way, you lose its effect.

GAMEPLAY

There are no seasons or courtship events during the game. Take your turns continuously, one after another. Follow all normal turn steps, with the exceptions described below.

GRAND BALL



The Tableau Mode Alderley Hall board includes a new **round track event**. It is resolved the same way as other events, with the following effect: **Draw 3 prestige guests, choose 1 to keep, and dismiss the others**.

BUYING FROM THE MARKET

When buying tiles from the Builders' Market, follow these modified rules:

- You may buy **any tile** from **any stack** on the board. You must pay the market price printed above the stack plus the price modifier on the tile. (**Note:** All tiles in each stack are public, and you may look through them at any time.)
- You may buy **any number** of tiles on your turn, provided you can afford them.
- Do not refill the Market after buying tiles.
- During each **Builders' Holiday** event, all tiles are discounted by £100.
- The **Builders' Reserve** is not used during the game.

REMOVING TILES AT END OF TURN

At the end of each turn, you must randomly select 1 tile from the Builders' Market to **discard** from the game.

To do this, roll the d20 solo dice and find the **solo estate counter** that includes your result in its number range. If you rolled the **lowest** number in the counter's range, remove the **top** tile on the corresponding stack from the game. If you rolled the **second-lowest** number, remove the **second** tile from the top of the stack (and so on). If there is no tile corresponding to the number you rolled, do **not** remove a tile this turn. (This includes when you roll a 19 or 20.)

After you roll, advance the **round marker** 1 space on the round track and begin your next turn.

> **Critical Rule:** You cannot remove a tile that would make it **impossible** for you to complete your tableau. Whenever you would do so, ignore your roll result and do not remove a tile that turn.

EXAMPLE: REMOVING TILES

In a standard-length game, you have 2 Service tiles out of the 3 you need in your tableau. You roll a 1, matching the Service stack. However, there is only 1 tile left. Since removing it would mean you can't complete your tableau, you ignore your roll.



OBJECTIVES

You do not draw any objectives at setup and don't discard any during the game. You may still draw objectives using the Main Library and VP cards. These objectives are scored normally.





GAME END & SCORING

When you have fulfilled all 3 conditions to **complete your tableau**, the game ends at the end of your current turn (before advancing the round marker).

Count your VP in each category as you would in a normal multiplayer game (pg. 24). Add a **VP bonus or penalty** based on the final position of the round marker relative to the highlighted **target round** space on the track.

- If you completed your tableau **during** the target round, you get **no** bonus or penalty.
- If you completed your tableau **before** the target round, you get a **bonus**. Score **+5 VP** for each round you finished early.
- If you completed your tableau **after** the target round, you get a **penalty**. Lose **5 VP** for each round you finished late (i.e., if you finish 4 rounds late you lose 20 VP).

Compare your final score to the **target VP value** printed next to the target round on the Alderley Hall board (132 VP for a standard-length game, 188 VP for an extended-length game). If you **beat** the target value, you win the game.

Opponent Challenge Variants: If you're ready to increase the difficulty of the Solo Estate Challenge, you can use the **base VP value** on a solo opponent card instead of the target VP value on the round track; you must use a solo opponent from base game or *Wessex* expansion. Optionally, add scavenged monument VPs to the solo opponent base score for ***maximum*** difficulty.



CHAPTER 6.
ALTERNATE GAME MODES

These 3 game modes—*Tableau*, *Team*, and *Cooperative*—are not variants, but complete game modes each with a specific emphasis.

Tableau Mode—aka *Obsession* Chess—removes almost all the thematic randomness that represents Victorian fate; *Team* Mode leverages the thematic fun of partnering with another player; and the *Cooperative* Mode challenges players to stop the loathsome Sneyd Family from stealing away the lovely Elizabeth.



6.1 (U) TABLEAU MODE

- **What is it?** An alternate game mode for 2-4 players that uses its own round track and has no courtship events. The game ends immediately when any player reaches max reputation.
- **Why use it?** Removes almost all thematic randomness and variability and makes the game much more chess-like.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	Reputation Level 7/8 Counters Reputation Level 9/10 Counters (2) **(U)** *Upstairs, Downstairs* Expansion Alderley Hall Board (1) **(U)** Low VP Monuments Module **(U)** Milestones Module
Incompatible with:	Team Mode **(5P+)** 5–6 Player Mode **(1P)** Solo Mode **(C)** *Characters* expansion **(C)** Cooperative Mode Courtship Variants

SETUP

During Player Setup, make the following changes:

- **Family Draft** (Step 2): Use an Expanded Family Draft to draft extra servants, starter guests, and distinguished family members, if desired.
- **Reputation** (Step 4): Each player adds a level **7/8** counter to their reputation counter stack.
  - With **2** players only, each player also adds a level **9/10** counter. Otherwise, return these to the box.
- **Objectives** (Step 9): Do not deal any objective cards.

During Central Play Area Setup, make the following changes:

- **Objective Deck** (Step 2): Remove all Group Bonus cards from the objective deck and place it on the board as normal. **Milestones:** Shuffle the milestone cards and deal **2** face up where everyone can see them. Return the rest to the box. Each player takes both milestone counters with their family's crest.
- **Monument Tiles** (Step 5): Add only the low VP monument tiles to the bag.
- **Alderley Hall** (Step 8): Use the Tableau Mode Alderley Hall board instead of the standard one, flipped to the side with the continuous round track.
  - **(X)** Use the same side of the board for a standard or extended-length game.
- **Theme & VP Cards** (Step 10): Theme cards are not used.
- **Fairchilds** (Step 11): The Fairchilds are not used.

GAMEPLAY

There are no seasons and no courtship events during the game. At the end of each game round, the last player moves the round marker 1 space anticlockwise on the round track. The player who starts with the first player marker keeps it throughout the game.

Apart from the elimination of courtship rounds, the turn structure is identical to the standard *Obsession* play, with players hosting activities and enjoying favours (see Order of Play, pg. 17).

If the round marker returns to the 'Start' space, players continue the game normally. The game ends when a player reaches the **maximum reputation level** (level 9 with 3+ players or level 11 with 2 players). When this happens, the active player finishes their turn and the game ends at the end of the current round.

Designer's Note: *In previous rulebooks, the game ended immediately when any player reached Max reputation. Based on community feedback, I now feel all players should have an equal number of turns.*

BUILDERS' MARKET & RESERVE

At the end of each round, remove the tile (or tiles) from the **leftmost space** in the Builders' Market, then refill the Market as normal (slide all other tiles left and draw a new tile for the rightmost space). Return the removed tile(s) to the bag (see Queen Victoria Market Variant, pg. 53).

At the end of the **3rd** round, move all Service tiles **and** PR1 1 tiles to the **Builders' Reserve**. The Reserve remains open for the rest of the game.

GRAND BALL



The Tableau Mode Alderley Hall board includes a new **round track event** with the following effect:

Before the first player starts their turn this round, each player **draws 3 prestige guests, chooses 1 to keep, and dismisses the others**. Players draw guests in turn order.

OBJECTIVES

Players do not draw any objectives at setup and don't discard any during the game. You may still draw objectives using the Main Library and VP cards. These objectives are scored normally.



END GAME SCORING

Players add up their final VP as follows.

TABLEAU MODE: VP SOURCES

Improvement Tile VP	**Total** VP from improvement tiles
Gentry VP	Only **negative** VP from unsavoury guests (do not score positive guests)
Objective VP	**Total** VP from milestones and objectives (if any)
Reputation VP	**Total** VP from reputation*
Service VP	**No** VP from servants
Wealth	**No** VP from money
VP Cards	**Total** VP from VP cards

**With 2 players, reputation levels 10 and 11 score 55 VP and 66 VP, respectively.*

END GAME TIEBREAKERS

In a tie, the player with the highest score in the **improvement tile** category wins. If still tied, the player who reached max reputation level wins (it is not possible to play a VP card after a player reaches Max reputation).



6.2 TEAM MODE

While gossip was the lifeblood of the Victorian social drama, enduring friendships and strategic relationships were not uncommon. What could be better than speaking truth about your self-promoting, unscrupulous neighbours? Why, doing it with the dearest of family friends, of course, over tea and biscuits.

- **What is it?** Players split into 2-player teams that compete against each other. Allied players coordinate objectives and work together by sharing money, gentry, and servants.
- **Why use it?** Combines elements of cooperative and competitive play. Excellent for introducing new players to the game by pairing them with experienced partners.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:	4 or 6 players*
Recommended:	**(5P+)** 5–6 Player Mode (required with 6 players)
Incompatible with:	**(1P)** Solo Mode **(C)** Cooperative Mode **(U)** Tableau Mode

**Four-player Team Mode was introduced in* Upstairs, Downstairs, *but does not require any special components and can be played, even if you do not own that expansion.*

SETUP

Before setup, players split into teams of 2 (2 teams with 4 players, 3 teams with 6). Teammates must sit across from each other, such that turn order alternates between teams.

During the family draft, teammates are free to discuss and coordinate their selections. Otherwise, follow all normal setup steps.



GAMEPLAY

Seasons, rounds, and turns are resolved as in a normal multiplayer game. However, throughout the game, players can **assist** their allies by sharing money, gentry cards, and servants (according to the restrictions detailed below). Allied players may also openly discuss strategy and show each other any secret information, such as objective cards, at any time.

At the end of the game, each team calculates a single score based on the average performance of both players (see End Game Scoring, pg. 65). When scoring objective cards, each team scores their best objectives between their players. The players on the team with the highest score win together.

RECEIVING ASSISTANCE

During your turn, you may receive assistance from an allied player in any or all of the following ways. Your ally must consent to giving assistance and can always decline (they may have other plans for their own resources). While providing assistance, your ally may spend their reputation to take **special actions**, such as borrowing money or refreshing servants (see Special Actions, pg. 27).

RECEIVING ASSISTANCE

Share Money	Your ally may give you up to **£200** on your turn.
Borrow Family or Starter Guests	Your ally may allow you to invite **family members** or **starter guests** from their hand to your activity. This includes ordinary family, distinguished family, starter guests chosen at setup, and starter guests acquired during the game (i.e., any guest with a ♔ under their prestige rating). You enjoy **all favours** from borrowed gentry who attend your activity as if you played them from your hand. At the end of your turn, return all gentry you borrowed to your ally's discard pile.
Share Servants	Your ally may allow you to use their **servants** in Available Service to provide service on your improvement tile and guests. At the end of your turn, return each allied servant to your ally's Expended Service.

Designer's Note: *The rules for team play in the* Upstairs, Downstairs *rulebook (pg. 12 of that book) included additional restrictions regarding borrowed family favours. This has been simplified so that the hosting player now enjoys all favours from both family and starter guests they borrow.*

TRACKING BORROWED COMPONENTS

During your turn, rotate any components you borrow from your ally sideways to distinguish them from your own. For servants, you may alternatively lay them down (or stand them up if you normally lay them down).

SERVICE ABILITIES

If your ally has any tiles that provide **service abilities** (pg. 30), their servants may use those abilities while visiting your estate. You must still meet any requirements to use each servant's ability (e.g., you must have no available valets to use the Brushing Room).

Servants you borrow do **not** gain service abilities from **your** tiles (they're only visiting for a short while, so there's no time to train them). You may place a borrowed servant on a Servants' Hall or Carriage House to use its effect as normal.

ASSISTANCE CLARIFICATIONS

- **Money Favours:** Money favours from borrowed gentry don't count towards the £200 per turn limit on sharing money.
- **Servants' Quarters:** The Servants' Quarters only allows a player to use their own servants in the Servants' Quarters, **not** share them. If an ally has the Servants' Quarters, you may still only borrow servants from their Available Service.
- **Borrowing SCS:** If you borrow second chance servants, you are subject to their reputation penalties (not your ally).
- **Borrowing Butler:** You may **not** use a borrowed butler (or underbutler) to hire new servants (ordinary or SCS). Only your own senior servants are qualified to check references for your household.
- **(U) Borrowing Supplemental Servants:** You may borrow a supplemental servant, even if you already have 1 of that servant in your employ. This can allow you to play more than 1 supplemental servant of the same type during your turn. However, you may **not** place more than 1 of the same supplemental servant on any **individual tile or guest**. (**Note:** This means you can only use 1 cook per turn, since the cook can only be placed on your current activity tile.)

END GAME SCORING

At the end of the game, each pair of allied players **combines** their individual scores in each VP category, as follows. The team with the highest combined score wins. (**Note:** When averaging a category, always round down.)

TEAM MODE: VP SOURCES

Improvement Tile VP	**Average** VP from improvement tiles
Gentry VP	**Average** VP from gentry
Objective VP	VP from **best 3** objectives (4 in an extended game)
Reputation VP	Total VP from the player with the **lowest** reputation*
Service VP	**Average** VP from servants
Wealth	**Average** VP from money
VP Cards	**Average** VP from VP cards

**Designer's Note:* *Using each team's lowest reputation score prevents any player from trashing their reputation to provide extra resources to their ally.*

OBJECTIVE SCORING

Each team only scores the **best 3** objectives they have between both players (or 4 in an extended game). Each allied player may contribute any number of scored objectives, as long as their team scores no more than 3 (or 4) in total. Each player only considers their own tableau, gentry, and resources when evaluating each objective (not their ally's).

Drawing extra objectives during the game using the Main Library or VP cards does **not** increase the number of objectives a team can score at end game, only the number they can choose from.



6.3 (C) COOPERATIVE MODE

A malevolence has cast a shadow over the Derbyshire hills. It is rumoured that the disreputable, mercantile Sneyd family hope to marry off their wantonly cruel, insipid heir, Oliver Sneyd, to the innocent Elizabeth Fairchild. The Sneyds have monopolised local craftsmen in an effort to transform their shabby estate, and have embarked on a campaign to blackguard upstanding families with scurrilous slanders that prejudice the Fairchilds against their neighbours.

The local upstanding families have united in opposition to the grasping Sneyd clan, declaring that they shall rally together to defend Derbyshire honour!

- **What is it?** Players band together to take on the devious Sneyd family, coordinating their objectives and working together by sharing money, gentry, and servants.
- **Why use it?** Presents a fully cooperative challenge for players of varying experience levels.

COMPONENTS & MODULES

Requires:

2 or 3 Players
d20 Solo Dice (base game)
(C) *Characters* Cooperative Components (pg. 5):

- Sneyd Family Board (1)
- Sneyd Gentry Cards (5)
- Fiery Sermon Cards (2)
- d6 Impropriety Dice (1)
- Scandal Markers (3)

(C) *Characters* Expansion
(C) *Characters* Replacement Objective Deck
(C) Distinguished Family Members Module
(C) Pony & Trap and Business Room Promo Tiles

Incompatible with:

(U) Low VP Monuments Module
(U) Milestones Module
(U) *Upstairs, Downstairs* Promotional Guests (marked with 'P'), except those added to Eccentric Dowager's Exiles
(B) Backer-Developed Promo Tiles
(1P) Solo Mode
(C) Team Mode
(U) Tableau Mode
Courtship Variants

SETUP

For setup purposes, the Sneyd family is **not** counted as a player (e.g., if you have 2 human players, set up a 2-player game).

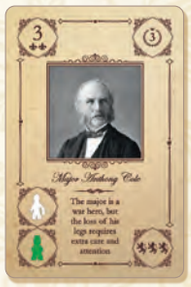
Follow **Player Setup** (pg. 8) with these changes:

- **Step 1:** The players choose who will be 1st player.
- **Step 2:** Lay out the family boards and prepare a draft pool including **extra servants**, **DFMs**, and **starter guests**, as you would during an Expanded Family Draft (pg. 14). However, instead of drafting normally, players discuss and choose their starting options in whatever order they like. The Sneyds do not participate in the draft.
  - With **2 players** only, draft 2 DFMs each (per the DFM 2–Player Variant, pg. 50).
  - If you are **not** using *Upstairs, Downstairs,* add 1 extra valet, lady's maid, and footman to Servants for Hire before drafting.
- **Step 10:** Use the *Characters* replacement objective deck. Before dealing, find the **4** cards marked with a **raven** (🐦‍⬛) in the top right—**2** objectives and **2** fiery sermons—and set aside the objectives for the Sneyd family and the sermons for Reverend Grantly.

Deal all players' objectives **face up**. Players may discuss and **exchange** their objectives as desired. Players may **only** exchange during setup, and each player must end up with the same number of objectives they were dealt.

Follow **Central Play Area Setup** (pg. 10) with these changes:

- **Step 4:** After shuffling the casual guest deck, draw until you find an **unsavoury** guest and place them face up above the casual deck to start the **dismissed pile**. Shuffle all other guests drawn back into the deck.
  - **(X)** In an extended game, search the prestige guest deck for **Major Anthony Cole** and place him face up on the round track, above the second courtship event space. Then shuffle the prestige deck as normal. (In a standard-length game, leave Major Cole in the deck.)

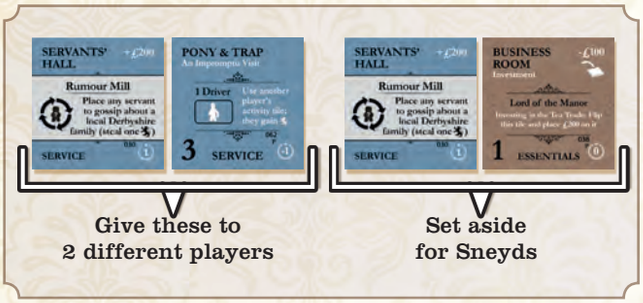


- **Step 5:** When adding monument tiles, use only the original high VP monuments from the base game.
  - **2 players:** Choose 4 monuments (max 1 Estate)
  - **3 players:** Choose 5 monuments (max 1 Estate)

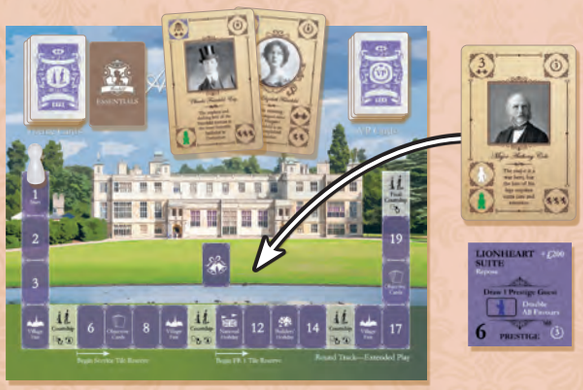
(continued on the following page)



- **Step 6:** Before filling the tile draw bag, take out **2 Servants' Halls**, **1 Business Room**, and **1 Pony & Trap**. Choose 1 player to start with a Servants' Hall in their tableau, and another player to start with the Pony & Trap. Set aside the other Servants' Hall and the Business Room for the Sneyds.



- **(X)** In an extended game, instead place the Servants' Hall and Pony & Trap in the **Builders' Reserve**. Also take out the **Lionheart Suite** and place it on the round track with Major Cole.



Follow *Characters* Sideboard Setup (pg. 13) with these changes:

- **Step 3:** When placing objective cards in Reverend Grantly's pile, add his **2 fiery sermons** (so there are 6 cards total).

REDUCING DIFFICULTY

Cooperative play is intended to be **challenging**. If you are struggling or would prefer a more relaxed experience, you can modify setup in any or all of the following ways:

- **More DFMs:** With 3 players, each player replaces **any 2** family members with their distinguished versions. Duplicate titles are allowed. With 2 players, each player replaces **all** family members with DFMs. (Do not use the Howard family with this change.)
- **Starting Sermons:** Instead of placing the fiery sermons in the Reverend's pile, choose 2 players to start with 1 sermon face up in their play area.
- **Improved Bonuses:** Each family gets the following improved starting bonus:

COOPERATIVE MODE: FAMILY BONUSES

Asquith	Start with the Dowager Countess and take the **2 starter guests** left at the end of the draft
Cavendish	Start at reputation **level 2**, position 4
Ponsonby	Start with **£600**
York	Start with an extra **footman** and **lady's maid**
(W) Wessex	Start with **both** the Breakfast Room and Tennis Court ( )
(U) Howard	Start with a **cook** and a **hall boy**

PLAYING WITHOUT *UPSTAIRS, DOWNSTAIRS*

When playing without the *Upstairs, Downstairs* expansion, it is strongly recommended to make all of the reduced difficulty setup changes above. Players will need these extra advantages to compensate for not having access to supplemental servants.

SNEYD FAMILY SETUP

After setting up the central play area, follow these steps to set up the Sneyd family:

1. **Family Board:** Choose a play area for the Sneyds between any 2 players. Place their family board and a tile organiser there, with their d6 impropriety dice and the d20 solo dice from the base game nearby.
2. **Reputation:** Set the Sneyds' reputation to **level 1, position 4** (using a reputation marker and set of counters from the base game).
3. **Starting Money:** Place **£1200** in the Sneyds' play area as their starting money supply.
4. **Scandal Markers:** Place the 3 red markers above the Sneyds' Scandals table.
5. **Starting Servants:** Place a set of 5 starting servants **plus** 1 SC lady's maid and 1 SC footman in **Rotters**. (**Note:** Take these servants from the box, not Servants for Hire or Higbee's.)
6. **Starter Tiles:** Place a set of 5 starter tiles below the Sneyds' organiser, along with the **Business Room** and **Servants' Hall** set aside earlier. Immediately **upgrade** all of their tiles (except the Servants' Hall).
7. **Business Room & Servants' Hall:** Take £200 from the Sneyds' starting money and place it on their Business Room. Place their SC footman on the Servants' Hall.
8. **Family Members:** Find the Sneyds' **3** family member cards. Place **Oliver** face up in the Sneyds' play area, then stack **Cosima** and **Enoch** face down next to him (in any order) to create the Sneyds' discard pile.
9. **Guests:** Find the Sneyds' **2** starting prestige guests (marked with a **raven** in the top left) and draw **1** more prestige guest from the deck, so that they have **3 guests** total. Arrange them in a face up row from lowest to highest **prestige rating (PR)**. This is the Sneyds' prestige guest display. (Guests with the same PR can be in any order.)
10. **Objectives:** Place the Sneyds' **2** starting objective cards (marked with a **raven** in the top right corner) face up in their play area.



Designer's Note: *The Sneyd family's starting resources reflect that they have already enjoyed favours from their 3 family members, as well as the front side of all their tiles (which have been upgraded as a result). They have not yet enjoyed favours from any prestige guests, since their reputation level is not high enough (pg. 26).*

- *Private Study, Servants' Hall: No immediate resources*
- *Butler's Room: +2 second chance servants*
- *Main Gazebo: +1 prestige guest*
- *Front Parlour: +3 reputation*
- *Bowling Green, Sneyd Family Members: £1200 starting money*
- *Business Room: -£200 starting money*



OVERVIEW

The reputable families of Derbyshire have allied themselves against the reprobate Sneyds and must work together to stop them from laying claim to the Fairchild fortune.

All players play on the same team against an AI opponent, the Sneyd family. Unlike solo opponents, the Sneyds take turns throughout the game, collecting reputation and money, building their estate, and inviting guests—but at a much more rapid and aggressive rate than any one normal player.

At game end, the allied players calculate a **single** score based on their average performance. If they manage to outscore the Sneyd family, they win.

GENERAL GAMEPLAY CHANGES

ROTATING SERVICE

During a cooperative game, players do **not** rotate service at the start of their turns (when Hosting an Activity, skip step 1 in the Order of Play). Instead, all players rotate service at the start of each round, when the round marker advances. (The Sneyds never rotate service.)

Designer's Note: *This allows players to better plan how they will share their pool of servants during the round.*

DISMISSING CASUAL GUESTS

Whenever a player dismisses a casual guest, instead of placing them on the bottom of the deck, place them face up on the **dismissed pile**. Similarly, whenever a player screens casual guests, place any they don't keep on the dismissed pile. If a player dismisses more than 1 casual guest at once, they may place them on the dismissed pile in any order.

Only **casual** guests are ever placed on the dismissed pile. Prestige guests who are dismissed (screened) are still placed on the bottom of their deck.

Designer's Note: *A core weakness in the Sneyds' scheme to win over the Fairchilds is that they attract cads, gossips, and scoundrels like flies. Instead of drawing new casual guests from the deck, like players do, the Sneyds draw casual guests from the dismissed pile (pg. 70). Clever players can use this to fill the Sneyds' gentry with rubbish.*

THE SNEYD FAMILY



Enoch Sneyd despises the aristocracy. He will exact retribution by foisting his insipid son on them.

MONEY

Whenever the Sneyds collect or spend money, they use their **money supply**. If they don't have enough money to pay a cost or penalty, they must spend **reputation** to pay the difference (at the usual rate of 2 reputation per £100). If they don't have enough reputation to pay the full cost, they pay as much as they can. They still gain any benefit attached to the cost (as if they had paid in full).

ACQUIRING TILES

The Sneyds acquire all tiles from the Builders' Market and Reserve **for free**. They never pay any tile's market price or price modifier (pg. 72).

BUSINESS ROOM

The Sneyds start with an **upgraded** Business Room and add £200 to it from the supply each turn (Step 2: Business Room, pg. 71). Money on their Business Room is not part of their money supply, and they will never spend it during the game, even if their supply is empty. This money is **only** used to score VP at game end (pg. 75).

REPUTATION

The Sneyds gain and lose reputation the same as players do. Whenever they exceed **maximum reputation** (max level, position 5), they immediately spend 2 reputation to gain £100 (before gaining any additional reputation).

SERVANTS

The Sneyds never expend or rotate servants and never hire or recruit new ones (except if they acquire a Butler's Pantry). Their starting servants score VP normally at end game. Players may recruit servants from the Sneyds using an upgraded Butler's Room.

CASUAL GUESTS

Whenever the Sneyds invite a casual guest, they take the top guest on the **dismissed pile** and place them face down on their **discard pile**. The Sneyds will score the guest's VP at game end, but will never enjoy their favours.

If the dismissed pile is empty when the Sneyds invite a casual guest, they instead draw a casual guest from the deck. Place the guest face down on their discard pile **without revealing them**.

PRESTIGE GUESTS

Whenever the Sneyds invite a prestige guest, they reveal the top guest from the prestige deck and add them to their **prestige guest display**, face up. Their display must always be ordered by prestige rating (PR), from lowest (left) to highest (right). Whenever there is a **tie** in PR, **newer** guests are placed to the right of other guests with the same PR.

EXAMPLE: PRESTIGE GUEST DISPLAY



All guests are ordered by prestige rating (PR) from lowest to highest, left to right.

PRESTIGE GUEST LIMIT

The Sneyds can have a maximum of **5** prestige guests in their display at a time. Prestige guests in their discard pile don't count towards this limit. If the Sneyds' display is **full**, and they invite another prestige guest, place the new guest face down on their **discard pile** without revealing them. The Sneyds' do not enjoy their favours. (**Note:** The Sneyds may temporarily go over their prestige guest limit during the Enjoy Guest Favours step of their turn; pg. 72).

GENTRY DISCARD PILE

Once the Sneyds discard a gentry card, they never draw or reveal it again during the game. Gentry in their discard pile are only kept to score **VP** at end game. Players may not look through the Sneyds' discard pile (until end game scoring).

SCREENING & DISMISSING GUESTS

Whenever the Sneyds would screen a guest (e.g., draw 2, keep 1), they draw **only** the number they are entitled to keep. The Sneyds do **not** dismiss guests and ignore all guest dismissal favours they would enjoy (pg. 72).

OBJECTIVES & VP CARDS

The Sneyds do **not** draw or discard any objectives during the game. At the end of the game, they **only** score their 2 starting objectives.

When the Sneyds draw a VP card from a courtship event or favour, they place it face down next to their objectives. The Sneyds only reveal their VP cards during **end game scoring**, and never discard them for other benefits.

SNEYD TURNS

All families, including the Sneyds, take turns in normal clockwise order. The first player marker passes anticlockwise as usual at the end of each season and passes to the Sneyds if they're next in line.

ORDER OF PLAY: SNEYD FAMILY

On their turn, the Sneyds resolve the following steps:

1. ✓ Round Track
2. ✓ Business Room
3. ✓ Monuments
4. ✓ Servants' Hall
5. Enjoy Guest Favours
6. Acquire from Market
7. Impropriety Effects

STEP 1: ROUND TRACK

The Sneyds observe round track events as follows:

SNEYDS: ROUND TRACK EVENTS

Village Fair: The Sneyds start with their Private Study upgraded, so they receive its benefits during each Village Fair (£300 and 2 reputation).

Draw Objectives:
The Sneyds ignore this event.

Builders' Holiday: When the Sneyds acquire a tile from the Builders' Market this turn, they take additional tiles from the Reserve (see Step 6 on pg. 72).

National Holiday:
The Sneyds ignore this event.



STEP 2: BUSINESS ROOM

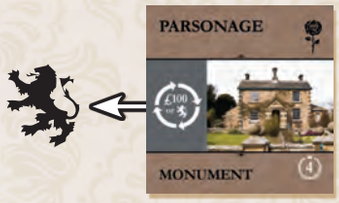
The Sneyds add £200 to their **Business Room**, using its 'grow investment' option. They never use the 'withdraw' option.



STEP 3: MONUMENTS

The Sneyds gain all benefits of any **monuments** they have. If given a choice between reputation or other benefits, they choose reputation.

If the Sneyds have a Parsonage, they will always choose to gain reputation instead of money.



STEP 4: SERVANTS' HALL

The Sneyds use their **Servants' Hall** to steal 1 reputation from a player (their SC footman stays on the tile as a reminder).



To determine whom they target, first check if any player would drop a full **reputation level** by losing 1 reputation. If there is such a player, the Sneyds target them; if not, they target the player with the **highest** reputation.

If multiple players would lose a reputation level, the Sneyds choose the one with the highest reputation. If multiple players are tied for highest reputation, players decide which of them is targeted. If all players are at minimum reputation, the Sneyds do not use their Servants' Hall (and do not gain 1 reputation).

EXAMPLE: SERVANTS' HALL



The Sneyds use their Servants' Hall to steal 1 reputation from a player. Since the Ponsonby player shown here will drop a full reputation level by losing 1 reputation, they will be the target.

STEP 5: ENJOY GUEST FAVOURS

In this step, the Sneyds take advantage of the charitable natures of Derbyshire's citizenry. Depending on the Sneyds' current reputation, they will enjoy favours from up to **3 prestige guests** in their display.

Start by checking whether the Sneyds' **reputation level** is high enough to meet or exceed the prestige rating of the **first guest** (leftmost) in their row. If it is, the Sneyds enjoy all of that guest's **favours**, then place the guest face down on their **discard pile**.

After the Sneyds resolve their first prestige guest this way, they slide the rest of their display left, then repeat with their next guest. They continue resolving guests until they have either resolved **3** total, or their **reputation level** is not high enough to resolve the next guest in their display.

EXAMPLE: ENJOY GUEST FAVOURS

The Sneyds are at reputation level 3, and have the following prestige guest display:



They enjoy favours from the first 2 guests in their row and discard them. They gain 1 , 1 new prestige guest (added to the end of their row), £200, and 1 casual guest from the dismissed pile (added to their discard pile). Their next guest requires level 4, so they don't resolve a 3rd guest. When finished, the display looks like this:



UNCOMMON FAVOURS

Whenever the Sneyds are granted a favour that is **not** reputation, money, a guest invite, or a VP card, they **ignore** it and gain no benefit. This includes favours that return gentry to hand, upgrade improvement tiles, or draw new objectives.

GUESTS INVITING GUESTS

When a prestige guest invites another prestige guest, the new guest is **always** added to the Sneyds' display, even if they are currently at their limit of **5** (see Prestige Guest Limit, pg. 70). This is because the guest who provided the invite will be discarded in short order, and the display will then return to 5 guests. (**Note:** There are no prestige guests who invite more than 1 other prestige guest.)

New guests invited this way are still placed in **prestige order**, and the Sneyds always resolve the **leftmost** guest in their display next. This means that if a new guest's PR is low enough, they will 'jump the queue' ahead of previous guests, and may even grant favours in the same turn they are drawn.

STEP 6: ACQUIRE FROM MARKET



In this step, the Sneyds leverage their shady business dealings to expand their manor and gain many benefits.

Start by rolling the **d20 market dice** and consulting the Sneyds' Market Selection table to see which tile or tiles they select from the Builders' Market or Reserve. Once the Sneyds have selected a tile or tiles, they acquire them **without paying any money** and immediately enjoy **all favours** on the front side of the tile(s).

They then immediately **upgrade** each selected tile that can be upgraded (including hybrid tiles) and add them to their tableau. Afterwards, refill the Builders' Market as usual.

EXAMPLE: ACQUIRE FROM MARKET



The Sneyds roll an 18, corresponding to the 5th space in the market (£700). They take the Long Gallery from the 5th space (for free) and immediately gain 4 from it.

They then flip it to the improved side ( ) and add it to their tableau.



VALUE TILE SELECTION

When the Sneyds roll a **1-10** on the market dice, they acquire the tile they consider **most valuable** from the Builders' Market or Reserve, according to their Value Tile list (under the Market Selection table).

They first try to take a tile of the most recently revealed **courtship theme**; if there are none, they try to take a **monument**; then a **Prestige** tile; and so on. If they need to choose between tiles of the same type, they take the most **expensive** of them (factoring in price modifiers). If there is a **tie** for most expensive, they take the tied tile with the higher price modifier (usually the leftmost). If there is still a tie, players decide.

While selecting a Value Tile, the Sneyds ignore any tiles that are protected by **fiery sermons** (pg. 75). They will select a tile in the Reserve if it is the most expensive Value Tile.

MARKET REFRESH

If the Sneyds roll a **20**, they immediately **refresh the Builders' Market**, following all normal rules (pg. 41). They then select a Value Tile, as above.

TILE CLARIFICATIONS

- When the Sneyds acquire a **duplicate** of a tile they already have, immediately remove it from the game. The Sneyds gain no benefit from the tile and do not take a replacement.
- When the Sneyds acquire a **hybrid tile**, they enjoy its favours and flip it over.
- When the Sneyds acquire any **ongoing effect** tile that cannot be upgraded, they add it to their tableau and gain no other benefit.
- When the Sneyds acquire an **activity tile** that does not provide any favours they can enjoy, they acquire and upgrade the tile, but ignore the favours and gain no other benefit. (This includes the Heritage Suite and Queen's Suite, since the Sneyds do not play guests.)
- If the Sneyds acquire the **Lionheart Suite** from the market, they draw 1 prestige guest, immediately enjoy double the guest's favours (regardless of reputation level), and place the guest in their discard pile.

BUILDERS' HOLIDAY



During a Builders' Holiday, after taking a tile from the market, the Sneyds also acquire 1 tile from the prestige rating 1 Reserve **and** 1 tile from the Service Reserve. They select the tile with the highest **tile sorting number** from each Reserve area. If either Reserve area has **no tiles**, the Sneyds don't acquire a tile from that area. As usual, the Sneyds immediately enjoy all favours and immediately upgrade all tiles they acquire this way.

STEP 7: IMPROPRIETY EFFECTS

In this step, the Sneyds check whether there are any social consequences for their impropriety. Roll the d6 dice and resolve the indicated effect on their Impropriety table.



IMPROPRIETY TABLE

1-2 BIRDS OF A FEATHER
Unsavoury guests are drawn to the Sneyd family.
The Sneyds invite 1 casual guest (from the dismissed pile, if possible).

3 EMBARRASSMENT
The uncultured Sneyd family commits a social misstep.
The Sneyds lose 1 reputation.

4-5 PROFLIGATE HEIR
Oliver Sneyd seeks attention by spending money.
The Sneyds lose £200.

6 SCANDAL
The wicked underbelly of the Sneyd business empire is exposed. The allied players choose 1 major scandal (listed to the right of the Impropriety table) that doesn't have a marker on it. Place a marker on the chosen scandal and resolve its effect.

- **Corruption:** *Reverend Grantly learns of deplorable business practices in the family business empire.* Choose a player to take a fiery sermon from Reverend Grantly's pile (pg. 75). If there are no sermons in the Reverend's pile, nothing happens.
- **Disgrace:** *A reprehensible sin against propriety comes to light.* The Sneyds lose 3 reputation.
- **Bribery:** *Tainted Sneyd money is needed to forestall humanitarian labour legislation in Parliament.* The Sneyds lose £500.

REVEALED SCANDALS

Once a scandal has a marker on it, it has been revealed to the public. Its effect can't be resolved again until the marker is cleared. If all 3 scandals have been revealed, and the Sneyds roll another 6, clear all 3 markers **instead** of resolving a new scandal. The Sneyds suffer no other consequences for their impropriety that turn. The next time the Sneyds roll a 6, players may again choose and mark any scandal (they have discovered yet more Sneyd misdeeds to expose).

COURTSHIP

The Sneyds participate in each courtship event and tally their courtship score just like a player. If the Sneyds win courtship, they draw a **VP card** and claim **Elizabeth Fairchild** as a love interest for Oliver Sneyd (Yuck!). Place Elizabeth face up next to Oliver, then do the following:

- **First 3 courtships:** The Sneyds immediately enjoy all favours on both Elizabeth **and** Oliver. Elizabeth remains face up with Oliver until the next courtship. She is not part of the Sneyds' prestige guest display, and does not count towards their guest limit.
- **Final courtship:** The Sneyds do not enjoy any favours from Elizabeth or Oliver, but still claim Elizabeth to score her VP.

If there is a tie (between Sneyd and a player, between two players, three players, or everyone), all tied players draw a VP card, but no one chooses a Fairchild card.

Note: When the Sneyds **lose** courtship, they don't enjoy **any** favours (including from Oliver).

(X) FAMILY FRIEND

In an extended game, the Sneyds build a new guest suite at the end of season 2 in anticipation of their longtime family friend coming to stay with them.

After resolving the second courtship event, the Sneyds acquire the **Lionheart Suite** from the round track. They immediately enjoy its favours as usual, but instead of drawing a prestige guest from the deck, they invite **Major Anthony Cole** from the round track. They immediately enjoy double his favours (regardless of their current reputation level), then place him face down on their discard pile. Lastly, they upgrade the Lionheart Suite to its monument side and add it to their tableau.

COOPERATIVE PLAY

The allied players are not without advantages: they can **assist** each other by sharing money, gentry cards, and servants, and they have access to a variety of **new abilities** provided by their Servants' Hall and the sideboard characters.

ASSISTING ALLIES

During your turn, you may receive assistance from one or more allies, following the same rules used in **Team Mode** (pg. 64). This includes sharing money, borrowing family or starter guests, and sharing servants.

In a 3-player game, you may receive assistance from **both** allies in the same turn. However, the **total** amount of money you borrow from allies during a single turn may not exceed £200.

SERVANTS' HALL AND GOSSIP

Whenever you take any action that would **reduce an opponent's reputation** (e.g., gossiping at the Servants' Hall or enjoying a Gossip guest's favour), you may instead freely rearrange the casual guests in the dismissed pile in any order.

Additionally, if you have a Servants' Hall, you may **delay** using it until the Enjoy Favours step of your turn. This allows you to resolve any screening or dismissal favours **before** deciding whether to rearrange the dismissed pile.

EXAMPLE: GOSSIP



Place casual guests with negative VP on top of the dismissed pile, so the Sneyds have to take them first.

ALTERNATE CHARACTER FAVOURS

Reverend Grantly and Constable Bucket each provide modified favours. The Eccentric Dowager's favours are unchanged.



REVEREND GRANTLY

- Choose 1:
  - Take **1 fiery sermon** from the Reverend's pile; OR
  - Exchange **1-2 objectives** with the Reverend's pile. Pay £100 per card you acquired.

Taking a fiery sermon or exchanging at least 1 objective is mandatory. You may not take a fiery sermon if you already have one or if there are none left in the Reverend's pile.



CONSTABLE BUCKET

- Ignore all negative favours on **unsavoury guests** attending your current activity **AND** all reputation penalties from **second chance servants** you use this turn.
- **Dismiss** any number of unsavoury guests.
- Lose 2 reputation.

You may invite the Constable even if you have **no** unsavoury guests in your activity, hand, or discard pile. You may not ignore or dismiss American Heiresses.

FIERY SERMONS

At the request of the upstanding folk of Derbyshire, Reverend Grantly will deliver a sermon condemning mercantilism and use thinly veiled criticism of the Sneyds to convince local craftsmen to steer well clear of them.

When you gain a fiery sermon, place it face up in your play area. During the Sneyds' turn, after they roll the market dice to select a tile or tiles (Step 6: Acquire From Market, pg. 72), you may place your sermon on 1 of the selected tiles to prevent the Sneyds from taking it for the rest of this turn. They must immediately reroll their dice until they select a different tile or tiles. When they refill the market after acquiring tiles, discard the sermon you used back to the Reverend's pile.

SERMON CLARIFICATIONS

- Each player can only have **1** fiery sermon at a time, but any player can use their fiery sermon during the Sneyds' turn. Both sermons can be used in the same turn.
- A fiery sermon only protects a tile for 1 turn. On the Sneyds' next turn, they may again select any tile.
- Once a sermon is used and discarded, it can be acquired again by any player through the Reverend's favours or as a result of a Corruption scandal (pg. 73).
- If either the 1st or 2nd tile in the market is protected, the Sneyds must reroll any result of '1st and 2nd.'

END GAME SCORING

At the end of the game, the Sneyd family scores as a single player, but the allied players **combine** their scores in each category. If the player team has the higher score, they win together. If not, the Sneyd family wins.
(**Note:** When averaging a category, always round down.)

OBJECTIVE SCORING

Drawing extra objectives during the game using the Main Library and certain VP cards does not increase the number of objectives the allied players can score, only the number they have available to choose from.

To score a **Majority Bonus** objective, you only need to have more of the relevant type of tile than **1** adjacent family, which may be an allied player or the Sneyds. To score a **Tableau Bonus** that requires the most of one or more types of tiles, you must have more than **every** family, including each allied player and the Sneyds.

For details on types of objective cards, see Appendix E: Objective Cards, pg. 106.

COOPERATIVE MODE: VP SOURCES

	Sneyd Family	Player Team
Improvement Tile VP	**Total** VP from improvement tiles	**Average** VP from improvement tiles
Gentry VP	**Total** VP from gentry (include prestige guest display, discard pile, and Fairchild if won)	**Average** VP from gentry
Objective VP	VP from **2 starting** objectives	VP from **best 3** objectives across all players (4 in an extended game)
Reputation VP	**Total** VP from reputation	Total VP from the player with the **lowest** reputation
Service VP	**Total** VP from servants	**Average** VP from servants
Wealth	**Total** VP from money	**Average** VP from money
VP Cards	**Total** VP from VP cards	**Average** VP from VP cards

APPENDIX A: FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

GETTING STARTED

Q: I am new to Obsession, having recently purchased the base game and all expansions. I am bit overwhelmed. Where should I start?

A: Getting expansions right away can be challenging, so please set them aside for now. If you play just the base game to start, the experience will be smooth, and you'll quickly learn the mechanics.

- **First Game:** I recommend a solitaire game for your 1st play, even if you don't normally play solo. Solo teaches the flow without the bother of instructing someone else. Find a solo video on Youtube (I recommend jplay, search **jplay *Obsession***) and watch. Set up a relaxed solo game (pg. 54) against a Beginner opponent. Start hosting activities and make your best guess at the rules you're not sure about. **Play in the sandbox**. After you've done this, then go back and read the rulebook, and it will all fall into place; play one more solo game to lock it in.
- **First Multiplayer Game:** Do not play with more than three people in your 1st multiplayer game. Two is best.
- **First Expansion:** Add the *Wessex* expansion soon after you've played a multiplayer game. That expansion uses the base game rules.
- **Second Expansion:** After a couple serious games under your belt, add *Upstairs, Downstairs*, which is primarily about 4 new servants: the cook, hall boy, head housemaid, and useful man (pg. 31). Learning these will be easy now that you know how activities are hosted.
- After that, you're ready for anything, including *Characters* and wild *Promotional Tiles*!

CAT CARDS

Q: Are the two gentry cards featuring cats (Duchess Lilo and Princess Kiki) playable in the game?

A: Neither of these cards are playable gentry cards; they are included for fun. However, see the **Variant Catalogue** included in the *Characters* expansion for a community variant that uses the Duchess Lilo card.



COURTSHIP

Q: Do I host an activity on a Courtship Round?

A: No activity takes place. When you reach a Courtship Round, **do not** rotate service, take monument reputation, or use your Servants' Hall. Only a courtship event is resolved (see 2.2 Seasons & Rounds, pg. 16).

FAVOURS

Q: When I'm at my lowest reputation, can I take the -3 reputation favour from an American Heiress first (which doesn't hurt me) and then take the +3 reputation favour from my Front Parlour so that my reputation goes up?

A: No, this is not allowed. Always take positive favours before negative favours. Always total money in the same fashion (see Negative Favours, pg. 36).

Q: When I have a dismissal favour, do I have to dismiss a good (respectable) guest if I have no bad (unsavoury) guests?

A: No. Dismissal favours are always **optional**, and they are the **only optional favour** (see Dismissing Guests, pg. 36).

Q: If I am out of money, do I have to pay a pauper who attends an activity?

A: Yes. To play a pauper, you **must** be able to pay for them, and you **may** use favour money from the activity the pauper attends. You can also use the Borrow Money special action or a VP card. If you cannot pay, you cannot use any guest that requires money (see Negative Favours, pg. 36).

HOWARD FAMILY

Q: Why doesn't the Howard Family have Distinguished Family Members?

A: By far and away, the most powerful family bonus is the starting cook for the Howards. When compared to the Asquith family (1 extra family card) or the Cavendish family (a starting reputation of 1.4 instead of 1.1), it is no contest.* Adding DFM to the other families levels the playing field. Howard is still a valuable family because of the cook and the ability to combo with another *Upstairs, Downstairs* servant during the draft. **Thematically** (and humourously), the Howards feast so regularly and so well they don't have time for self-improvement.

** You will ask why I created such a powerful family bonus; I was intoxicated by the rich theme that comes with a legendary Victorian cook.*

OBJECTIVES

Q: My Animal Lover's Group objective card shows the rose ( ) side of the Hillside Kennels and Riding Stables, which means they have been upgraded. Do I need to flip these tiles to complete the objective?

A: No. To complete any objective that requires tiles, the player only needs to have the tiles in their tableau at the end of the game. **The tiles do not have to be upgraded** (see Group Objectives, pg. 42).
I apologise for using upgraded images!

ORGANISERS

Q: I play 6-player *Obsession*, so why do I have only 5 improvement organisers? Am I missing one?

A: You are not missing an organiser. Note that each family board has an integral organiser on one side, which 1 person must use when playing a 6-player game.

REPUTATION

Q: My reputation is 6.1, and I want to use the French Garden, but I don't have a bunch of servants I need. Can I use special actions to refresh a butler, footman, and 2 valets even though my reputation drops to 3.4?

A: Yes! Your reputation level must be greater than or equal to the prestige ratings (PR) on both tile and cards **before you begin Step 3** (Choose Activity). Think of it like this: At the end of Step 2 (a step where you often gain and lose reputation long before your activity takes place), your reputation level **for screening purposes only** is fixed for the rest of your turn. Let's call it **SRL** (screening reputation level). No matter what happens to your actual reputation level as you plan your activity, your **SRL** never changes. For this turn, you always screen with that **SRL** number. If your reputation level falls from 6 to 3 (!!!), it doesn't matter; you can still invite the Duke of Hazelton (PR6) to your French Garden party (PR6). You could even spend all your reputation down to 1.1 and still host your French Garden activity! Your bad management of the domestic staff and unseemly scrambling for funds is your little secret…**until** the society grapevine slowly discovers your bad form. You will suffer the consequences *next* round (unless your garden party was such a smashing success, your domestic sins will be forgotten).

Q: What do I do with all the wasted reputation I earn after reaching Max reputation?

A: So many things! A seasoned player lives for when they are at Max reputation because it allows frequent use of special actions. At Max reputation you still move the black hexagon (reputation marker) all the way to the Max.5 space. However, it **never** goes higher than Max.5, so you should immediately use special actions **before** taking your favour (i.e., before your reputation would exceed Max.5).

For example, let's say you earn a 5-reputation favour from the State Room, and you are at Max.3. **Before** you take that reputation favour, you should immediately take special actions—let's say **-6** reputation to gain £300—so that you don't waste any of it. You then take your State Room favour of 5 reputation, finishing at Max.2.

Special actions can be taken at any time on your turn, even in the middle of taking a favour (see Special Actions, pg. 27).

SERVANTS

Q: What use is the Butler's Room with the new rule that allows you to hire when passing?

A: When hiring on a pass turn, you must still **use your Butler's Room** as you would during a normal activity. You must still move the Butler's Room tile to your board, place your butler (or underbutler) on the tile, hire your servants, put your butler and the new hires into Expended Service, and upgrade your Butler's Room if you haven't already (see Butler's Room, pg. 88).

Q: What if I want to use the Butler's Room without passing? I don't want to pass, I just want to hire.

A: When passing, you get additional free benefits of refreshing servants and reclaiming your discard pile. At any time when you think it worthwhile to use the Butler's Room, it is always better to **also** refresh servants and take back your discard pile. Even if you want to hire on back-to-back turns (perhaps you want to fulfill a servant objective when you have no better options), you will **pass both those turns** and on the second turn you will have the advantage of refreshing your servants (see 2.5 Passing, pg. 21).

Q: There is only 1 lady's maid left in Servants for Hire. Can I hire a second chance lady's maid along with the regular lady's maid (using the Butler's Room)?

A: No. You cannot hire second chance servants (or an underbutler) with the Butler's Room. Hiring disreputable servants is a separate action that involves expending your butler **without using the Butler's Room**. Thematically, the butler is not interviewing good servants in his office but quietly visiting Higbee's seeking embarrassing, substandard help (pg. 34).

Q: I have an objective card requiring 11 servants! Do my second chance servants count?

A: No. Second chance servants **cannot** be used to complete objective cards or milestones (see Scoring Second Chance Servants, pg. 34).

SETUP

Q: Why do I have some extra tiles and Monuments?

A: EXTRA TILES—There are 4 tiles that have appeared in more than one expansion over the years (Barn, Brushing Room, Business Room, Alternate West Terrace). **You should never have more than 2 tiles** of any type in your bag, and that includes these 4 tiles. If you have extra, discard them.

MONUMENT TILES—There are two sets of Monument tiles, the originals from the base game and low VP Monuments from *Upstairs, Downstairs*. Each game, you will choose which set of Monuments to use.

Note: Tiles that convert from an activity to a monument (i.e., Lionheart Suite) are not considered Monuments and always go into the bag at setup (see Step 5 of section 1.2 Central Play Area Setup, pg. 10).

Q: I am confused about what tiles go into my bag at setup. Can you help?

A: All non-Monument tiles go in the bag for all player counts. **Note:** There are two sets of West Terraces: the base game version and an alternate West Terrace that has an ongoing dismissal effect once upgraded. Choose one set to use and return the others to the box; **never use all four** (see West Terrace, pg. 104).

SOLO

Q: If the standard AI rolls 16–19 (no purchase, so -5 on next roll) what should I do if my next roll is 2?

A: No negative numbers are used, so any roll of 5 or less will be 1, which means you remove the left-most tile in the market.

Q: What happens if I purchase 1 tile from a stack of 2 Breakfast Rooms in the market?

A: You take 1 and leave the remaining tile in the market.

SPECIAL ACTIONS

Q: I need a Cabinet of Curiosities for a big objective. Can I refresh the market more than once until I find it?

A: It depends. You can use the Borrow Money and Service Help special actions **any number** of times each turn (provided you have enough reputation), but you cannot use the Market Refresh special action more than **once per turn**. However, there are 3 other ways to refresh the market that can be used: 3 Market Refresh VP cards, retiring a useful man, and the Market Refresh passing benefit. Theoretically, you could refresh the market 6 times in one turn by:

1. Passing and taking the Market Refresh benefit,
2. Using a special action,
3. Using your 3 VP card Market refresh actions (in the unlikely event you had them), and
4. Retiring your useful man.

(See Refreshing The Builders' Market, pg. 41.)

STARTER GUESTS

Q: May I complain? It is a PAIN to take starter guests out the casual deck for the draft every game!

A: Never separate starter guests. Instead, shuffle the casual deck, flip it upside down and draw from the bottom until you have the required number of starter guests. Afterwards, shuffle in the 2 starter guests you didn't use.

THEME

Q: What is an Activity?

A: When you host a social activity (i.e., a recital in the Music Room), that is the focal point of a visit usually spanning several days. Travelling around the countryside in 1860s England was neither quick nor comfortable, and guests from some distance away would enjoy an extended stay.

It is important to realise that the activity is **not concurrent with the favours**. You are hosting two, maybe three, social events at your country estate per season, a time which spans many months. A visit is planned, provisions purchased, and the estate made ready, then guests arrive and enjoy some notable activity. Conversations begun on the Bowling Green carry over to the West Saloon and Music Room.

After a stay of several days, your guests slowly depart at their convenience. No pounds change hands, no new connections have yet been made, no local attitudes about your family have evolved, for no one is yet aware. There was an intriguing visit of some days that slowly sends out ripples through local society.

During the weeks following the visit, the consequences of your foray into high society come to fruition: servants proudly mention the name of a distinguished visitor; the Viscountess pens an invitation to new acquaintances for a game of Cassino in the Parlour; the Earl upon learning of unrest abroad instructs his business manager to be more conservative in the commodities market.

Thus are favours born.

TILES

Q: Can I use my Carriage House to increase the number of guests in a Suites tile?

A: Nothing can increase or decrease the one guest card required for all Suites tiles (see Socialites & Antisocialites, pg. 37). Note that the Glencora & Plantagenet Palliser promotional card is still one card and may be used (see Glencora & Plantagenet Palliser, pg. 85).

Q: My friend won a courtship because the Wine Cellar was in the reserve. Should it be in there?

A: The Largest Wine Cellar is a monument and **never** placed in the service Reserve (see Opening The Reserve, pg. 40).

Q: How do I use the Business Room?

A: The Business Room tile is played like a normal activity on the family board with only the Lord attending. The tile is then flipped and returned to your tableau (see Business Room, pg. 88).

Q: What is upgrading a Tile?

A: After a tile is used it is flipped over to its improved side, upgrading it. A tile that then has an upgrade icon ( ) stays in this improved state for the rest of the game. Hybrid (/) and flip ( ) tiles will continue to flip to the opposite side (as if upgrading it) following each subsequent use. (See Upgrading Improvements, pg. 39.)

Q: Are there any restrictions when using cards and service tiles that increase or reduce the number of guests at an activity?

A: Yes! If the current activity restricts the kinds of gentry that can attend, each additional gentry must follow these restrictions. No activity can be reduced to 0 guests.

Special cases:

- **SUITES:** No ability can increase the number of guests played in a suite (that would be a scandal!). Guests with attendee modifiers drawn via the Lionheart Suite should be reshuffled into the prestige deck and a new card drawn.
- **THEMATIC IMPROVEMENTS:** Additionally, the Parish Church **(U)** (pg. 98) and Summer House (front side only) **(B)** (pg. 102) have fixed guest counts for thematic reasons, and the guest count cannot be modified.
- **FAMILY:** Family-only activities cannot be modified by using the Carriage House **(U)** (pg. 89)—a conveyance sent from the estate to return/bring a guest—but may be increased by the Socialite ability of the **(C)** Dowager; however, with the family restriction, the extra gentry must be a family member (pg. 44).

Q: I am worried my tiles will get all scuffed up if I mix them in the bag thoroughly. Does that happen?

A: I know the rulebook uses the words 'thoroughly mix,' but that is synonymous with randomisation. If I were to say 'randomise your tiles,' it would raise many questions as to how.

If you want your tiles to stay nice and unmarked, avoid shuffling in the bag. I have had sets of tiles used in 50+ plays, and they were still in very good condition (little scuffing). I personally never shuffle in the bag.

When randomising, I stack and restack tiles on my table until mixed, very much like I stack and restack poker chips when playing poker. I then gently place them in my bag. When filling the market, I reach into a different location in the bag—top left, bottom middle, middle right, bottom left—and that works like a charm. No wear and tear and perfectly random. Give it a try!

VP CARDS

Q: At the end of the game, I realised my reputation was 2 short of Max. I had a VP card with a 3 reputation favour, but my husband said I couldn't use it. Is that right?

A: No! After the final courtship event, players always have a last chance to discard any of their VP cards to gain their printed benefits, if possible (see Discarding VP cards, pg. 42).

APPENDIX B: GENTRY CARDS

EXPANSION LEGEND: **(U)** *Upstairs, Downstairs* **(C)** *Characters* **(W)** *Wessex*

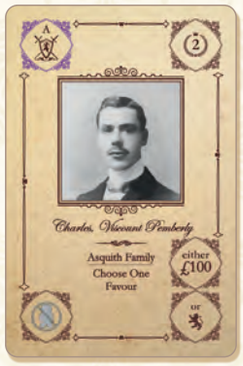
This appendix uses the following shorthand: **PR:** Prestige Rating **VP:** Victory Points

FAMILY MEMBERS

The Lord, Lady, Heir, and Young Lady of each family have identical effects. The Asquith's family advantage is the unique Dowager Countess.

Family do not have a Prestige Rating (PR) and may attend any activity, if they qualify.

FAMILY MEMBER – HEIR



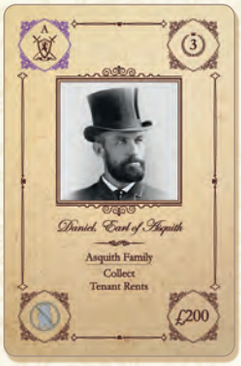
Service Requirement: None

Favour: Choose between—

- Gain £100, or
- Gain 1 reputation

PR: n/a **VP:** 2

FAMILY MEMBER – LORD OF THE MANOR



Service Requirement: None

Favour: Gain £200

PR: n/a **VP:** 3

FAMILY MEMBER – YOUNG LADY



Service Requirement: None

Favour: Draw 1 casual guest

***Conditional Favour:** If a male prestige guest is played at the same activity as the young lady, gain 2 reputation

PR: n/a **VP:** 1

FAMILY MEMBER – LADY OF THE MANOR



Service Requirement: None

Favour: Choose between—

- Draw 2 casual guests, keep 1, and dismiss the other (see Screening Guests, pg. 36), or
- Dismiss 1 guest from your hand, current activity, or discard pile

PR: n/a **VP:** 2

FAMILY MEMBER – DOWAGER *(FAMILY ASQUITH ONLY)*



Service Requirement: None

Favours: Take both—

- Gain 1 reputation, and
- Gain £100

PR: n/a **VP:** 1

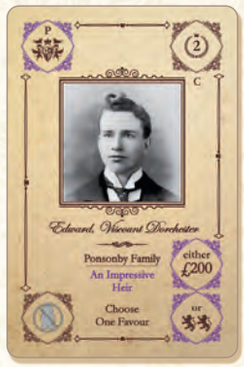


(C) DISTINGUISHED FAMILY MEMBERS

Distinguished Family Members (DFM) – The Lord, Lady, Heir, and Young Lady for each DFM have identical effects. The Asquith's family advantage is a unique Dowager Countess.

Family do not have a Prestige Rating (PR) and may attend any activity, if they qualify.

(C) DISTINGUISHED FAMILY MEMBER – HEIR



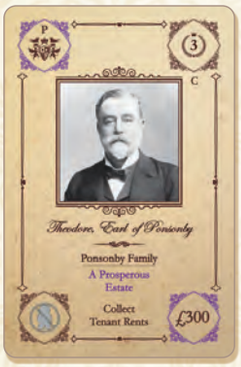
Service Requirement: None

Favour: Choose between—

- Gain £200, or
- Gain 2 reputation

PR: n/a **VP:** 2

(C) DISTINGUISHED FAMILY MEMBER – LORD OF THE MANOR



Service Requirement: None

Favour: Gain £300

PR: n/a **VP:** 3

(C) DISTINGUISHED FAMILY MEMBER – YOUNG LADY



Service Requirement: None

Favour: Return 1 family from the discard pile to your hand; if there is no family in your discard pile, this favour has no effect

***Conditional Favour:** If a male prestige guest is played at the same activity as the young lady, gain 3 reputation

PR: n/a **VP:** 1

(C) DISTINGUISHED FAMILY MEMBER – LADY OF THE MANOR



Service Requirement: None

DFM Service Ability: You may ignore any 1 required servant on another guest at your activity

Favour: Choose between—

- Draw 2 casual guests, keep 1, and dismiss the other (see Screening Guests, pg. 36), or
- Dismiss 1 guest from your hand, current activity, or discard pile

PR: n/a **VP:** 2

(C) DISTINGUISHED FAMILY MEMBER – DOWAGER *(ASQUITH ONLY)*



Service Requirement: None

Favours: Take both—

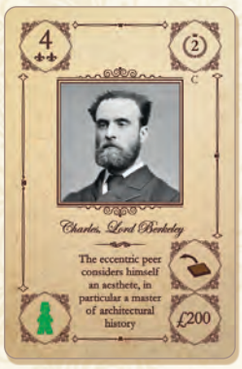
- After you clear your board this turn, you may refresh any 1 servant to Available Service, and
- Gain £200

PR: n/a **VP:** 1

UNIQUE GUESTS

Note: Unique guests in this section are alphabetised by **last name**.

(C) CHARLES, LORD BERKELEY



PR: 4 **VP:** 2

Aesthete

Service Requirement: Valet

Favours: Take both—

- Flip 1 activity tile to its rose side or flip 1 hybrid activity tile to its opposite side. **Note:** You may not flip the Business Room or Private Study using this favour, and you also may not use this favour to flip a tile you acquired during your current activity, and
- Gain £200

(U) JANE BOOTH



PR: 1 **VP:** -3

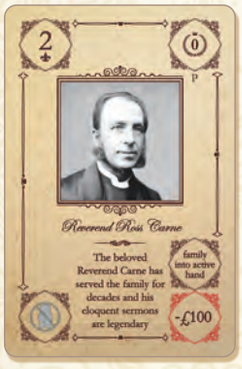
Actress

Service Requirement: Lady's maid

Favours: Take both—

- Add up to 3 casual guests beyond the guest count (these new guests do not require personal service). **Note:** If the current activity restricts the kinds of gentry that can attend, each additional gentry must follow these restrictions. (For example, if an activity requires 2 Ladies, you can't invite a Gentleman, only another Lady), and
- Lose 3 reputation

Note: Cannot be played in the Heritage Guest Suite.



PR: 2 **VP:** 0

(U) REVEREND ROSS CARNE

Service Requirement: None

Favours: Take both—

- Return all family in your discard pile to your hand, and
- Pay £100 to the supply

(U) SIR WALLACE CARTER, BT.



PR: 2 **VP:** 2

Houseguest

Service Requirement: None

Ongoing Effect: This card is not added to your hand but placed beneath your family board face up. Each turn, roll a d20 dice during Enjoy Favours.

- **If 1–18 is rolled:** the player takes £100 from the supply, or
- **If 19 or 20 is rolled:** Sir Wallace is revealed to be a libertine; lose 4 reputation, and the card is dismissed.

(C) MISS EUNICE COMPTON



PR: 1 **VP:** 0

Socialite

Service Requirement: None

Socialite Ability (+1): Increase the total number of gentry that must attend their activity by 1. **Note:** If the current activity restricts the kinds of gentry that can attend, each additional gentry must follow these restrictions. (For example, if an activity requires 2 Ladies, you can't invite a Gentleman, only another Lady.)

Favour: Draw 1 casual guest

Note: Cannot be played in the Heritage Guest Suite.

(C) SIR AUGUST DANKWORTH



PR: 2 **VP:** -2

Curmudgeon

Antisocialite Ability (-1): Reduce the total number of gentry that must attend their activity by 1. **Note:** If the current activity requires a set of gentry of specific kinds, you may choose which of them you do not invite. (For example, if an activity requires 2 Gentlemen and 2 Ladies, you may invite 2 Gentlemen and 1 Lady, or 1 Gentleman and 2 Ladies.)

Service Requirement: Valet

Favours: Take both—

- Gain 1 reputation, and
- Gain £200

Note: Cannot be played in the Heritage Guest Suite.

CHARLES FAIRCHILD



PR: Fairchilds do not have a PR and may attend any activity, if they qualify

Service Requirement: Valet

Favour: Gain 3 reputation

PR: n/a **VP:** 8

(C) CHARLES FAIRCHILD *(ALTERNATE)*



PR: Fairchilds do not have a PR and may attend any activity, if they qualify

Service Requirement: Valet

Favours: Take both—

- Gain £300, and
- Gain 3 reputation

PR: n/a **VP:** 8

ELIZABETH FAIRCHILD



PR: Fairchilds do not have a PR and may attend any activity, if they qualify

Service Requirement: Lady's maid

Favours: Take both—

- Draw 1 prestige guest, and
- Gain 2 reputation

PR: n/a **VP:** 8

(U) LADY ETHEL FAIRCHILD



Service Requirement: Lady's maid

Favour: During Enjoy Favours, secretly examine the top unrevealed Courtship theme card, which is then returned to the top of the theme card deck.

PR: 5 **VP:** 4

(U) MARGARET, DOWAGER COUNTESS FAIRCHILD



PR Note: When playing a standard-length game, Margaret can be played on the National Holiday and when reputation is Max.

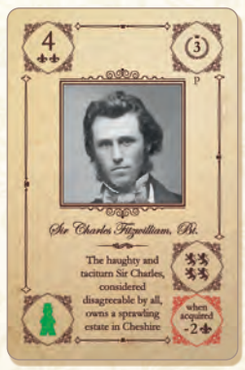
Service Requirement:
Lady's maid and housekeeper

Favours: Take both—

- Gain £500, and
- Take 1 VP card

PR: 7 **VP:** 5

(U) SIR CHARLES FITZWILLIAM, BT.



Service Requirement: Valet

Favours: Take both—

- Gain 4 reputation, and
- When drawn, announce the arrival of Sir Charles, immediately dismiss 2 casual guests from your hand, current activity, and/or discard pile, excluding unsavoury guests.

Note: When drawn into the Lionheart Suite, only the reputation favour is doubled.

PR: 4 **VP:** 3

(C) HELEN, BARONESS GATENBY



PR: 3 **VP:** 3

Socialite

Service Requirement: Lady's maid

Socialite Ability (+1): Increase the total number of gentry that must attend their activity by 1. **Note:** If the current activity restricts the kinds of gentry that can attend, each additional gentry must follow these restrictions. (For example, if an activity requires 2 Ladies, you can't invite a Gentleman, only another Lady.)

Favours: Take both—

- Draw 1 casual guest, and
- Gain 2 reputation

Note: Cannot be used in the Queen's Suite. When drawn into the Lionheart Suite, the Baroness refuses to stay. Return her to the bottom of the prestige guest deck and redraw.

(U) LADY ISOBEL HAWTHORNE



PR: 3 **VP:** 0

Activist

Service Requirement: None

Favours: Take both—

- Gain £100, and
- Casual guests who attend the current activity do not require personal service.

Note: When drawn into the Lionheart Suite, Lady Isobel refuses to stay. Return her to the bottom of the prestige guest deck and redraw.

(U) THOMAS ALLEN HURT, ESQ.



PR: 3 **VP:** 4

Service Requirement: Valet

Favours: Take both—

- When drawn, lose 3 reputation and place in the discard pile, and
- Take 1 VP card

Note: When drawn into the Lionheart Suite, only the VP card favour is doubled.

(U) SHERLOCK HOLMES



PR: 5 **VP:** 3

Detective

Service Requirement: Valet

Favours: Take both—

- Gain 2 reputation, and
- Dismiss all cads, gossips, and scoundrels from both your hand and discard pile.

Ongoing Effect: After this card has been played one time, all cads, gossips, and scoundrels drawn in the future are immediately dismissed.

(U) SIR ALASTAIR LEESE, BT.



PR: 4 **VP:** 1

Service Requirement: Valet

Favour: Gain £600

Ongoing Effect: If you have this card in your hand, current activity, or discard pile, unsavoury guests cannot be dismissed.

Note: If you also have Sherlock Holmes in your gentry deck, then Sir Alastair's Ongoing Effect prevents Sherlock Holmes from dismissing any unsavoury guests.

MISS FLORENCE OLIVER



PR: 1 **VP:** -4

Gossip

Service Requirement: Lady's maid

Favours: Take both—

- Decrease one opponent's family board reputation by 2
- Lose 1 Reputation

MISS ELIZABETH PERKINS



Gossip

Service Requirement: Lady's maid

Favour: Decrease one opponent's family board reputation by 1

PR: 1 **VP:** -3

(U) GLENCORA & PLANTAGENET PALLISER



Public Figures

PR Note: When playing a standard-length game, the Pallisers can be played on the National Holiday and when reputation is Max.

Service Requirement: Lady's maid and valet

Note: The Pallisers cannot be invited to an activity where there are gender restrictions. They can be drawn into the Lionheart Suite.

PR:7 **VP:** 5

Favours: Take both—

- Draw 1 prestige guest, and
- Flip 1 activity tile to its rose side or flip 1 hybrid activity tile to its opposite side. **Note:** You may not flip the Business Room or Private Study using this favour, and you also may not use this favour to flip a tile you acquired during your current activity.

(C) LADY HELEN PARNELL



Aesthete

Service Requirement: Lady's maid

Favours: Take both—

- Flip 1 activity tile to its rose side or flip 1 hybrid activity tile to its opposite side. **Note:** You may not flip the Business Room or Private Study using this favour. You may also not use this favour to flip a tile you acquired during your current activity, and
- Gain 3 reputation

PR: 5 **VP:** 3

(U) LADY MARY SHELTON



Service Requirement: Lady's maid

Favours: Take both—

- Gain 2 reputation, and
- Any male gentry card may be added to an activity attended by Lady Mary in excess of the tile's guest count. This guest requires service and follows reputation restrictions, but not gender restrictions.

Note: Cannot be used in the Queen's Suite. When drawn into the Lionheart Suite, the Baroness refuses to stay. Return her to the bottom of the prestige guest deck and redraw.

PR: 3 **VP:** 1

(C) HORATIO TARLETON, ESQ.



Scoundrel

Service Requirement: Valet

Socialite Ability (+2): Increase the total number of gentry that must attend their activity by 2. **Note:** If the current activity restricts the kinds of gentry that can attend, each additional gentry must follow these restrictions. (For example, if an activity requires 2 Gentlemen, you can't invite a Lady, only another Gentleman.)

Favours: Take both—

- Draw 1 casual guest, and
- Pay £100 to the supply

Note: Cannot be played in the Heritage Guest Suite.

PR: 1 **VP:** -3

(U) ASTON WEBB



Architect

Service Requirement: None

Favours: Take both—

- Take any 1 improvement tile from the Builders' Market at no cost, excluding monuments. This favour does not prevent the player from making normal purchase(s).
- Discard to the bottom of the casual guest deck after Enjoying Favours.

Note: This card may not be used in the Heritage Guest Suite.

PR: 1 **VP:** 0

APPENDIX C: IMPROVEMENT TILES

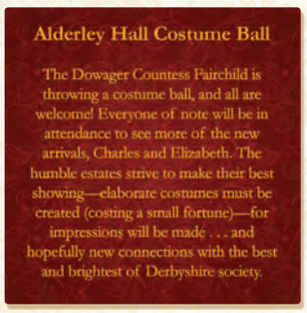
EXPANSION LEGEND: **(U)** *Upstairs, Downstairs* **(C)** *Characters* **(W)** *Wessex* **(B)** Promo Tiles Pack

(B) Alderley Hall

EVENT (see 4.8 Costume Ball, pg. 51) **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: At the beginning of season 2, place this tile in the £800 space of the Builders' Market. Return the replaced tile to the bag. Alderley Hall cannot be purchased.

Play: When the current player has made a purchase and this tile reaches the £500 space in the Builders' Market, all players with a reputation of at least 2 can choose to pay £200 to enjoy the favours.

Favours: Draw 2 prestige guests, keep 1, and dismiss the other.

When all players have enjoyed favours, remove the Alderley Hall tile from the game and refill the market.

(B) Art Gallery 119

WILDCARD **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification. When purchased, place in any category except Service.

Play: Place the head housemaid and 1 footman on the tile then play 3 Lady cards.

Favours: Pay £200 to flip and move the tile to any other, non-service, category *or* decline to pay and flip the tile in the current category.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Play: Place the head housemaid and 1 footman on the tile then play 3 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Pay £200 to flip and move the tile to any other, non-service, category *or* decline to pay and flip the tile in the current category.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Place this tile in the Builders' Market with the underlined flower in the top right facing up. It is a wildcard tile, meaning it counts as being of the category in which it is currently located.

Note: Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

Design: Steve Clark

(U) Babbling Brook 091

SPORTING/ESTATE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 4 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain £400 and 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 4 Lady cards.

Favours: Return any guest from the discard pile to the hand, also gain 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Place this tile in the Builders' Market with the underlined flower in the top right facing up. After purchasing, place the tile in the Sporting category. After the front side has been played, flip the tile over and move it to the Estate category. When the back side has been played, flip the tile again and move it back to the Sporting category. This may be done multiple times.

Design: MJ Petrie

Barn 020

SERVICE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £100.

Recurring benefit: Every time an activity is hosted using an Estate tile (a red tile, for example Main Gazebo) gain 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Big Game Trophy Room 175

SPORTING 1 TILE



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile is purchased.

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

(U) Low VP version: No price modifier, worth 1 VP.

Bowling Green Starting Tile

SPORTING 6 TILES*



FRONT



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £300.

End of game: Worth -3 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £200.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

*4 in the base game, 2 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

Billiards Room 095

SPORTING 2 TILES



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain £400.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.

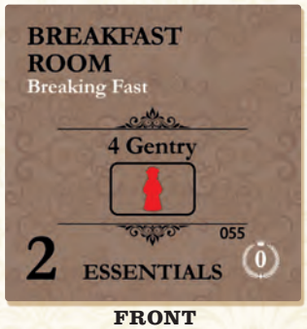
Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain £600.

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

Breakfast Room 055

ESSENTIALS 2 TILES*



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

*(W) The *Wessex* expansion includes 1 additional Breakfast Room marked as a starting tile ( ), used as part of the Wessex Family bonus (pg. 9.)

Brushing Room 005

SERVICE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £200.

Recurring benefit: Footmen may be used as valets, but only when there are no available valets.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Note: You can use Second Chance (SC) footmen as valets if you have the Brushing Room, but only if you have no available valets, which includes SC valets. You also cannot use a regular footman if you have available SC valets.

(U) (C) Business Room 038

ESSENTIALS **2 TILES***



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £100.

Play: Play the Lord of the Manor**. Flip the tile and place the Lord's favour of £200 on it. If playing with the Distinguished Family Lord from the *Characters* expansion, place £200 and take £100.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Recurring benefit: At the beginning of the turn (step 2) decide between placing another £200 from the supply on the tile *or* take all accumulated money and flip the tile.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Place this tile in the Builders' Market with the side showing the -£100 price modifier facing up. After the front side has been played, flip the tile over. When the back side has been played, flip the tile again. This may be done multiple times.

*It has been included in *Upstairs, Downstairs* (2 tiles), *Characters* (2 tiles), and the Useful Box (2 tiles).

Use only 2 Business Room tiles in a game. Any duplicates can be permanently removed from the game or kept as spares.

****The Lords are:** Daniel, Earl of Asquith; Earl Paul Cavendish; James, Earl Howard; Theodore, Earl of Ponsonby; John, Viscount Wessex; and George, Viscount York.

Butler's Pantry 015

SERVICE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Gain 1 underbutler from the supply.

Recurring benefit: The underbutler may be used instead of any male servant, except the useful man.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

This tile provides the only way to acquire an underbutler. When gained he is immediately placed in Expended Service.

Butler's Room Starting Tile

SERVICE **6 TILES***



FRONT



BACK

Play: Place the butler on the tile.

Favours: Take 2 servants (not the underbutler) from the supply. Normal servant restrictions apply.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Play: Place the butler on the tile.

Favours: Take 2 servants (not the underbutler) from the supply *or* take one valet, lady's maid or footman from an opponent (from any location on their player board).

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

The newly hired servants and the butler are placed in Expended Service at the end of the turn.

Note: When playing with the Hiring When Passing rule **(U)(C)**, this room cannot be chosen as an activity. It is flipped/upgraded the first time you choose to Hire as a passing benefit (see pgs. 30, 77).

*4 in the base game, 2 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

Cabinet of Curiosities 145

PRESTIGE **2 TILES***



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 6 reputation.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth 7 VP.

*1 in the base game, 1 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

Cricket Field 120

SPORTING **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 5 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain £500.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 5 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain £600.

End of game: Worth 6 VP.

*1 in the base game, 1 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

(U) Carriage House 010

SERVICE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman (or the hall boy) on the tile while hosting an activity.

Favours: The required number of played cards for the hosted activity can be adjusted +1 or –1. **Note:** The Carriage House cannot be used with a Suites tile, the Summer House (front side only) **(B)**, the Parish Church **(U)**, or at an activity that requires only family.

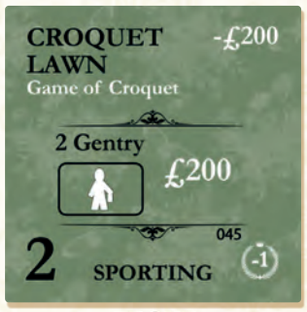
End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Move the footman or hall boy to Expended Service at the end of the turn.

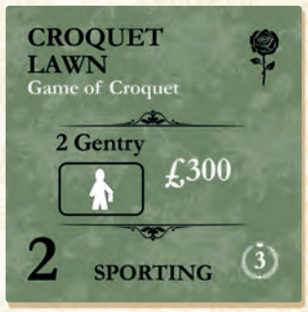
Note: This tile is not an activity tile. It stays in the tableau and is used to modify the guest count of an activity tile played on the family board.

Croquet Lawn 045

SPORTING **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £200.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £200.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £300.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Drawing Room 090

PRESTIGE **2 TILES**



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 3 reputation.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.



BACK

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 3 reputation.

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

(B) East Lawn 122

SPORTING **1 TILE**



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £400.

Play: Place 1 footman and the useful man on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 2 reputation.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman and the useful man on the tile and play 5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Roll a d20 dice. If the result is 1–16, gain 1 Victory Point card. If the result is 17–20, lose 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Note: Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

Design: Stephen Rynerson

(B) East End Ha-Ha 044

ESTATE **1 TILE**



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 3 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 1 reputation and optionally dismiss 1 guest from your hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw pile.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Design: Simon Barnes



BACK

Recurring benefit: During step 6, optionally dismiss 1 guest from your hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw pile.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

English Garden 110

ESTATE **2 TILES**



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 3 Lady cards.

Favours: Draw 2 prestige guests, keep 1, and dismiss the other.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.



BACK

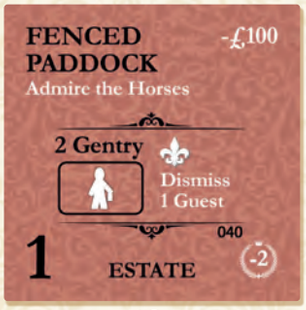
Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest and optionally dismiss 1–2 cards from your hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw piles.

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

Fenced Paddock

ESTATE — **040** — **2 TILES**



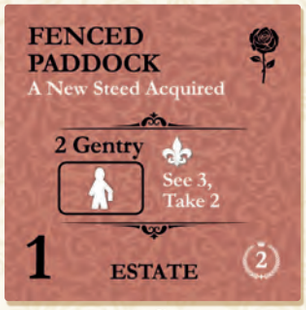
FRONT

Market: Decrease price by £100.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 1 casual guest and optionally dismiss 1 card from your hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw pile. You may use the tile's dismissal favour to dismiss the casual guest you just drew.

End of game: Worth -2 VP.



BACK

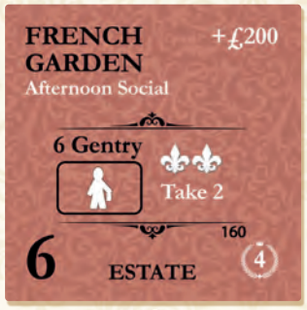
Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 3 casual guests, keep 2, and dismiss the remaining 1.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

French Garden

ESTATE — **160** — **1 TILE**



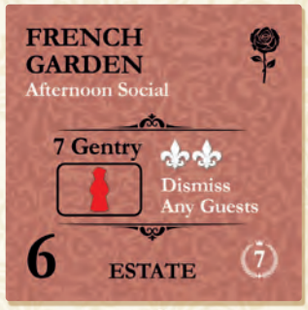
FRONT

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 6 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 2 prestige guests.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.



BACK

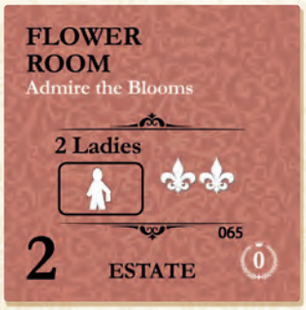
Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 7 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest and optionally dismiss any number of guests from your hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw piles.

End of game: Worth 7 VP.

Flower Room

ESTATE — **065** — **2 TILES**



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 Lady cards.

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 3 Lady cards.

Favours: Draw 1 casual guest and optionally dismiss 1–2 cards from your hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw piles. You may use the tile's dismissal favour to dismiss the casual guest you just drew.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Front Parlour

PRESTIGE — **Starting Tile** — **6 TILES***

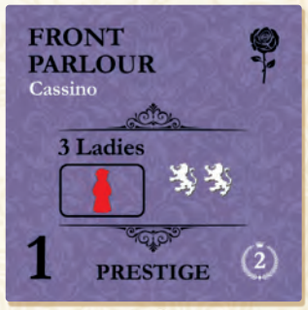


FRONT

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 2 Lady cards.

Favours: Gain 3 reputation.

End of game: Worth -2 VP.



BACK

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 3 Lady cards.

Favours: Gain 2 reputation.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

*4 in the base game, 2 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

Gabled Conservatory 085

ESTATE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 Lady cards.

Favours: Draw 4 casual guests and select 2 to keep.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 Lady cards.

Favours: Draw 3 casual guests, keep 2, and dismiss the remaining 1. In addition, optionally dismiss 1 card from your hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw pile. You may use the tile's dismissal favour to dismiss a casual guest you just drew.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

Garden Maze 185

ESTATE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £200.

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile is purchased.

End of game: Worth 7 VP.

May be used as an alternative to the Sculpture Garden monument tile (pg. 100).

Note: There is no low VP Garden Maze monument.

(B) Garden Observatory 092

PRESTIGE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place 1 footman and the useful man on the tile and play 3 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Roll a d20 dice. If the result is 1–17 gain £300. If the result is 18–20 gain 6 reputation.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 2 reputation and draw 1 prestige guest.

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

Note: Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

Design: Silver Fang

(B) Grand Ballroom 173

ESSENTIALS **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £300.

Play: Place the hall boy, the butler, and 1 footman on the tile then play 3 Ladies and 3 Gentleman cards.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Play: Place the hall boy, the butler, and 1 footman on the tile then play 4 Ladies and 4 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest, gain £400, and gain 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth 7 VP.

Note: Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

PR Note: When playing a standard-length game, the Grand Ballroom can be played on the National Holiday and when reputation is Max.

Design: Steve Clark

Great Hall

155

ESSENTIALS

1 TILE



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 6 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 0 VP.



BACK

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 9 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 6 VP.

Heritage Guest Suite

060

ESSENTIALS

1 TILE



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 1 casual guest card.

Favours: Double all favours on the played guest card including any negative favours (in a red frame).

End of game: Worth 1 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 1 casual guest card.

Favours: Double all favours on the played guest card including any negative favours (in a red frame).

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Note: The number of gentry must be 1, meaning guests or tiles that modify guest counts cannot be used (see Tiles FAQ pg. 79, top right).

Green Room

088

ESSENTIALS/PRESTIGE

1 TILE



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 4 Lady cards.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 1 Gentleman card and 1 Lady card.

Favours: Gain 2 reputation.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Place this tile in the Builders' Market with the underlined flower in the top right facing up. After the front side has been played, flip the tile over and move it to the Prestige category. When the back side has been played, file the tile again and move it back to the Essentials category. This may be done multiple times.

Hillside Kennels

075

SPORTING

2 TILES



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 3 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £300.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £400.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

(B) Horse Carriage 033

SERVICE 1 TILE



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 2 footmen on the tile and play the Lady of the Manor*.

Favours: Gain 1 available Fairchild card until the next Courtship round.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Play: Place 2 footmen on the tile and play the Lord of the Manor**.

Favours: Gain £1000 and lose 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.

***The Ladies are:** Patricia, Countess of Asquith; Lady Evelyn Cavendish; Victoria, Countess Howard; Mabel, Countess of Ponsonby; Katherine, Viscountess Wessex; and Beatrice, Viscountess York.

****The Lords are:** Daniel, Earl of Asquith; Earl Paul Cavendish; James, Earl Howard; Theodore, Earl of Ponsonby; John, Viscount Wessex; and George, Viscount York.

Design: Bill Buchanan

(U) Housekeeper's Room 014

SERVICE 2 TILES



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Recurring benefit: The head housemaid may be used instead of the housekeeper or lady's maid, even if they are available. She may not stand in for the cook.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Note: Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

(B) Ice House 027

SERVICE 1 TILE



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: Place the useful man on the tile.

Favours: Gain 2 reputation.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Note: This is an activity (Acquire Ice) that takes the whole turn to play; no gentry are invited.

Play: Place the cook on the tile and play 3 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £400 and 1 reputation (the cook's normal ability).

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Place this tile in the Builders' Market with the side showing the +£200 price modifier facing up. After the front side has been played, flip the tile over. When the back side has been played, flip the tile again. This may be done multiple times.

Note: Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

Design: Simon Barnes

Imported Marble Floor 190

ESSENTIALS 1 TILE



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £300.

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile is purchased.

End of game: Worth 8 VP.

(U) Low VP version: No price modifier, worth 2 VP.

Largest Wine Cellar 180

SERVICE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: The Largest Wine Cellar is a Monument and never placed into the Service Reserve.

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile is purchased.

End of game: Worth 6 VP.

Note: There is no low VP service monument.

Lionheart Suite 165

PRESTIGE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and then draw 1 prestige guest from the prestige guest deck to attend this activity. Do **not** provide service to the guest.

Favours: Double all favours on the drawn card, excluding any negative favours (in a red frame). Keep the card and place it in your discard pile.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile has been flipped to this side.

End of game: Worth 6 VP.

Note: The number of gentry must be 1, meaning guests or tiles that modify guest counts cannot be used (see Tiles FAQ pg. 79, top right).

(B) Laundry 017

SERVICE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £100.

Play: Place 1 female servant here while hosting an activity to return a guest from the discard pile to your hand.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Note: If the cook is used, she does not grant her normal 1 reputation ability since she is not preparing food. This tile is not an activity tile. It stays in the tableau and is used to return any **1 card** from your discard pile to your hand. This card may be played at the current activity.

Design: Katharina Schrempf

Long Gallery 140

PRESTIGE **2 TILES***



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 5 reputation.

End of game: Worth 7 VP.

*1 in the base game, 1 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

Main Gazebo — Starting Tile

ESTATE — **6 TILES***



FRONT

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest.

End of game: Worth -2 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

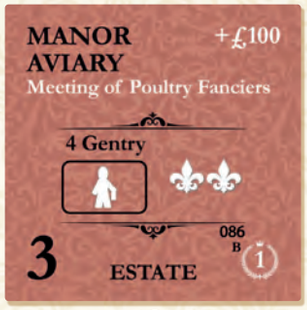
Favours: Draw 2 casual guests, keep 1, and dismiss the other.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

*4 in the base game, 2 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

(B) Manor Aviary — 086

ESTATE — **1 TILE**



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 2 casual guests, keep 1, and dismiss the other.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

Design: Laura Turtledove

Main Library — 125

ESSENTIALS — **2 TILES***



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 2 family cards.

Favours: Draw 1 objective card.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.



BACK

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 family cards.

Favours: Draw 1 VP card.

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

*1 in the base game, 1 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

Manor Gargoyles — 195

PRESTIGE — **1 TILE**



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £300.

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile is purchased.

End of game: Worth 9 VP.



BACK

(U) Low VP version: +£100 price modifier, worth 3 VP.

(W) Morning Room 037

ESSENTIALS **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £100.

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 1–3 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 1–2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

(B) Music Room (Service) 002

SERVICE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £200.

Recurring Benefit: The Young Lady* of the family permanently gains a +1 reputation favour. The favour is enjoyed when her card is played at an activity. If her admirer bonus is in effect, this +1 reputation is in addition to the +2 admirer bonus (or +3 admirer bonus if playing with the Distinguished Family Young Lady from the *Characters* expansion).

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

***The young Ladies are:** Lady Eleanor Chesterton (Asquith), Lady Tara Cavendish, Lady Diana Stark (Howard), Lady Margaret Carlow (Ponsonby), Hon. Anne Smythe (Wessex), and Hon. Marianne Waters (York).

Design: Laura Turtledove

Music Room 115

PRESTIGE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth 6 VP.

North Dining Room 080

ESSENTIALS **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 6 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

North Library — 100

ESSENTIALS — **2 TILES**



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 4 Gentleman cards.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.



BACK

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

(B) Ornamental Hermitage — 112

PRESTIGE — **1 TILE**



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 family cards.

Favours: Gain 3 reputation.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Design: Simon Barnes



BACK

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile has been flipped to this side.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

(B) North Tower — 147

PRESTIGE — **1 TILE**



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £300.

Play: Place 1 valet on the tile and play 4 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain £500 and 2 reputation.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 lady's maid and play 4 Lady cards.

Favours: Draw 3 prestige guests, keep 2, and dismiss the remaining 1.

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

Place this tile in the Builders' Market with the side showing the +£300 price modifier facing up. After the front side has been played, flip the tile over. When the back side has been played, flip the tile again. This may be done multiple times.

Design: Frank Calcagno

(U) Parish Church — 118

ESSENTIALS — **1 TILE**



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £400.

Play: Play 1 Gentleman.

Favours: Gain 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Note: The number of gentry must be 1, meaning guests or tiles that modify guest counts cannot be used (see Tiles FAQ pg. 79, top right).

Design: Stephen Cleary



BACK

Recurring benefit: At the beginning of every turn choose to either gain £100 or 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

(C) Pony & Trap — 062

SERVICE — **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman ('the driver') on the tile. Choose an activity tile from an opponent's tableau and place it, with the same side facing up, next to this tile, Play that tile as normal. Return the opponent's tile un-flipped.

Favours: Enjoy the favours from the opponent's tile. The opponent gains 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman (not a second chance servant) on the tile. Choose an activity tile from an opponent's tableau and place it, with the same side facing up, next to this tile, Play that tile as normal. Return the opponent's tile un-flipped.

Favours: Enjoy the favours from the opponent's tile without needing to provide 1 male servant service on the tile or a played card. The opponent gains 2 reputation.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Note: This tile cannot be used in **(1P)** Solo Mode.

Design: Tony Boydell

(B) Private Family Chapel — 103

ESSENTIALS — **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen) of which at least 2 must be family cards.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Design: Matteo Zago

Play: Place 2 footmen on the tile and play 6 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen). You do not need to provide servants for the played cards.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

Private Study — Starting Tile

ESSENTIALS — **6 TILES***



FRONT



BACK

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 2 family cards.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Recurring benefit: Gain £300 and 2 reputation on Village Fair rounds.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

*4 in the base game, 2 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*

Queen's Suite — 105

ESTATE — **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place the housekeeper on the tile and play 1 prestige guest card.

Favours: Double 1 favour (player's choice) on the played card. Any other favours on the card are enjoyed as normal.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Note: The number of gentry must be 1, meaning guests or tiles that modify guest counts cannot be used (see Tiles FAQ_ pg. 79, top right).

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile has been flipped to this side.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

(U) Renovated Kitchen 034

SERVICE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £300.

Play: Place the cook on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen) of any prestige rating.

Favours: Gain 1 reputation (the cook's normal ability).

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Recurring benefit: When the cook is used on hosted activities, the player may play 1 extra card in addition to the normal guest requirement. If the current activity restricts the kinds of gentry that can attend, each additional gentry must follow these restrictions. (For example, if an activity requires 2 Ladies, you can't invite a Gentleman, only another Lady.)

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Note: Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

Riding Stables 035

SPORTING **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £200.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 1 Lady card and 1 Gentleman card.

Favours: Gain £200.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 1 Lady card and 1 Gentleman card.

Favours: Gain £300.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

(W) Retiring Room 043

PRESTIGE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £200.

Play: Place 1 lady's maid on the tile and play 1 Lady card.

Favours: Gain 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Play: Place 1 lady's maid on the tile and play 1 Lady card.

Favours: Gain 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Sculpture Garden 200

ESTATE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £400.

Recurring benefit: Gain 1 reputation each round after the tile is purchased.

End of game: Worth 10 VP.

(U) Low VP version: +£200 price modifier, worth 4 VP.

Servants' Hall 030

SERVICE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: Place 1 servant of any type on the tile at the beginning of the turn (step 2) to decrease an opponent's reputation by 1 and gain 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Note: If the cook is used, she does not grant her normal 1 reputation ability since she is not preparing food.

Servants' Hall is activated at the beginning of the turn (step 2), so an activity may still be hosted in step 3. Move the servant to Expended Service at the end of the turn.

Note: This tile is not an activity tile. It stays in the tableau and is used to steal 1 reputation in the current turn. An activity may be hosted at the same time.

Servants' Quarters 025

SERVICE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Recurring benefit: Each turn, the player may use 1 servant from the Servants' Quarters in addition to servants from Available Service.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Smoking Room 070

PRESTIGE **2 TILES**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 2 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain 3 reputation.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain 3 reputation.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

South Lawn 072

SPORTING/ESTATE **1 TILE**



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 Lady cards.

Favours: Gain £300.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen) of which at least 2 must be family cards.

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest.

End of game: Worth 2 VP.

Place this tile in the Builders' Market with the underlined flower in the top right facing up. After purchasing, place the tile in the Sporting category. After the front side has been played, flip the tile over and move it to the Estate category. When the back side has been played, flip the tile again and move it back to the Sporting category. This may be done multiple times.

State Room 170

PRESTIGE 1 TILE



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 6 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 5 reputation.

End of game: Worth 5 VP.



BACK

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 8 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain 4 reputation.

End of game: Worth 8 VP.

(U) Stocked Lake 150

SPORTING 1 TILE



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £200.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 4 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £600.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.



BACK

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 Gentleman cards.

Favours: Gain £800.

End of game: Worth 7 VP.

(B) Still Room 012

SERVICE 1 TILE



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £200.

Play: Place 1 servant of your choice here (except the useful man or cook) to reserve their service for a future turn.

Use: On any future turn use the servant for two tasks. For example, use a footman to activate the Carriage House and to also provide activity service on the Bowling Green.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Move the selected servant to Expended Service at the end of the turn it was used.

Note: This tile is not an activity tile. It stays in the tableau and is used to ready a servant to be used twice in a future turn. An activity may be hosted at the same time.

Design: IvanCH

(B) Summer House 057

ESTATE 1 TILE



FRONT

Market: No price modification.

Play: Play 1 Gentleman and 1 Lady (you cannot play 2 family members).*

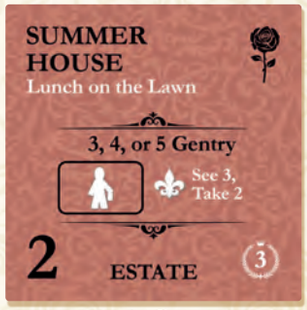
Favours: Draw 1 casual guest.

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

* In Team and Cooperative Mode you may play 2 family members from different families.

Note: The number of gentry must be 2, meaning guests or tiles that modify guest counts cannot be used (see Tiles FAQ pg. 79, top right).

Design: Aga & Szymon



BACK

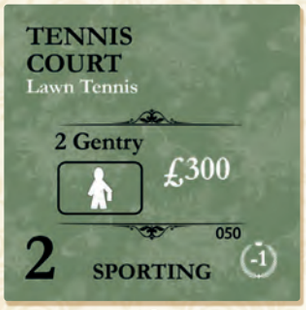
Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 3–5 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 3 casual guests, keep 2, and dismiss the remaining 1.

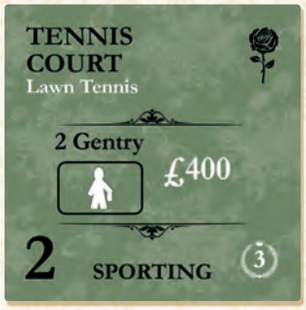
End of game: Worth 3 VP.

Tennis Court 050

SPORTING — 2 TILES*



FRONT



BACK

Market: No price modification.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £300.

End of game: Worth -1 VP.

Play: Place 1 footman on the tile and play 2 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Gain £400.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

*(W) The *Wessex* expansion includes 1 additional Tennis Court marked as a starting tile ( ), used as part of the Wessex Family bonus (pg. 9).

(B) Walled Garden 008

SERVICE — 1 TILE



FRONT



BACK

Market: Decrease price by £100.

Play: Place the cook on the tile.

Favours: Gain 2 reputation, instead of the cook's normal ability.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Note: This tile is not an activity tile. It stays in the tableau and can be used alongside an activity during your turn. Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

Design: Val Ofiesh

(B) Village Fair Stall 094

SERVICE — 1 TILE



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £300.

Play: Place the butler and the useful man on the tile.

Favours: Take 3 servants from the supply. Normal servant restrictions apply.

End of game: Worth 1 VP.

Recurring benefit: During step 2 each turn optionally pay £100 to gain 1 reputation.

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

Note: This is an activity (Recruitment Drive) that takes the whole turn to play; no gentry are invited. Requires the *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants and rules to play.

Design: Steve Clark

West Saloon 130

ESSENTIALS — 2 TILES*



FRONT



BACK

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 7 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 0 VP.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 8 cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

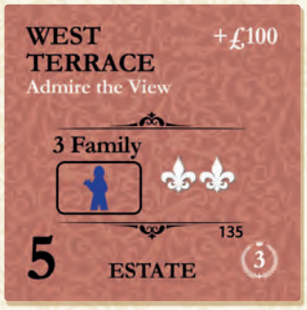
*1 in the base game, 1 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*.

West Terrace

135

ESTATE

2 TILES*



FRONT

Market: Increase price by £100.

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 family cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest.

End of game: Worth 3 VP.



BACK

Play: Place the butler on the tile and play 3 family cards (Ladies and/or Gentlemen).

Favours: Draw 1 prestige guest and optionally dismiss 1–4 guests from the hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw piles.

End of game: Worth 6 VP.

*1 in the base game, 1 more in *Upstairs, Downstairs*.

(U) ALTERNATE WEST TERRACE

Upstairs, Downstairs includes an alternate West Terrace (2 tiles) with a different favour on its back side compared to the standard West Terrace.

Decide which type of West Terrace you want to use in a game and put the other pair back in the box. Only the 2 tiles of the same type (standard or alternate) of West Terrace should be used in a game. Do not use 1 of each or all 4 in any game.



ALTERNATE TILE BACK

Recurring benefit: During step 6 optionally dismiss 1 guest from your hand, current activity, or discard pile to the bottom of the appropriate draw pile.

End of game: Worth 6 VP.

Note: Three different products have included this alternate version (see above): The out-of-print Useful Box (2020); printings of *Upstairs, Downstairs* after 2022; and all printings of the *Characters* expansions.



APPENDIX D: VP CARDS



REPUTATION (2 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

If discarded: Gain 2 reputation.



REPUTATION (3 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

If discarded: Gain 3 reputation.



MONEY (3 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

If discarded: Gain £200.



MONEY (3 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

If discarded: Gain £300.



MARKET PURCHASE (2 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 3 VP.

If discarded: Make as many purchases from the Builders' Market as resources allow. This favour works the same as the Builders' Holiday round event on the round track (see Round Track Events, pg. 17).



MARKET REFRESH (3 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

If discarded: Refresh the Builders' Market (pg. 41).



OBJECTIVE CARD (3 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

If discarded: Gain 1 objective card by drawing 2 cards from the supply and selecting 1 to keep. Return the other card to the bottom of the deck.



REFRESH SERVICE (4 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

If discarded: Move all servants directly to Available Service. They can be used immediately. This is the same refresh that takes place when a player passes (see 2.5 Passing, pg. 21).



PRESTIGE GUEST (3 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 4 VP.

If discarded: Draw 1 guest card from the prestige deck, reveal it to all players, and add it to your hand.



HIRE SERVANT (2 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

If discarded: Take 1 servant (not the underbutler) from the Servants for Hire section of the supply board. The servant is placed in Expended Service.



REFRESH GUEST (2 CARDS)

End of game: Worth 5 VP.

If discarded: You may return 1 gentry card of your choice from your discard pile to your hand. It can be used immediately.

APPENDIX E: OBJECTIVE CARDS

EXPANSION LEGEND: **(U)** *Upstairs, Downstairs* **(C)** *Characters* **(W)** *Wessex*

OBJECTIVE DECK BACKS

Back of the objective deck included in the base game and in the *Upstairs, Downstairs* expansion.





Back of the objective deck included in the *Characters* expansion. This deck completely replaces the red-backed objective deck in all situations.

GROUPS OF TILES

To complete any tile objective, you only need to have those tiles in your tableau; it is never necessary that the tile be upgraded.



GROUP BONUS
6 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)** **(C)**

Service Group
Both Barn and Brushing Room tiles are needed.



GROUP BONUS
8 VP

Deck: **(C)**

Elite Service Group
Both Housekeeper's Room and Butler's Pantry tiles are needed. Requires **(U)**.



GROUP BONUS
9 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)** **(C)**

Epicurean Group
Both Breakfast Room and North Dining Room tiles are needed.



GROUP BONUS
9 VP

Deck: **(C)**

Management Group
Both Morning Room and Business Room tiles are needed.



GROUP BONUS
9 VP

Deck: **(C)**

Nature Group
The Flower Room tile and any 1 garden tile needed. The gardens are English Garden, French Garden, Sculpture Garden, or Garden Maze.



GROUP BONUS
10 VP

Deck: **(C)**

Domestic Group
The Conservatory tile and any 1 library tile needed. The library tiles are Main Library and North Library.



GROUP BONUS
10 VP

Deck: **(C)**

Proper Service Group
Finish the game with at least 4 of these tiles: Barn, Brushing Room, Servants' Quarters, Butler's Pantry, and Carriage House.



GROUP BONUS
10 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)** **(C)**

Prestige Group
Both Smoking Room and Drawing Room tiles are needed.



GROUP BONUS
11 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)**

Nature Group
The Flower Room tile and any 1 garden tile needed. The gardens are English Garden, French Garden, Sculpture Garden, and Garden Maze.



GROUP BONUS
12 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

Animal Lover's Group
The Fenced Paddock, Hillside Kennels, and Riding Stables tiles are all three needed.



GROUP BONUS
12 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)**

Domestic Group
The Conservatory tile and 1 library tile needed. The library tiles are Main Library and North Library.



GROUP BONUS
12 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

Literature Group
Both Main Library and North Library tiles are needed.



GROUP BONUS
13 VP

Deck: **(C)**

Fly Fishing Group
Both Stocked Lake and Babbling Brook tiles are needed. Requires **(U)**.



GROUP BONUS
13 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

Sporting Group
The Tennis Court, Cricket Field, and Croquet Lawn tiles are all three needed.



GROUP BONUS
14 VP

Deck: **(C)**

Ladies' Group
The Conservatory, Flower Room, and Music Room tiles are all needed. The promotional service tile Music Room does not count.



GROUP BONUS
15 VP

Deck: **(C)**

Gentlemen's Group
The Billiards Room, Hillside Kennels, and Cabinet of Curiosities tiles are all needed.



GROUP BONUS
16 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)**

Ladies' Group
The Conservatory, Flower Room, and Music Room tiles are all needed. The promotional service tile Music Room does not count.



GROUP BONUS
17 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)**

Gentlemen's Group
The Billiards Room, Hillside Kennels, and Cabinet of Curiosities tiles are all needed.

GUEST CARDS



GUEST BONUS
1 VP for every prestige guest

Deck: Base, **(U)**

Family cards do not count.



GUEST BONUS
1 VP for every 2 prestige guests

Deck: **(C)**

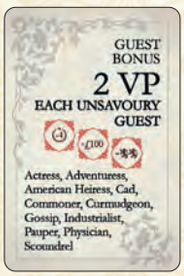
Family cards do not count.



GUEST BONUS
1 VP for every 3 guests

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

All guest cards, except family cards, count.



GUEST BONUS
2 VP for every unsavoury guest

Deck: **(C)**

Guests are unsavoury if they have at least 1 red frame on their card (denoting negative VP or favours).



HYBRID BONUS



HYBRID BONUS
5 VP

Deck: (C)

Repair Group
The Barn tile and the useful man are both needed. Requires **(U)**.



HYBRID BONUS
6 VP

Deck: (C)

Gourmand Group
The North Dining Room tile and the cook are both needed. Requires **(U)**.



HYBRID BONUS
7 VP

Deck: (C)

Courtesy Group
The Carriage House tile and the hall boy are both needed. Requires **(U)**.



HYBRID BONUS
7 VP

Deck: (C)

Gossip Group
The Servants' Hall tile and the head housemaid are both needed. Requires **(U)**.

IMPROVEMENT CATEGORIES

Note: Score only the hybrid tile's final face-up category.



ESSENTIALS BONUS
1 VP per tile

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

Including monument and hybrid tiles.



ESTATE BONUS
1 VP per tile

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

Including monument and hybrid tiles.



PRESTIGE BONUS
1 VP per tile

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

Including monument and hybrid tiles.



SERVICE BONUS
1 VP per tile

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

Including monument and hybrid tiles.



SPORTING BONUS
1 VP per tile

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

Including monument and hybrid tiles.

MAJORITY BONUSES

Note: Score only the hybrid tile's final face-up category. **(1P)** Remove all these objective cards for solo play.



MAJORITY BONUS
4 VP

Deck: (C)

Essentials Majority
Have more tiles in the Essentials category than one adjacent player.



MAJORITY BONUS
4 VP

Deck: (C)

Estate Majority
Have more tiles in the Estate category than one adjacent player.



MAJORITY BONUS
4 VP

Deck: (C)

Prestige Majority
Have more tiles in the Prestige category than one adjacent player.



MAJORITY BONUS
4 VP

Deck: (C)

Service Majority
Have more tiles in the Service category than one adjacent player.



MAJORITY BONUS
4 VP

Deck: (C)

Sporting Majority
Have more tiles in the Sporting category than one adjacent player.

SERVANTS

Note: (C) Second chance servants cannot be used to complete objectives.



SERVANT BONUS
1 VP for every 2 basic* servants

Deck: (U)(C)

Butler, housekeeper, and underbutler do not count. *Common and supplemental servants.



SERVANT BONUS
1 VP for every basic* servants

Deck: Base

Only valets, lady's maids, and footmen count. *Common servants.



SERVANT BONUS
4 VP

Deck: (U)(C)

Finish the game with at least 1 of each female servant. They are the cook, housekeeper, lady's maid, and head housemaid. Requires **(U)**.



SERVANT BONUS
4 VP

Deck: (U)

Finish the game with all 4 *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants: useful man, head housemaid, cook, and hall boy. Requires **(U)**.



SERVANT BONUS
5 VP

Deck: Base

2 valets and 2 lady's maids are needed.



SERVANT BONUS
5 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)(C)**

The underbutler is needed.



SERVANT BONUS
5 VP

Deck: (U)

Have 13 or more servants at the end of the game. Requires **(U)**.



SERVANT BONUS
5 VP

Deck: (C)

Have 11 or more servants at the end of the game. Requires **(U)**.



SERVANT BONUS
5 VP

Deck: (C)

Finish the game with all 4 *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants: useful man, head housemaid, cook, and hall boy. Requires **(U)**.

SERVANTS (CONTINUED)

Note: (C) Second chance servants cannot be used to complete objectives.



SERVANT BONUS
5 VP

Deck: (C)

3 footmen needed.



SERVANT BONUS
6 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)**

3 lady's maids needed.



SERVANT BONUS
6 VP

Deck: Base, **(U)**

3 valets needed.



SERVANT BONUS
6 VP

Deck: (C)

2 lady's maids, 2 valets, and 2 footmen are all needed.



SERVANT BONUS
7 VP

Deck: (C)

Trainee Group
The underbutler and hall boy are both needed. Requires **(U)**.



SERVANT BONUS
7 VP

Deck: Base

Have 10 or more servants at the end of the game.



SERVANT BONUS
7 VP

Deck: (U)

Finish the game with at least 1 of each male servant: butler, under-butler, valet, footman, useful man, and hall boy. Requires **(U)**.



SERVANT BONUS
8 VP

Deck: (C)

Finish the game with at least 1 of each male servant: butler, under-butler, valet, footman, useful man, and hall boy. Requires **(U)**.

TABLEAU

Note: Score only the hybrid tile's final face-up category.



TABLEAU BONUS
6 VP

Deck: (U)(C)

Have at least 5 tiles in any 1 category. Score only once (if you have more than 1 column of 5 tiles, this card still scores only 6 VP).



TABLEAU BONUS
7 VP

Deck: (C)

Country Living Estate
Finish the game with the most Estate and Sporting tiles. Compare the combined total for both categories. **(1P)** Remove for solo play.



TABLEAU BONUS
7 VP

Deck: (C)

Traditional Estate
Finish the game with the most Service and Essentials tiles. Compare the combined total for both categories. **(1P)** Remove for solo play.

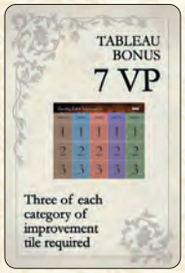


TABLEAU BONUS
7 VP

Deck: (U)(C)

Have at least 3 improvement tiles in each category.



TABLEAU BONUS
9 VP

Deck: (C)

Largest Estate
Finish the game with the most improvement tiles (the total for all categories combined). **(1P)** Remove for solo play.

TILES

To complete any tile objective, you only need to have that tile in your tableau; it is never necessary that the tile be upgraded.



TILE BONUS
5 VP

Deck: Base

The English Garden tile is needed.



TILE BONUS
5 VP

Deck: Base, (U)(C)

The Cabinet of Curiosities tile is needed.



TILE BONUS
5 VP

Deck: Base, (U)(C)

The French Garden tile is needed.



TILE BONUS
5 VP

Deck: Base, (U)(C)

The State Room tile is needed.



TILE BONUS
5 VP

Deck: (C)

The West Saloon tile is needed.

MISCELLANEOUS



REPUTATION BONUS
7 VP

Deck: Base, (U)(C)

At the end of the game, maximum reputation is needed.



FIERY SERMON

Deck: (C)

Included in the *Characters* expansion objective card deck, but only used in cooperative play.



MONUMENT BONUS
3 VP per monument tile

Deck: Base, (U)(C)

Upgraded suite tiles and promotional tiles flipped to their monument side also count, such as:

- Queen's Suite
- Lionheart Suite
- Simon's Ha-Ha
- Parsonage
- Proper Domestic Staff



WEALTH BONUS
10 VP

Deck: Base, (U)(C)

Finish the game with at least £1200.



APPENDIX F: MILESTONES

All VP from milestones are scored at the **end of the game**, and added to Objective VP.



REPUTATION MILESTONE

To Qualify: Reach reputation level 4 on your family board.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



ESTATE MILESTONE

To Qualify: Flip 7 improvement tiles in your tableau. Only tiles showing a qualify.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



SOCIETY MILESTONE

To Qualify: Have 8 casual guests ( ) in your hand and/or discard pile. Before claiming, show your 8 casual guests to your opponents.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



HIGH SOCIETY MILESTONE

To Qualify: Have 4 prestige guests ( ) in your hand and/or discard pile. Before claiming, show your 4 prestige guests to your opponents. Fairchilds qualify.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



DOMESTIC MILESTONE

To Qualify: Have 11 servants of any type. Duplicate servants (i.e., 2 lady's maids) qualify. Starting servants qualify. **Second chance servants do not qualify**.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



SOIRÉE MILESTONE

To Qualify: Host an activity where 5 or more gentry attend. **All** gentry cards qualify, including family.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



PASSION MILESTONE

To Qualify: Flip 4 improvement tiles in one tableau category. Only tiles showing a qualify.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



GRAND ESTATE MILESTONE

To Qualify: Flip an improvement tile with a prestige rating of 5 or greater. The tile must show a to qualify.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



BALANCED MILESTONE

To Qualify: Have 2 improvement tiles in each of the 5 tableau categories. Starting tiles count, tiles do not have to be upgraded.

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.



(U) SPECIALISED DOMESTIC MILESTONE

Requires: *Upstairs, Downstairs* Expansion

To Qualify: Have all 4 *Upstairs, Downstairs* servants (cook, hall boy, head housemaid, useful man).

Top Position: Score 8 VP.

Bottom Position: Score 4 VP.

APPENDIX G: SOLO OPPONENTS

EXPANSION LEGEND: **(U)** *Upstairs, Downstairs* **(C)** *Characters* **(W)** *Wessex* **(B)** Promo Tiles Pack

MATCH DIFFICULTY

In this appendix, the difficulty rating of each solo opponent is shown as 1-3 stars beside their name: **beginner** (★), **intermediate** (★★), or **expert** (★★★).

(X) EXTENDED GAME MODE

Solo opponents compatible with the **Extended Game Mode** are listed alphabetically on the following page after all of the opponents for a standard-length game.



ANNESLEY ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 129



(U) CRAWLEY ★

Compatible: Base, **(W)(U)**
Incompatible: **(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 131



BOLEYN ★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 85



EDEN ★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 95



BRUNSWICK ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 112



FAIRFAX ★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 94



(C) CADWALADR ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)(C)**
Incompatible: **(U)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 138



FITZHERBERT ★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 99



(C) CANMORE ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)(U)(C)**
Incompatible: **(B)**
End Game Base Score: 210



GLADSTONE ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 126



CORNWALLIS ★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 102



HANOVER ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**
Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**
End Game Base Score: 117



(C) MACKENZIE ★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)(U)(C)**

Incompatible: **(B)**

End Game Base Score: 189



SIMPSON ★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**

Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 78



(C) MACMURROUGH ★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)(C)**

Incompatible: **(U)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 113



SEYMOUR ★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**

Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 80



(U) POLDARK ★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)(U)**

Incompatible: **(C)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 166



STUART ★

Compatible: Base, **(W)**

Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 87



(C) RHEGED ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)(U)(C)**

Incompatible: **(B)**

End Game Base Score: 199



(U) TOTTENHAM ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(W)(U)**

Incompatible: **(C)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 193

(X) EXTENDED MODE SOLO OPPONENTS

Note: These cards are marked with '(EP)' or 'Extended Play.'



(C) AETHELWULF ★★

Compatible: Base, **(X)(W)(U)(C)**

Incompatible: **(B)**

End Game Base Score: 251



(C) CUNEDDA ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(X)(W)(C)**

Incompatible: **(U)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 210



(C)BALLIOL ★★

Compatible: Base, **(X)(W)(U)(C)**

Incompatible: **(B)**

End Game Base Score: 241



(C) CANUTE ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(X)(W)(U)(C)**

Incompatible: **(B)**

End Game Base Score: 286



(W) BLOIS ★

Compatible: Base, **(X)(W)**

Incompatible: **(U)(C)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 128



(C) DUNCAN ★★★

Compatible: Base, **(X)(W)(C)**

Incompatible: **(U)(B)**

End Game Base Score: 218

(X) EXTENDED MODE SOLO OPPONENTS (CONTINUED)



(C) FRASER ★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)(C)
Incompatible: (U)(B)
End Game Base Score: 164



(C) GLYNDWR ★★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)(U)
Incompatible: (C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 262



(W) GROSVENOR ★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)
Incompatible: (U)(C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 150



(C) GWYNEDD ★★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)(U)(C)
Incompatible: (B)
End Game Base Score: 277



(U) LAMBTON WORM ★★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)(U)
Incompatible: (C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 327



(W) LANCASTER ★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)
Incompatible: (U)(C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 122



(C) MACGREGOR ★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)(C)
Incompatible: (U)(B)
End Game Base Score: 173



(W) ORANGE ★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)
Incompatible: (U)(C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 147



(W) PLANTAGENET ★★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)
Incompatible: (U)(C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 187



(W) TUDOR ★★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)
Incompatible: (U)(C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 174



(U) WINDSOR ★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)(U)
Incompatible: (C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 203



(U) WARLEGGAN ★★

Compatible: Base, (X)(W)(U)
Incompatible: (C)(B)
End Game Base Score: 230

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QUICK REFERENCE

ICONS

- Reputation
- £ Money
- VP
- Starter Guest
- Casual Guest
- Prestige Guest
- Starter Tile
- Upgraded Tile
- Hybrid Tile
- VP Card — VP Card
- Ongoing Effect
- Pass 1st Player Marker
- Screen Guests (Draw 2, Keep 1)
- Screen Objectives (Draw 2, Keep 1) — obj
- Dismiss Guest
- Discard Objective
- Return 1 Discarded Gentry to Hand
- Refresh 1 Servant
- Refresh All Servants
- Ignore Service on 1 Guest
- Socialite: +1 Gentry Required — +1
- Antisocialite: –1 Gentry Required — –1
- Buy Any Number of Tiles
- Hire 1 Servant (not underbutler) — ?
- Flip Tile
- Take Free Tile

COMMON SERVANTS

(can be recruited) pg.29

FOOTMAN

- Required on activities and some guest cards
- Backup valet if no valets are available (needs Brushing Room)
- **(C)** Activates characters

VALET

- Required on male guest cards

LADY'S MAID

- Required on female guest cards

SECOND CHANCE SERVANTS (SCS)

(can be recruited) pg.34

(C) SC FOOTMAN

- Like a regular footman, with reputation penalties
- Cannot activate characters

(C) SC VALET

- Like a regular valet, with reputation penalties

(C) SC LADY'S MAID

- Like a regular lady's maid, with reputation penalties

Reputation Level	VP
1	1
2	3
3	6
4	10
5	15
6	21
7 (Max)	28
8	36
9 (Max)	45

SUPPLEMENTAL SERVANTS

(cannot be recruited) pg.31

(U) HALL BOY

- +£100 if used on guest card money favour
- Backup butler on guest cards even when butler is available
- Backup footman on the Carriage House even when footmen are available

(U) HEAD HOUSEMAID

- Screens invites on guest cards or tiles
- Backup housekeeper on guest cards even when housekeeper is available
- Backup housekeeper and lady's maid even if they are available (needs Housekeeper's Room)

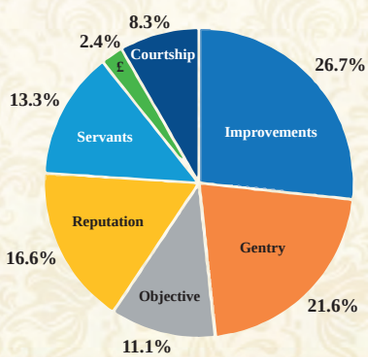
(U) COOK

- When placed on an activity tile, lowers the prestige rating (PR) of all guest cards in your hand by 2 and gain 1

(U) USEFUL MAN

- +£200 on a Village Fair round when placed on Private Study
- –£100 on tile purchase (cannot be £0)
- –1 prestige rating (PR) on tile
- Remove from the game to either refresh the market or locate a specific tile in the tile bag

VICTORY POINT DISTRIBUTION



Distribution of VP based on 48 plays (base game only)

UNIQUE SERVANTS

(cannot be recruited) pg.29

BUTLER

- Hires and recruits servants
- Hires and recruits SCS
- Required on some tiles
- Required on some male guest cards

HOUSEKEEPER

- Backup lady's maid if no lady's maids are available
- Required on some improvement tiles
- Required on some female guest cards

UNDERBUTLER

- Hired by acquiring a Butler's Pantry tile
- Backup for any male servant even when servants of that type are available (except the useful man)

CHARACTERS

pg.43

(C) REVEREND GRANTLY

- Exchange 1-2 objectives with the Reverend's pile (mandatory). Pay £100 per objective exchanged

(C) CONSTABLE BUCKET

- Ignore negative guest favours at activity*
- Dismiss unsavoury guests (minimum 1)*
- Lose 2 reputation

*Cannot ignore or dismiss American Heiresses

(C) ECCENTRIC DOWAGER

- **When invited:** Instead of passing benefit, invite 1 Exile from the dowager's pile
- **When enjoying favours:** +1 gentry to your activity